

# Results — revised submission — original style

## 1 Datasets

| # | Name            | $N$  | $P$  | $K$ | MeanIR | CVIR |
|---|-----------------|------|------|-----|--------|------|
| 1 | GpositivePseAAC | 519  | 440  | 4   | 3.86   | 1.15 |
| 2 | CHD_49          | 555  | 49   | 6   | 5.77   | 1.60 |
| 3 | Emotions        | 593  | 72   | 6   | 1.48   | 0.16 |
| 4 | Scene           | 2407 | 294  | 6   | 1.25   | 0.11 |
| 5 | PlantPseAAC     | 978  | 440  | 12  | 6.69   | 0.68 |
| 6 | Water-quality   | 1060 | 16   | 14  | 1.77   | 0.29 |
| 7 | Yeast           | 2417 | 103  | 14  | 7.20   | 1.82 |
| 8 | HumanPseAAC     | 3106 | 440  | 14  | 15.29  | 1.05 |
| 9 | enron           | 1702 | 1001 | 53  | 10.45  | 0.80 |

Table 1: (Table 3) Datasets used in the revised experiments.  $N$ ,  $P$ ,  $K$  are the number of instances, features, labels. MeanIR and CVIR report per-label imbalance (higher = more imbalanced).

## Pending follow-ups (to fill before final submission)

- **LGBM run on enron.** Sequentially training ( 2–3h per task due to  $K=53$  pairwise classifiers); will be merged into `full_enron_split_lgbm_summary/` when complete and the LGBM aggregate panels regenerated.
- **Extended PartialAbstention metrics.** The evaluator has been extended with 11 new PA metrics (`jaccard_pa`, `{example,macro,micro}_{precision,recall,f1}_pa`, `mfrd_pa`, `afrd_pa`). Existing runs were summarised with the previous metric set; the new columns will populate automatically on the next end-to-end training+evaluation pass.

## 2 Method encoding

For every panel that follows, the x-axis encodes the classifier as one of 12 methods, grouped into three blocks:

**Block A — Order-based predictors (ours, indices 1–8).** Each name has the form `<order>-<target>-<height>`;  $order \in \{\text{PA} = \text{partial order}, \text{PR} = \text{pre-order}\}$ ;  $target \in \{\text{H} = \text{Hamming}, \text{S} = \text{Subset } 0/1\}$ ;  $height \in \{2, \infty \text{ (omitted in the label)}\}$ .

- **1 = PA-H-2:** partial order, Hamming target, height  $\leq 2$ .

- 2 = **PA-H**: partial order, Hamming target, unrestricted height.
- 3 = **PA-S-2**: partial order, Subset 0/1 target, height  $\leq 2$ .
- 4 = **PA-S**: partial order, Subset 0/1, unrestricted.
- 5 = **PR-H-2**: pre-order, Hamming, height  $\leq 2$ .
- 6 = **PR-H**: pre-order, Hamming, unrestricted.
- 7 = **PR-S-2**: pre-order, Subset 0/1, height  $\leq 2$ .
- 8 = **PR-S**: pre-order, Subset 0/1, unrestricted.

**Block B — Standard MLC baselines from the original paper (indices 9–11).**

- 9 = **BR** (Binary Relevance):  $K$  independent binary classifiers, one per label.
- 10 = **CC** (Classifier Chain): sequential chain that uses previous labels as features.
- 11 = **CLR** (Calibrated Label Ranking): pairwise label ranking with a calibration label that separates relevant from irrelevant.

**Block C — Extended baseline added for the revision (index 12).**

- 12 = **ECC** (Ensemble of Classifier Chains): averages over multiple CCs with random chain orders.

**Reading the panels.** Each panel plots one dotted line with markers per noise level, colored as in the original paper’s Table 5:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$ ,  $\alpha = 0.3$ . *PartialAbstention* and *ScoreVector* panels show only indices 1–8 (the remaining baselines do not export a partial-abstention prediction nor a probabilistic score vector). Vertical dashed lines at  $x = 4.5$ ,  $x = 8.5$ , and  $x = 11.5$  separate the four method groups: PA (1–4), PR (5–8), standard baselines BR/CC/CLR (9–11), and ECC (12). Missing methods show as gaps in the line (with a small grey “x” on the axis when the method has no data at all for that panel).

### 3 Paper results (RF base learner)

Reproduces the layout of the original paper’s main experiment tables (Tables 5–7): 3 datasets across, 4 metrics down, one table per prediction type (binary vector, partial abstention, score vector). Per the revision,  $f_{\text{MLC}}^{\text{ham}}$  and  $f_{\text{MLC}}^{\text{sub}}$  are dropped in favour of  $f_{\text{MLC}}^{\text{Jacc}}$ .

| # | Name            | $N$  | $P$  | $K$ | MeanIR | CVIR |
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Table 2: (Table 3) Datasets used in the revised experiments.  $N$ ,  $P$ ,  $K$  are the number of instances, features, labels. MeanIR and CVIR report per-label imbalance (higher = more imbalanced).

#### 3.1 Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector)

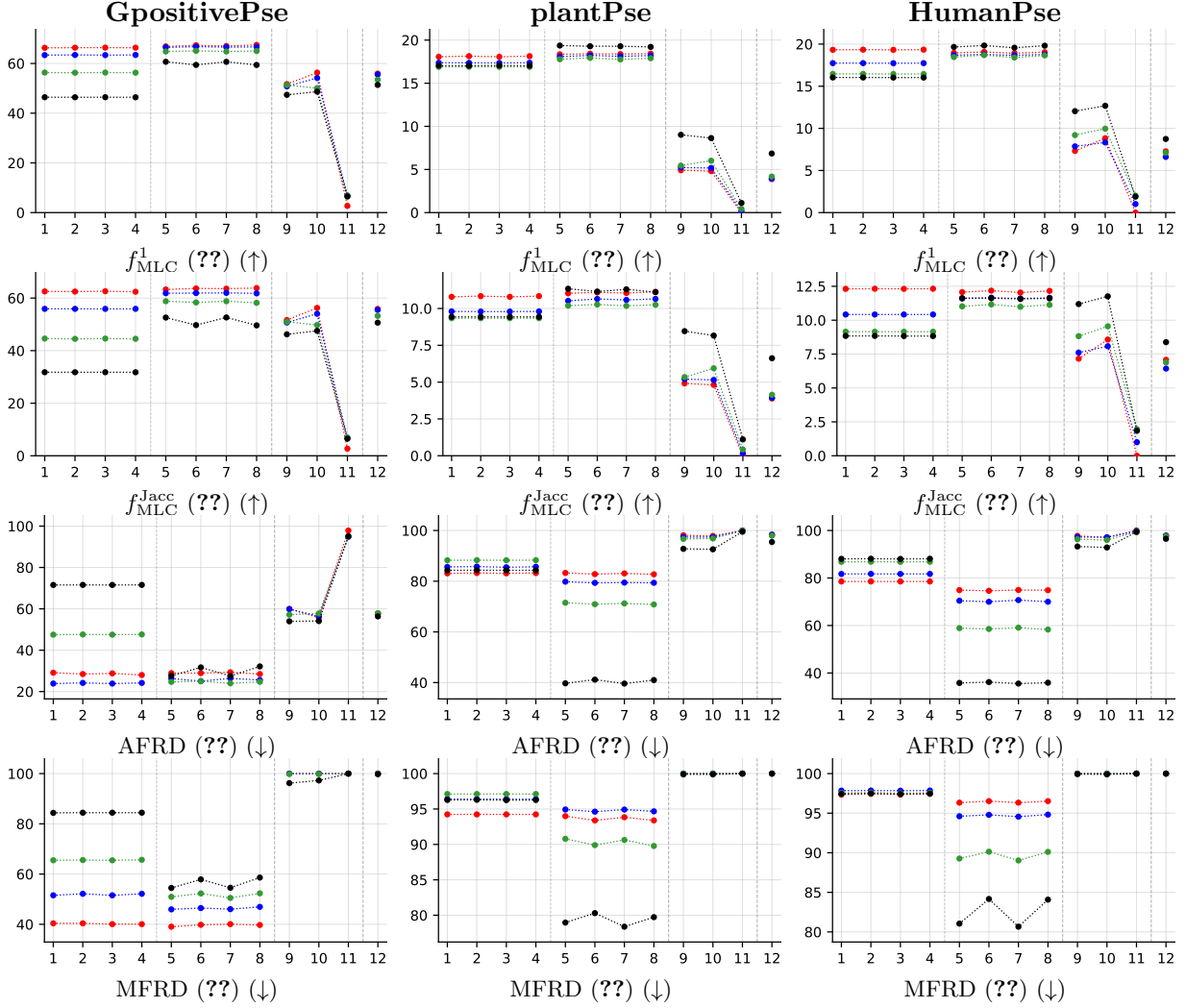


Table 3: (Table 4) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .



### 3.2 Partial abstention (PartialAbstention)

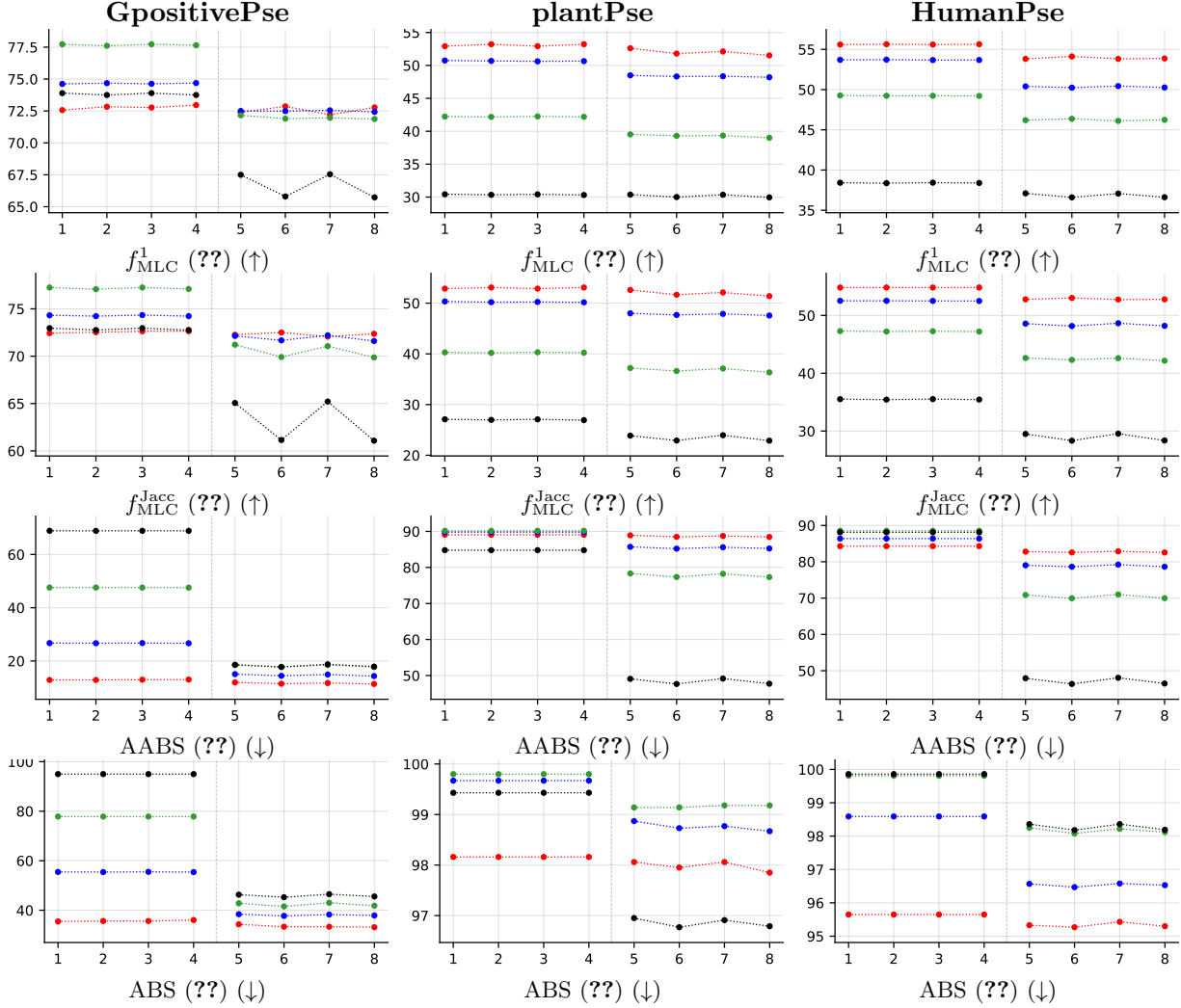


Table 4: (Table 5) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

### 3.3 Experimental results — appendix tables (RF base learner)

Appendix counterpart of the main Paper results section. Tables G2–G5 mirror the original paper’s appendix exactly (same metric sets, with the 6 non-main datasets split into imbalanced vs. balanced buckets following the original layout). Tables G6–G7 are revision additions reporting the new metrics ( $f_{MLC}^{Jacc}$ , macro- $f_1$ , micro- $f_1$ ).

#### 3.3.1 Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector)

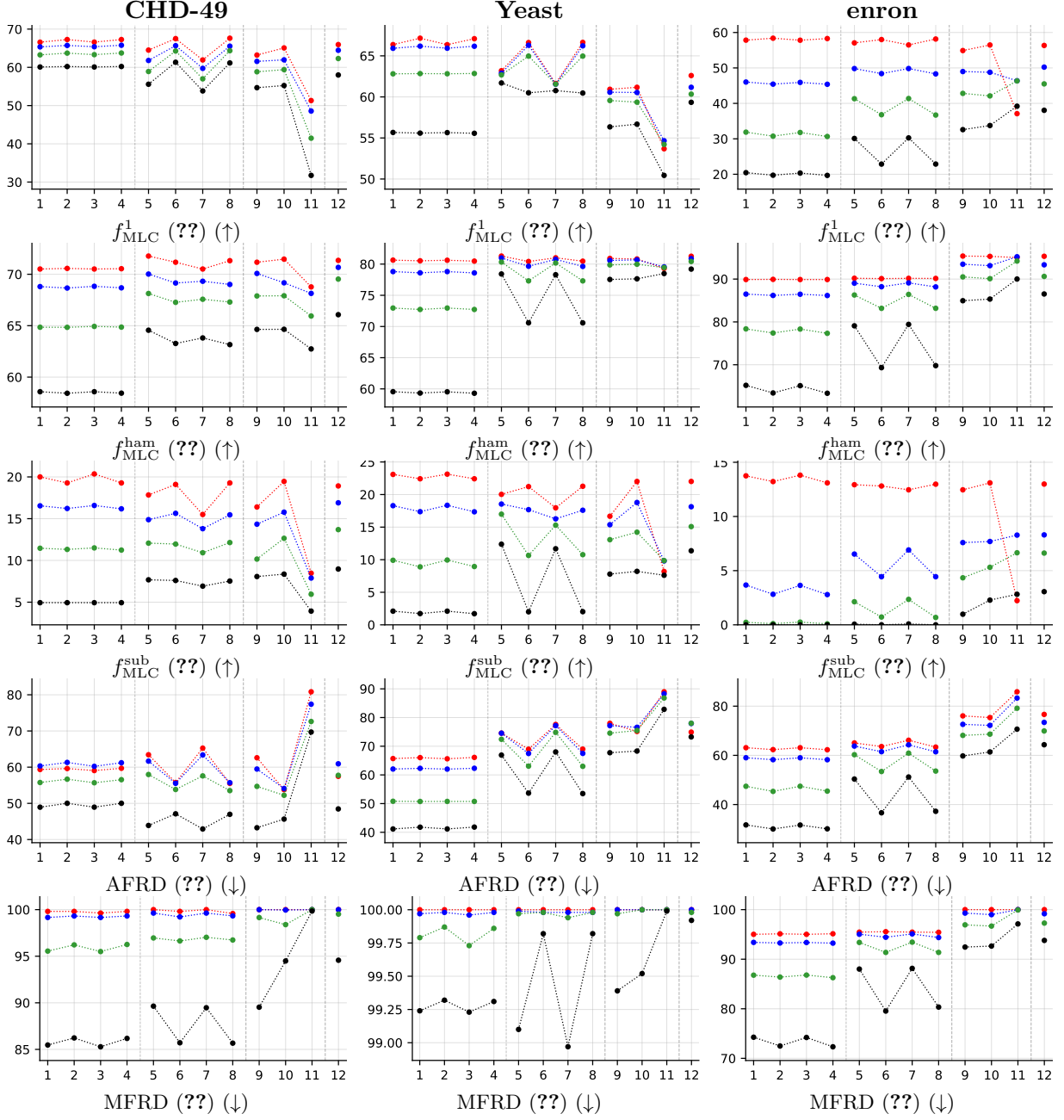


Table 5: (Table G2) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

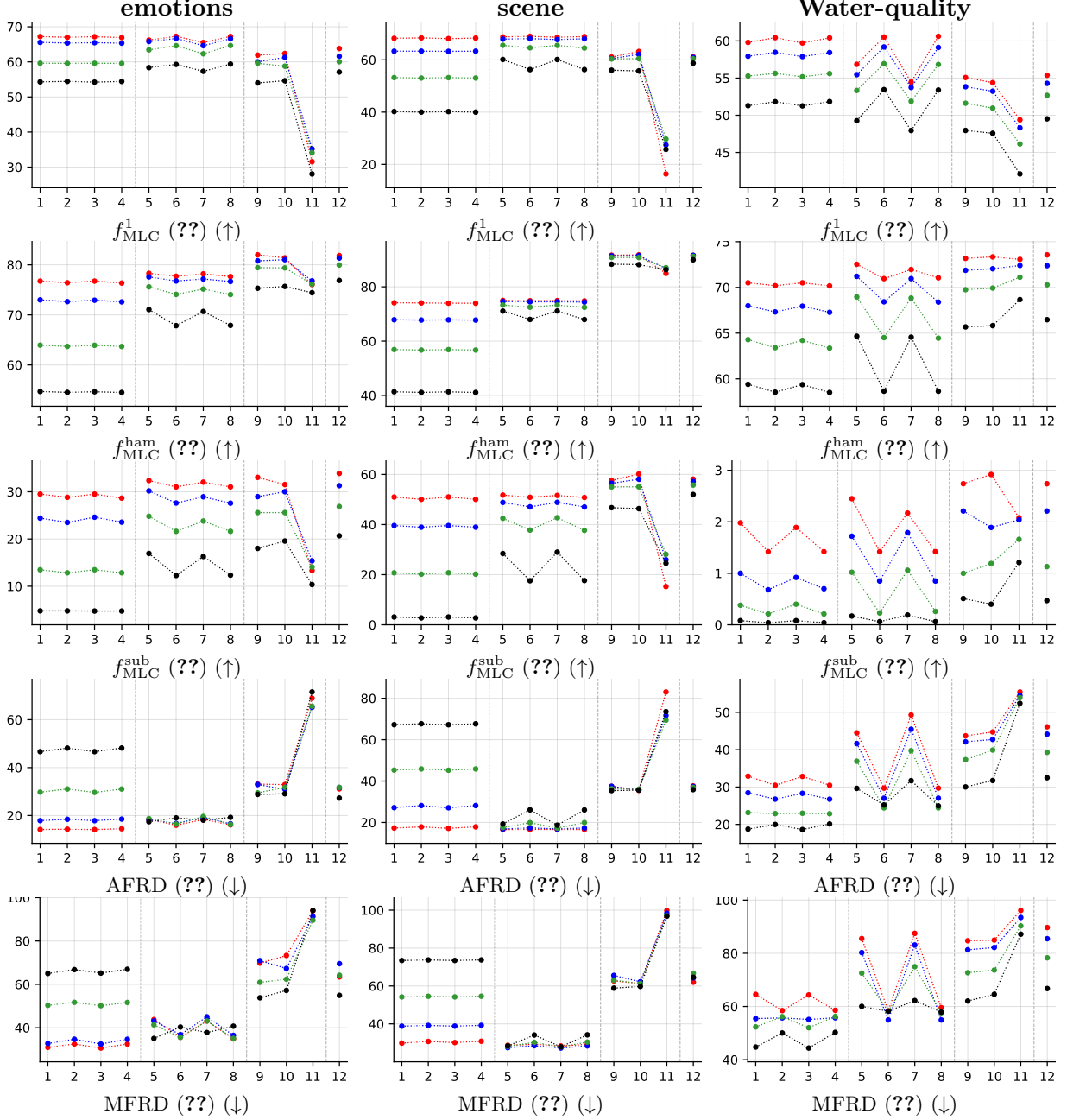


Table 6: (Table G3) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

### 3.3.2 Partial abstention (PartialAbstention)

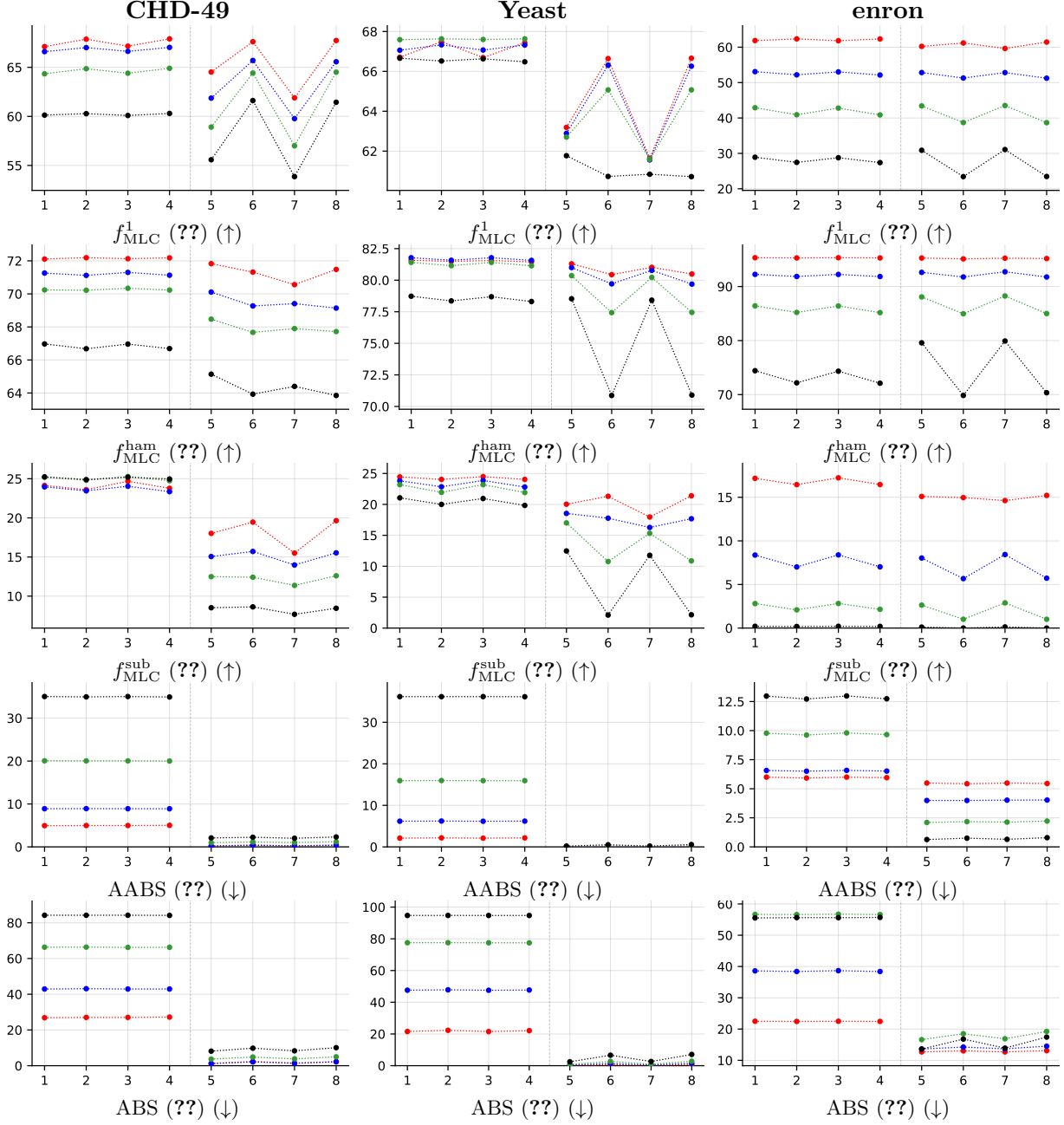


Table 7: (Table G4) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

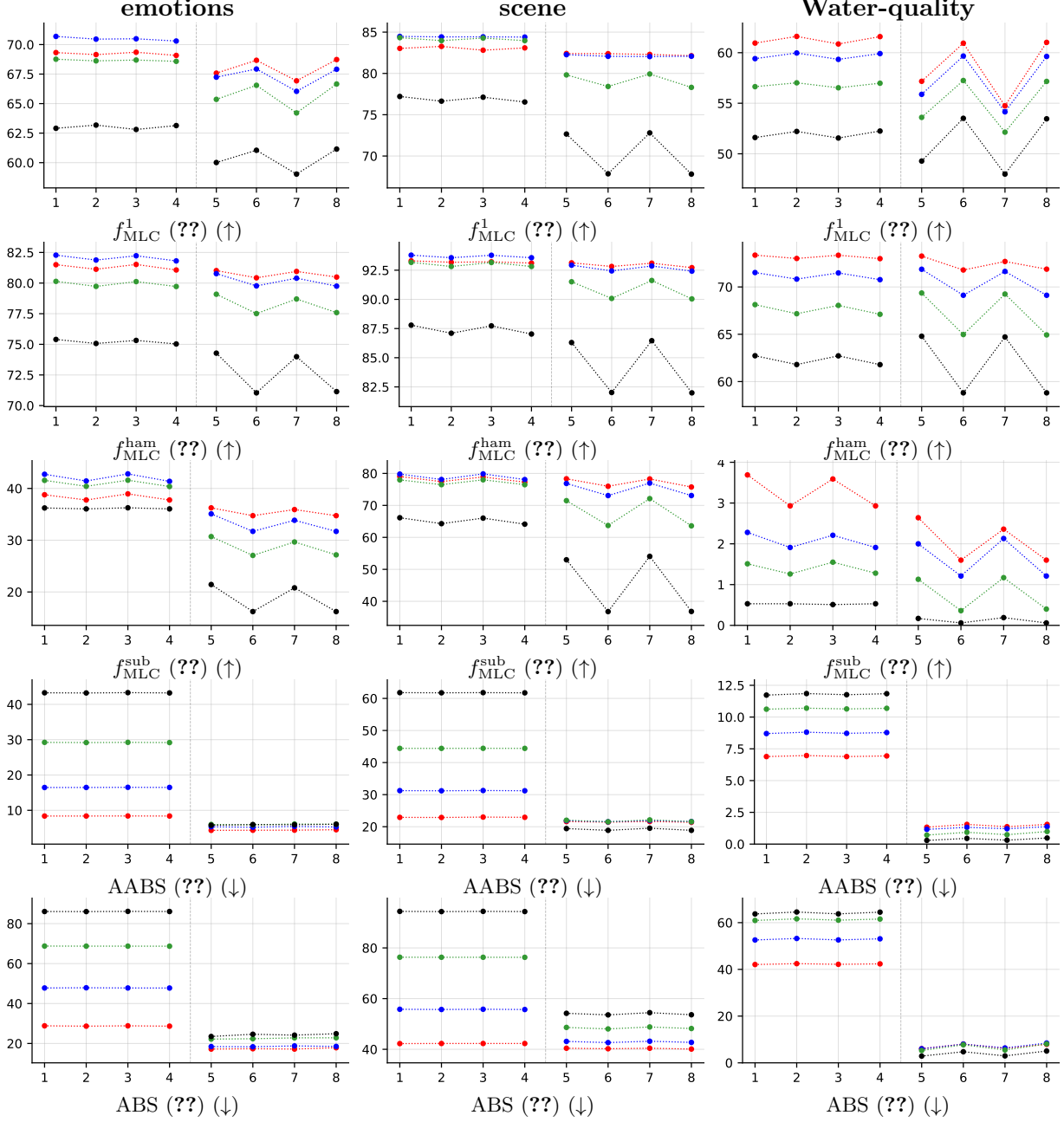


Table 8: (Table G5) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

### 3.3.3 Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector)

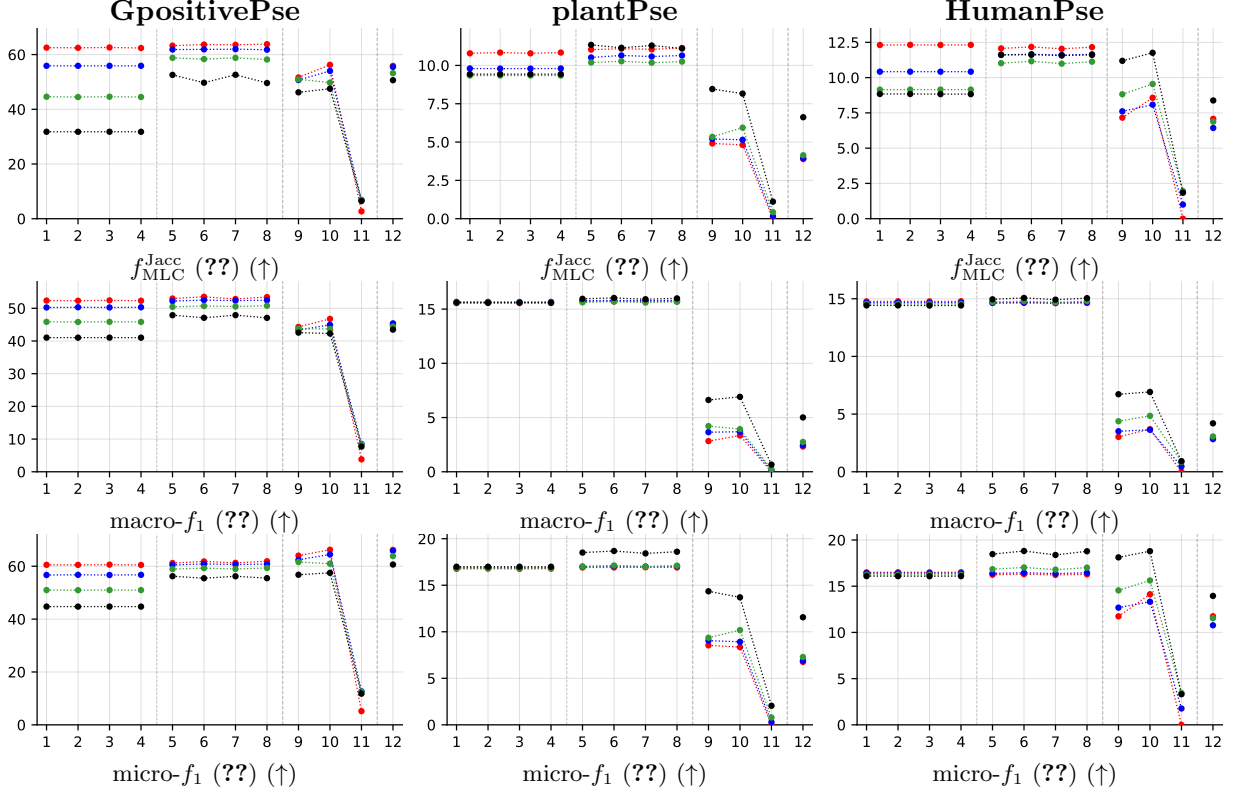


Table 9: (Table G6, new metrics — main datasets) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

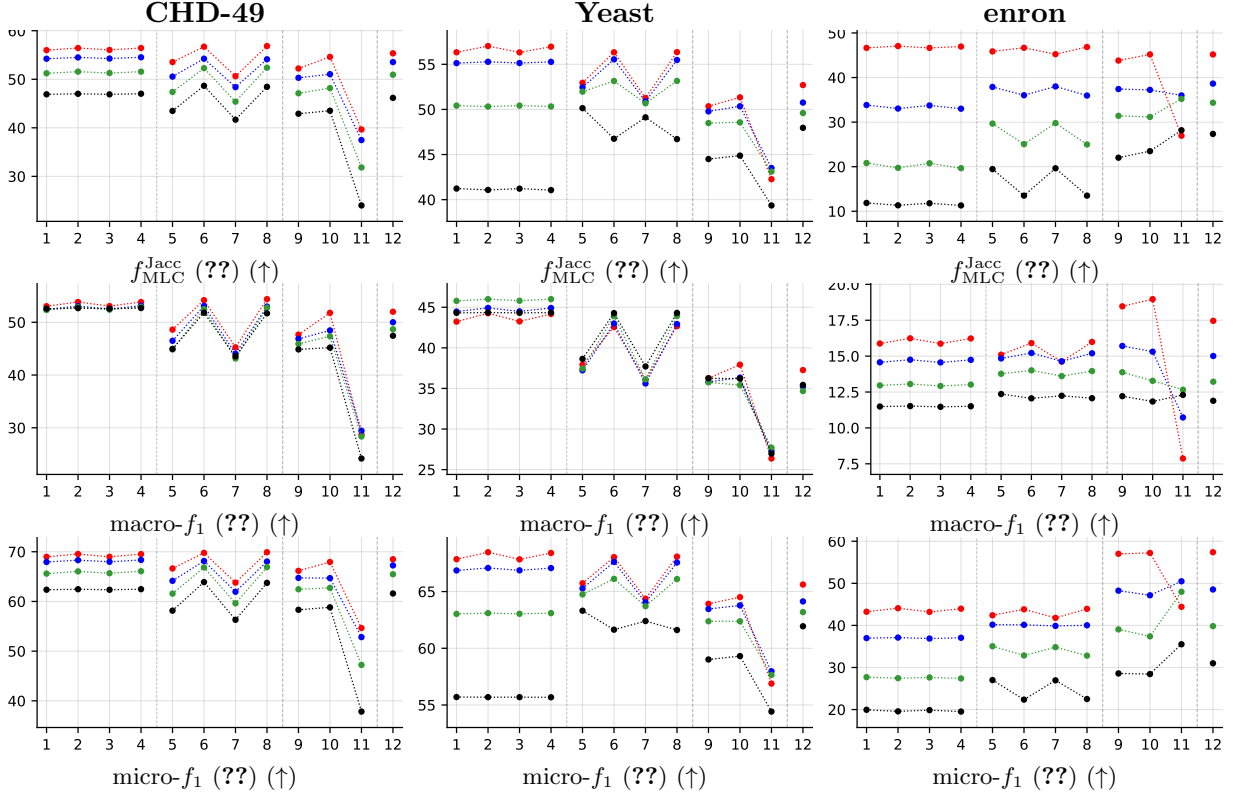


Table 10: (Table G6, new metrics — imbalanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

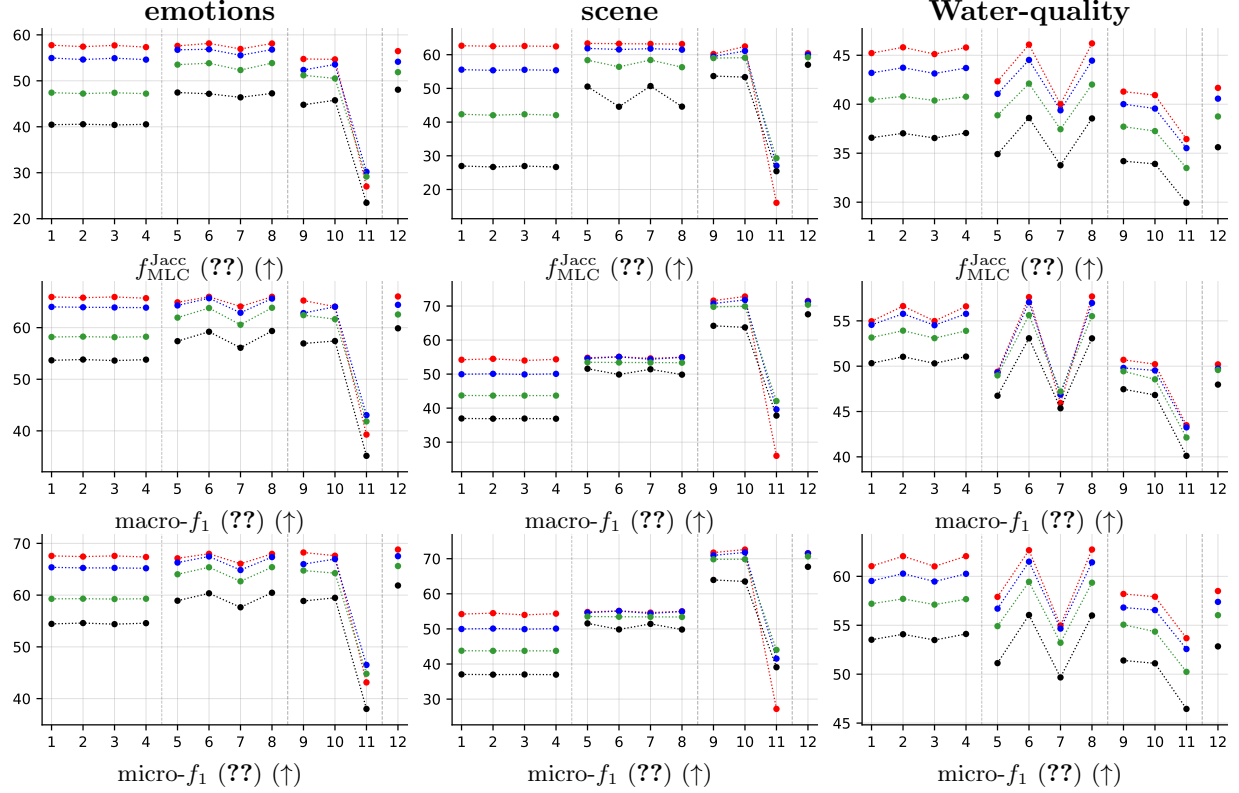


Table 11: (Table G6, new metrics — balanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .



### 3.3.4 Partial abstention (PartialAbstention)

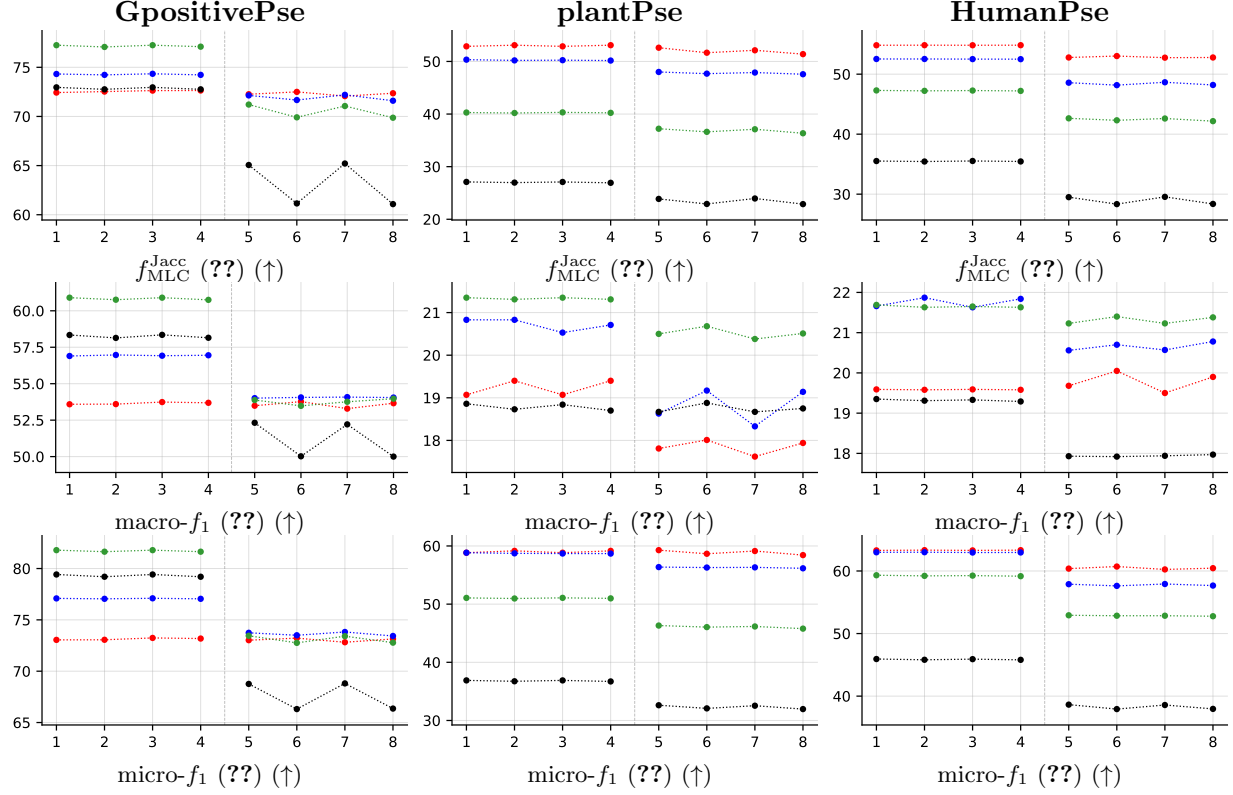


Table 12: (Table G7, new metrics — main datasets) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

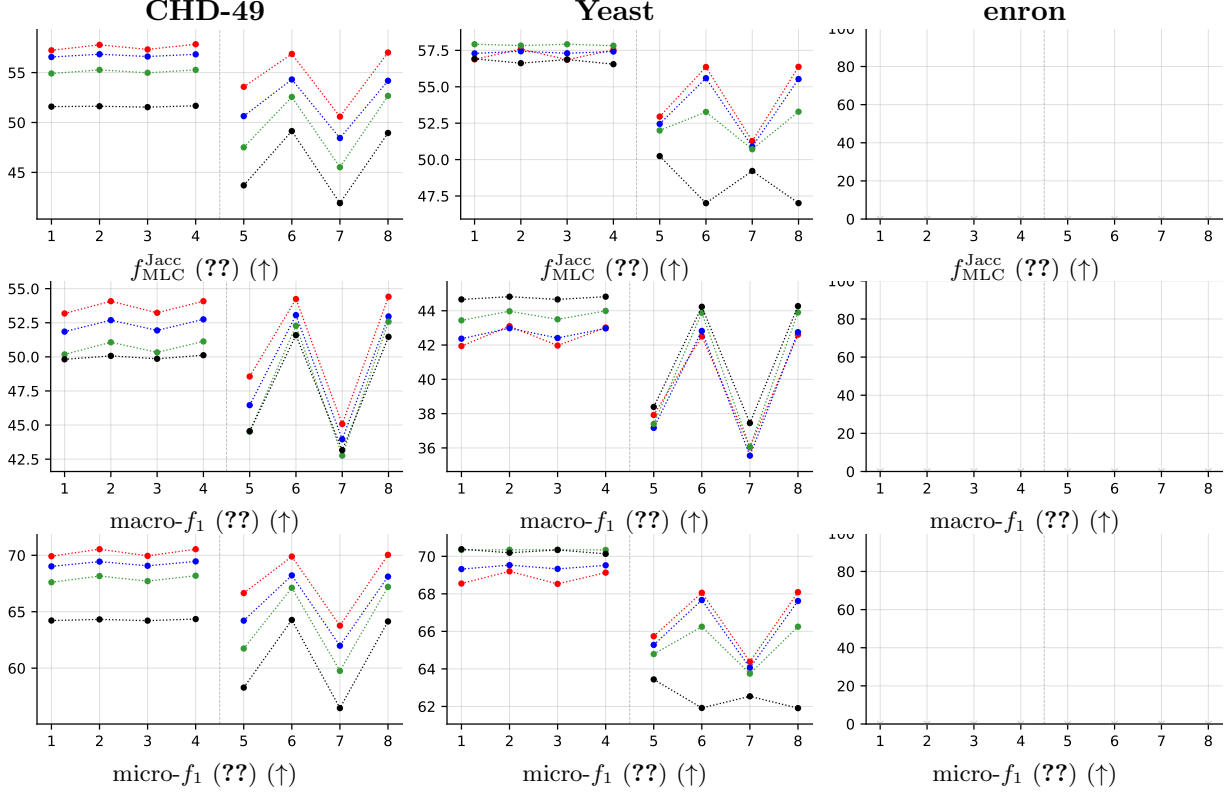


Table 13: (Table G7, new metrics — imbalanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

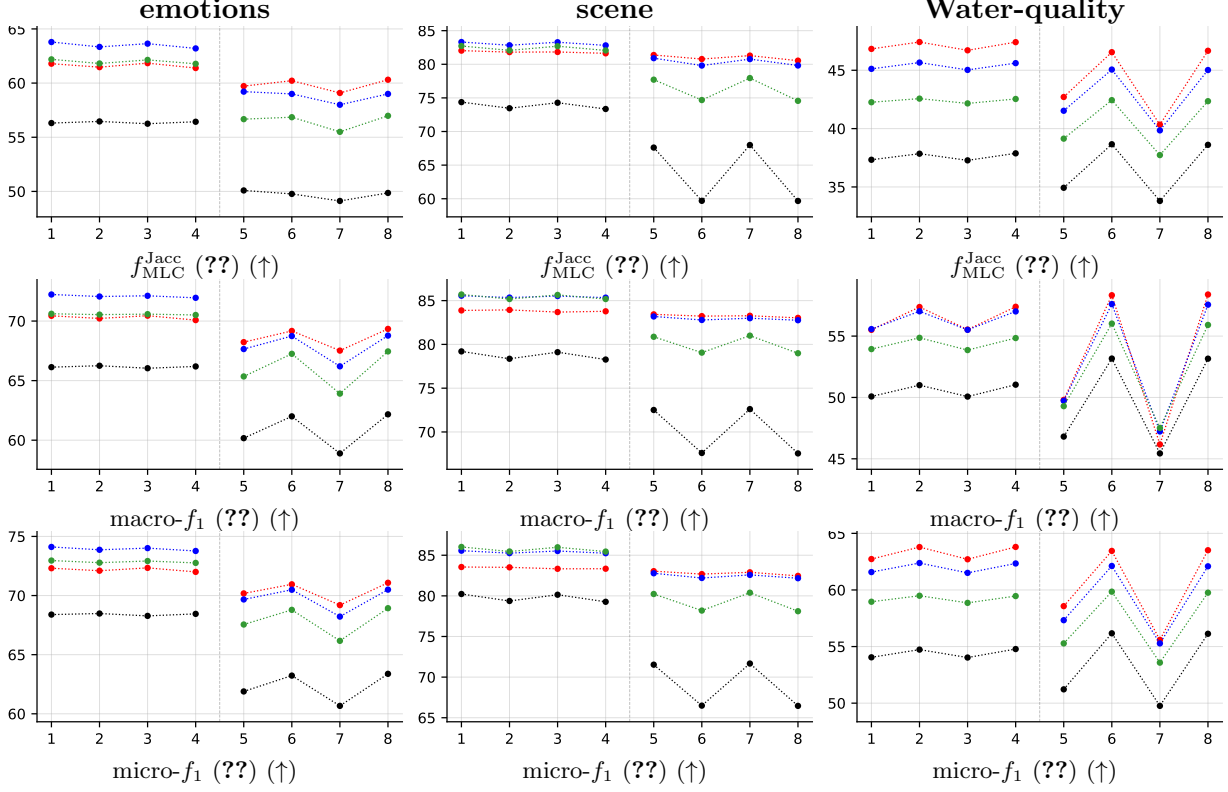


Table 14: (Table G7, new metrics — balanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

### 3.4 Abstention overview: aggregate trends

**Purpose.** This compact section shows the headline abstention-vs-standard-MLC trend across noise levels, averaged over all datasets, for both base learners (RF, LGBM) and both retained quality metrics ( $f_1$ , Jaccard). Use it as a quick visual summary before diving into the detailed per-method / per-dataset figures in Section 5.

**How to read.** In each panel: blue bar = standard MLC (no abstention) on its native quality metric; coloured bar = with-abstention quality on retained labels. Green “+ $x.y$ ” label = score-point gain of abstention over the standard-MLC bar of the same method. The four sub-panels per figure correspond to  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ .

RF averaged across all datasets: abstention vs. standard MLC --- 4x3 grid

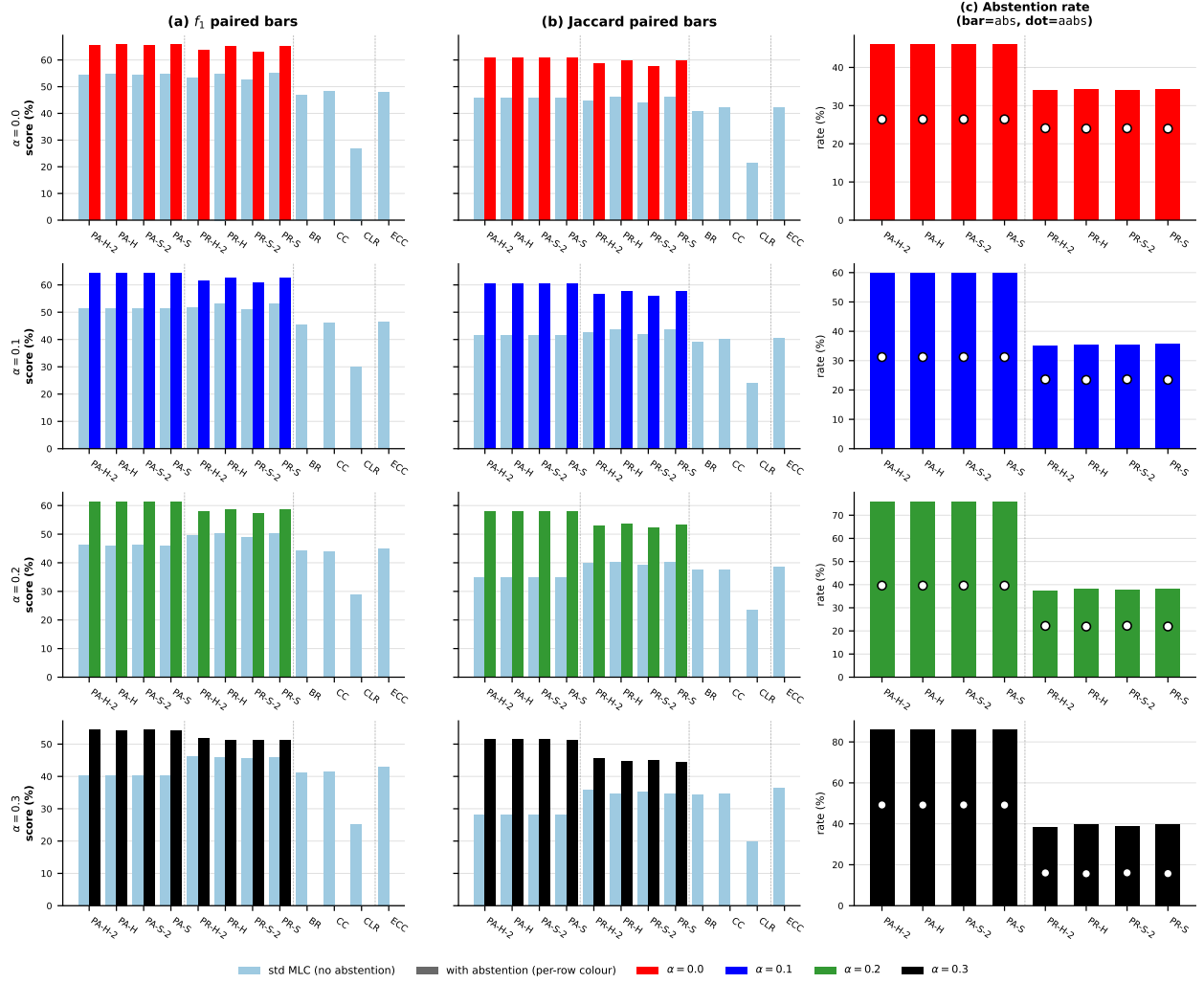


Figure 1: Figure 1: RF averaged across all datasets — table-shaped 4 x 3 grid: rows =  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ , columns = ((a)  $f_1$  paired bars, (b) Jaccard paired bars, (c) abstention rate). Light blue = standard MLC,  $\alpha$ -coloured = with-abstention; in (c), bar = abs (instance-level), dot = aabs (per-cell). Color =  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ .

LGBM averaged across all datasets: abstention vs.\ standard MLC --- 4×3 grid

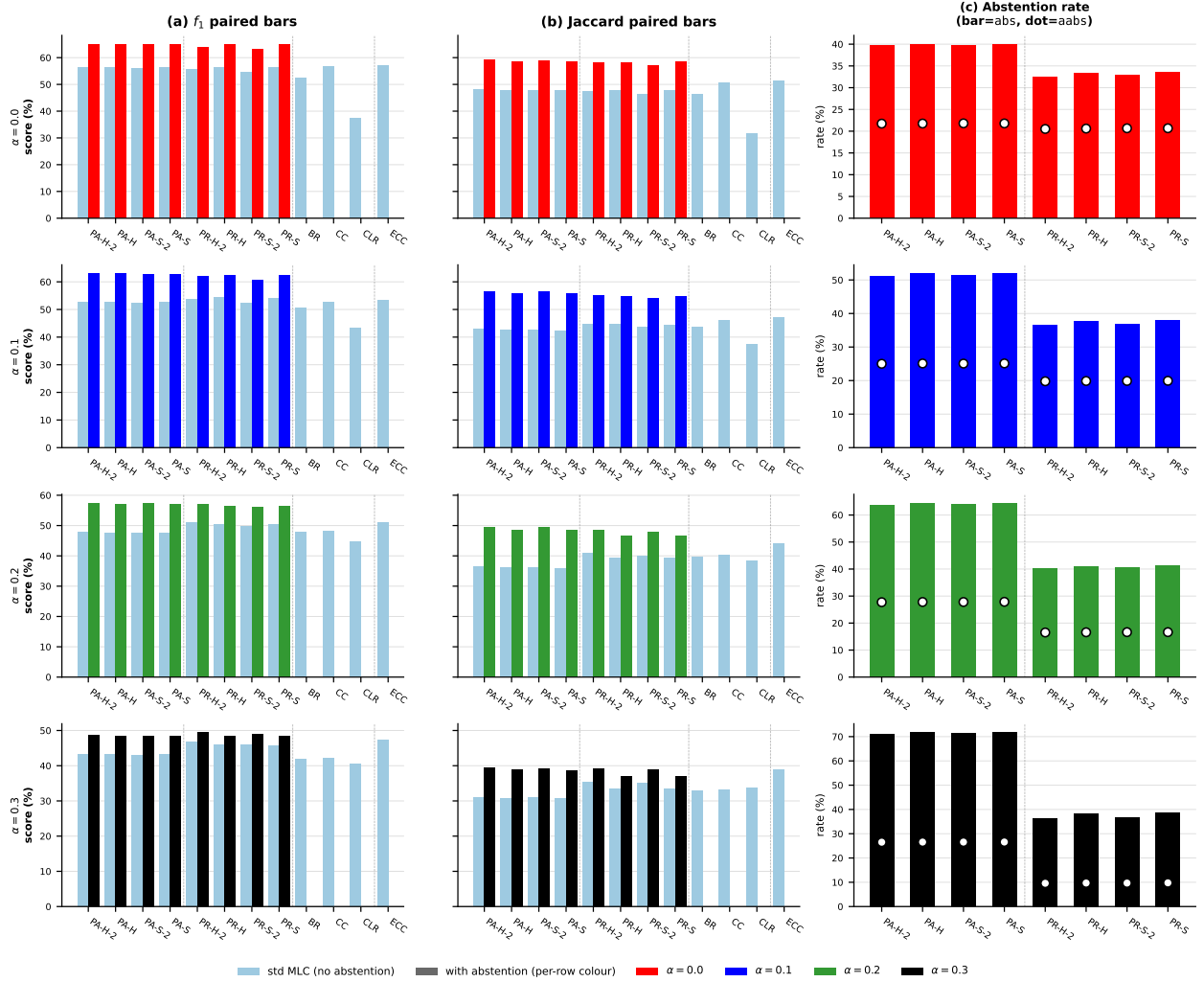


Figure 2: Figure 1: LGBM averaged across all datasets — table-shaped  $4 \times 3$  grid: rows =  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ , columns = ((a)  $f_1$  paired bars, (b) Jaccard paired bars, (c) abstention rate). Light blue = standard MLC,  $\alpha$ -coloured = with-abstention; in (c), bar = abs (instance-level), dot = aabs (per-cell). Color =  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ .

## 4 Main results: RF base learner, aggregated

RF • Aggregate • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions

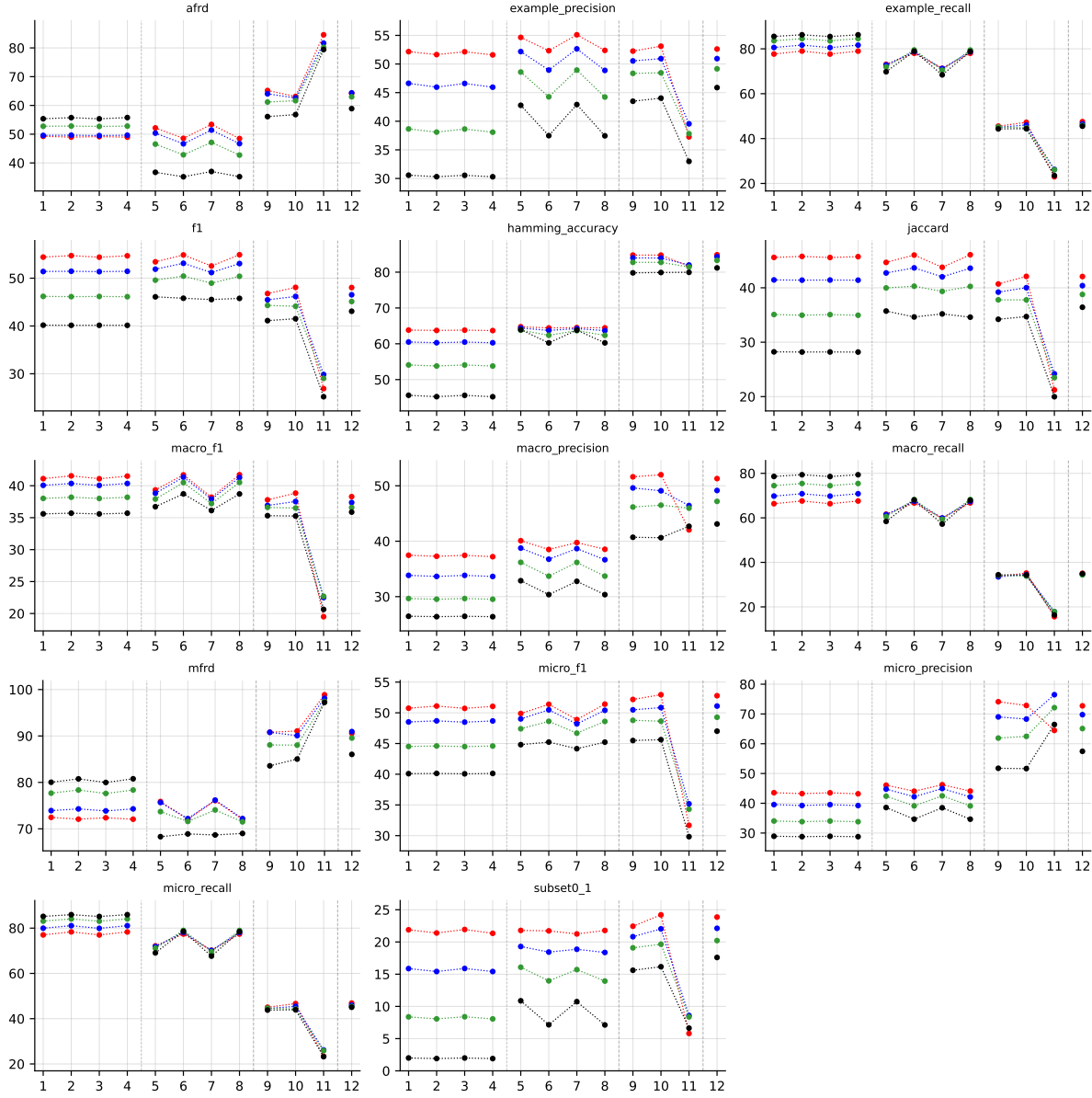


Table 15: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector), RF base learner, averaged across datasets. Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.

RF • Aggregate • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention

RF • Aggregate • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

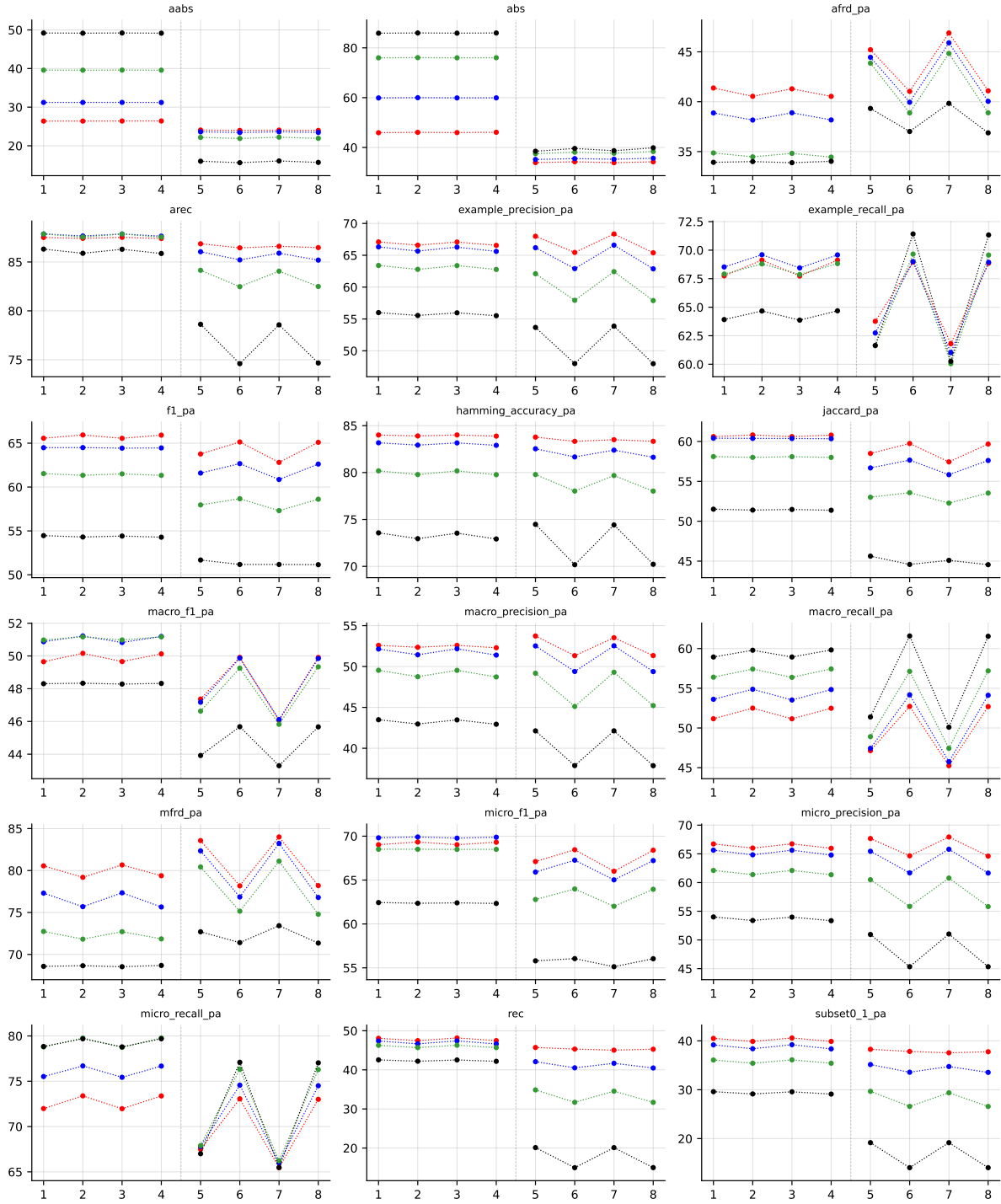


Table 16: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention), RF base learner, averaged across datasets. Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.

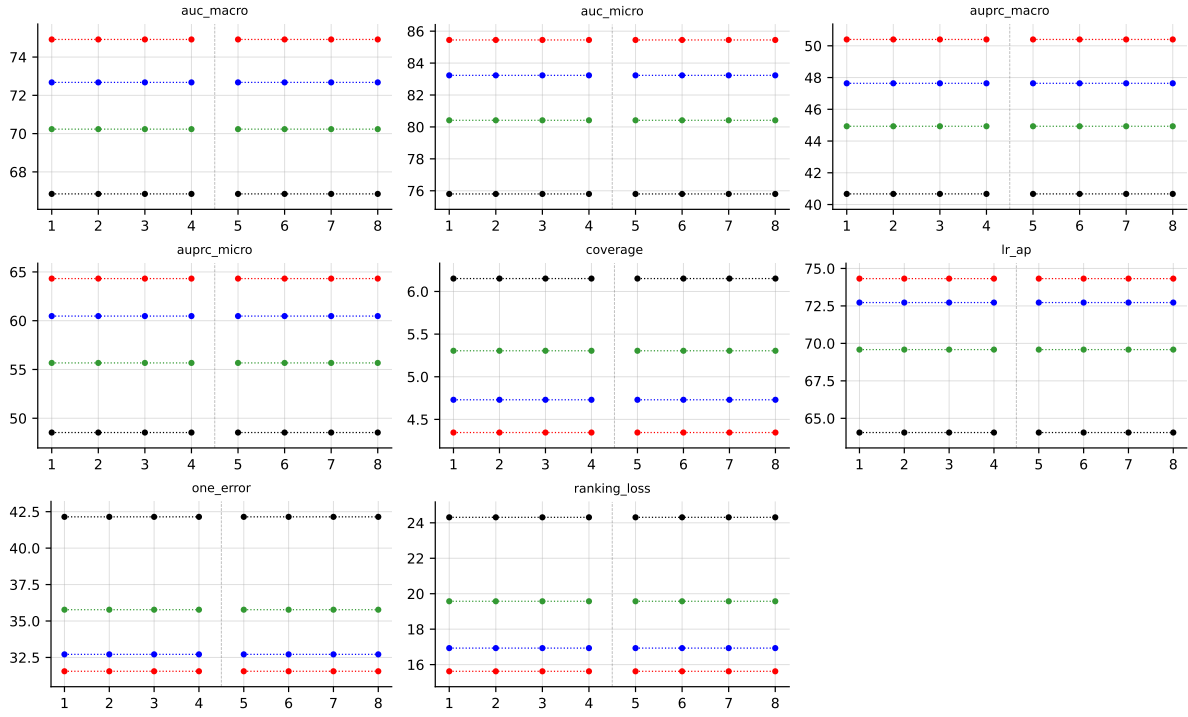


Table 17: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector), RF base learner, averaged across datasets. Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.



## 5 Abstention vs standard MLC

**Why this section exists.** The paper’s central claim is that an order-based predictor can *abstain* on labels it is unsure about and, on the labels it does predict, achieve higher quality than a standard MLC method that is forced to predict every label. The two chart families below make that claim visible.

**Terminology.** ‘*Standard MLC*’ (a.k.a. **BinaryVector** / BV) means each method outputs a 0/1 prediction for every one of the  $K$  labels. ‘*With abstention*’ (a.k.a. **PartialAbstention** / PA) means an order-based predictor may return  $\perp$  (abstain) on some labels; the PA quality metrics (**f1\_pa**, **jaccard\_pa**, ...) are computed only over the non-abstained labels. Only the 8 PA/PR methods (indices 1–8) can abstain; BR/CC/CLR/ECC cannot.

**Reading the coverage-risk chart.** Each point is one (PA/PR method, noise level  $\alpha$ ) pair. The x-axis is the abstention rate (fraction of labels the method skipped); the y-axis is the quality metric on the labels that *were* predicted (higher is better). Marker shape encodes method, colour encodes noise level. The dashed grey line is the best standard-MLC baseline (BR / CC / CLR / ECC) on the BV quality metric — it is the bar that “no abstention” has to clear. **Any point above the dashed line is direct evidence that abstaining improved quality beyond what any standard MLC method achieves.** Points further right traded coverage for that gain.

**Reading the paired-bars chart.** Same data, different view. The four sub-panels correspond to the four noise levels. Inside each sub-panel: 12 method positions, two bars per position — blue is the standard-MLC quality (**f1**, no abstention), warm-colour is the with-abstention quality on retained labels. Only the 8 PA/PR methods (1–8) have a warm bar; the standard MLC baselines (9–12) only have a blue bar by construction. The green “+ $x.y$ ” label above each warm bar is the gain in score-points over that method’s own BV bar.

### 5.1 RF, metric f1\_pa — aggregate



Figure 3: RF (**f1\_pa**) averaged across all datasets: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

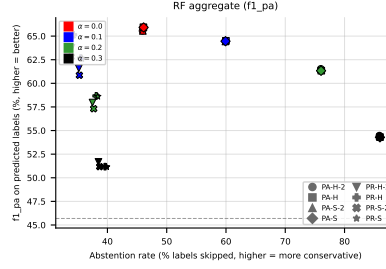


Figure 4: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) averaged across all datasets: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 5: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) averaged across all datasets: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).



Figure 6: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) averaged across all datasets — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x$  = coverage =  $1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.2 RF, metric $f1_{pa}$ — per dataset



Figure 7: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

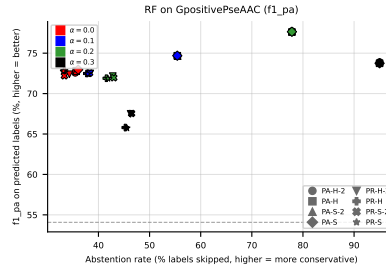


Figure 8: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 9: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

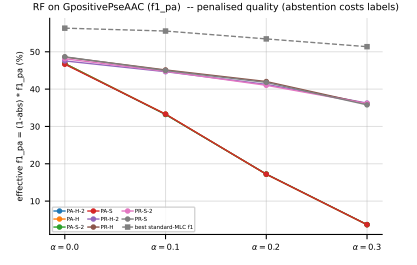
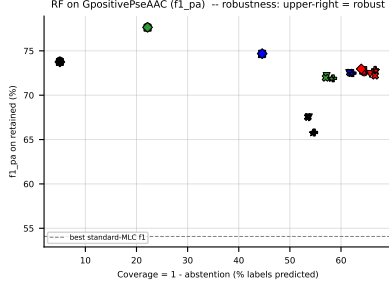


Figure 10: RF (f1\_pa) on GpositivePseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x$  = coverage =  $1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective f1\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

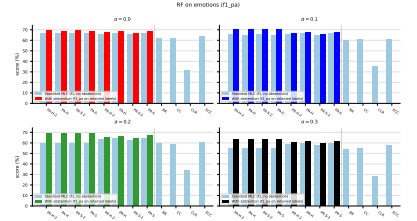
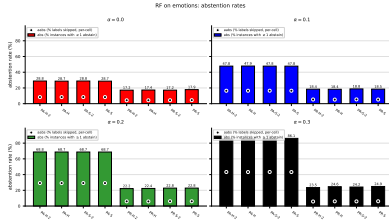


Figure 11: RF (f1\_pa) on emotions: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

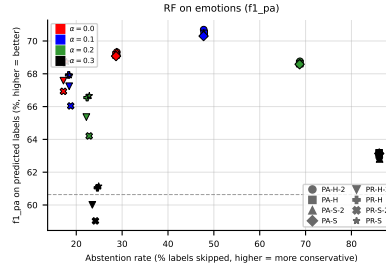


Figure 12: RF (f1\_pa) on emotions: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

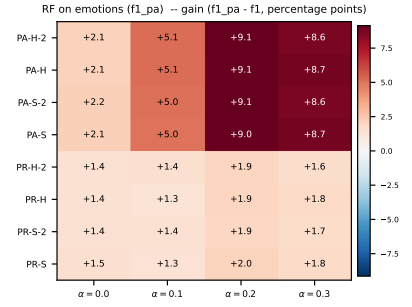
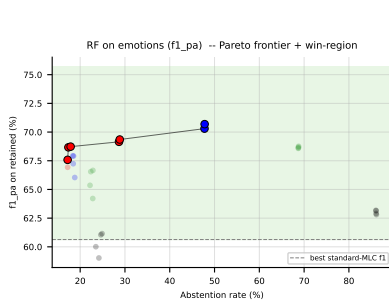


Figure 13: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

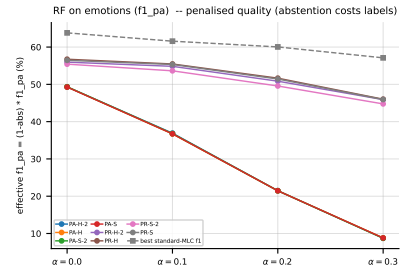
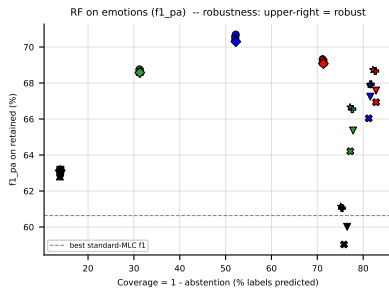


Figure 14: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

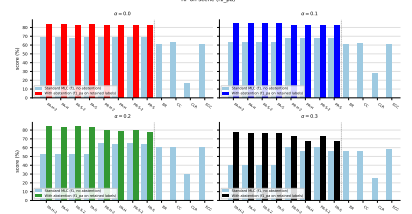
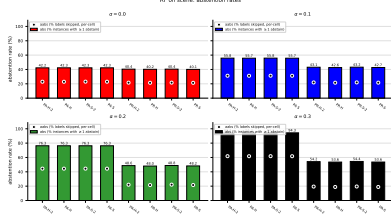


Figure 15: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

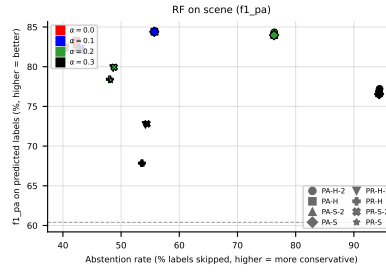


Figure 16: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

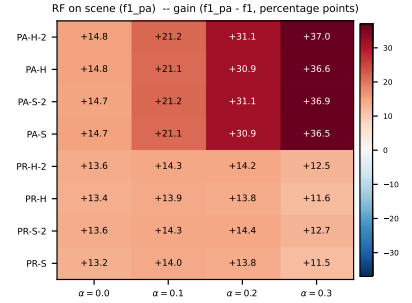
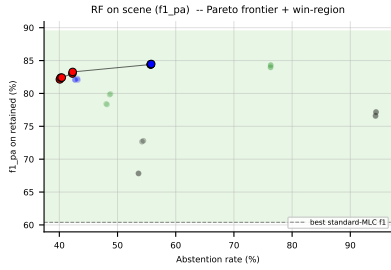


Figure 17: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

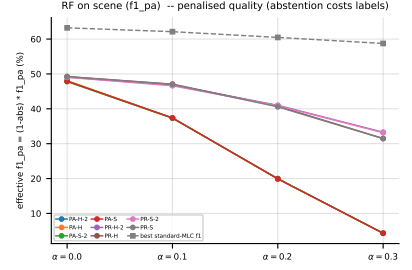
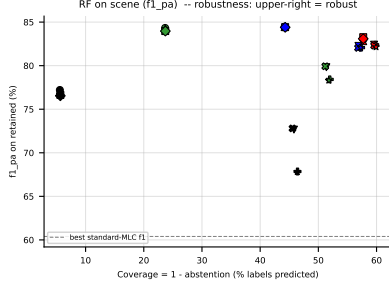


Figure 18: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on **scene** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective f1<sub>pa</sub> =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

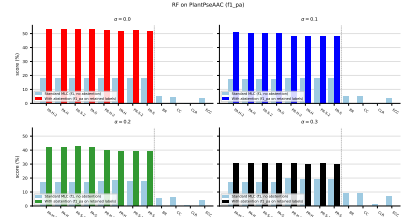
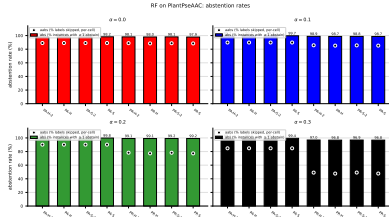


Figure 19: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on **PlantPseAAC**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

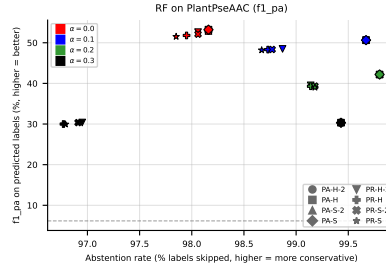


Figure 20: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on **PlantPseAAC**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

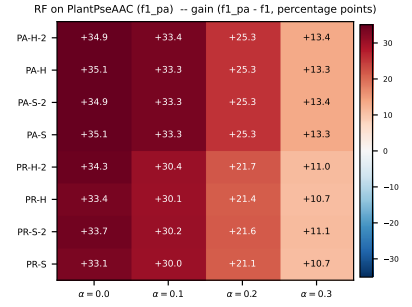
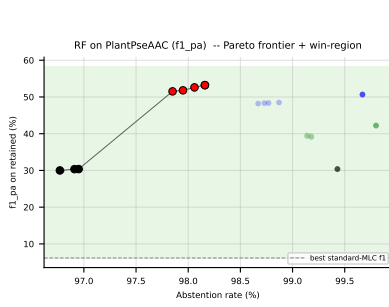


Figure 21: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on PlantPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

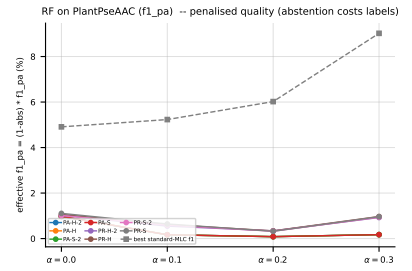
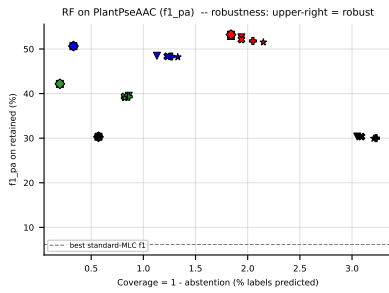


Figure 22: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on PlantPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.



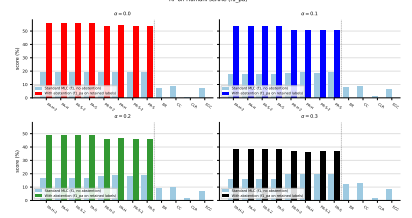
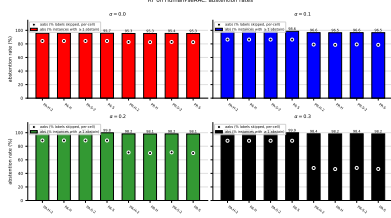


Figure 23: RF ( $f_{1\_pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

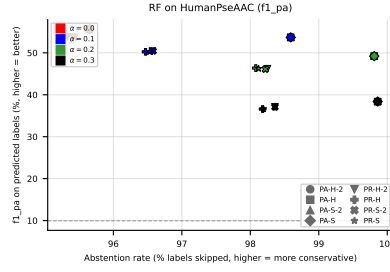


Figure 24: RF ( $f_{1\_pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

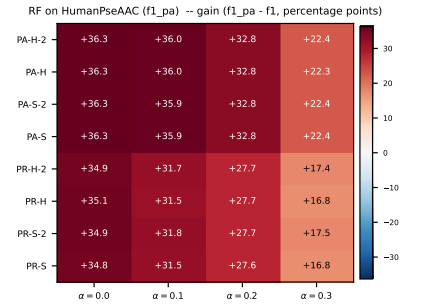
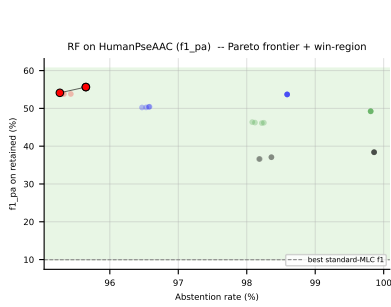


Figure 25: RF ( $f_{1\_pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f_{1\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

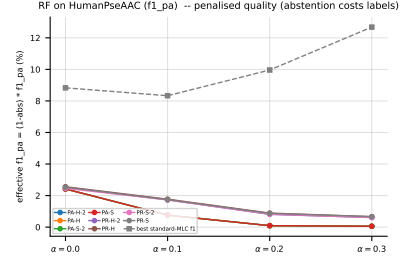
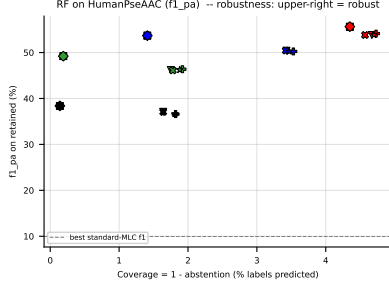


Figure 26: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **HumanPseAAC** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

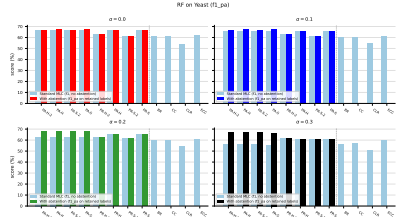
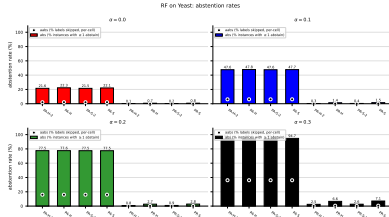


Figure 27: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Yeast**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

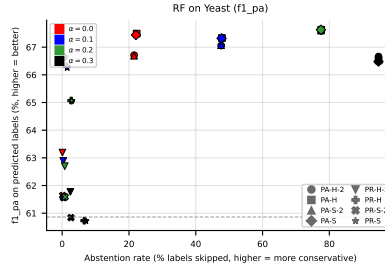


Figure 28: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Yeast**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 29: RF (f1\_pa) on Yeast: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1\_pa - f1$ ) heatmap (right).



Figure 30: RF (f1\_pa) on Yeast — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1\_pa = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

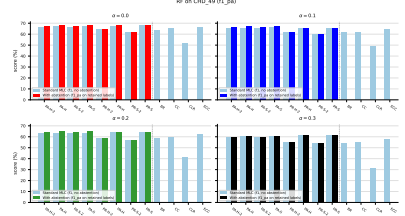
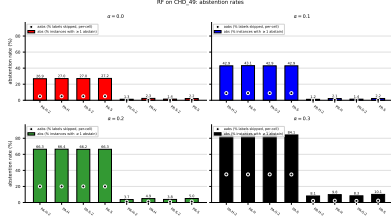


Figure 31: RF ( $f1\_pa$ ) on CHD\_49: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

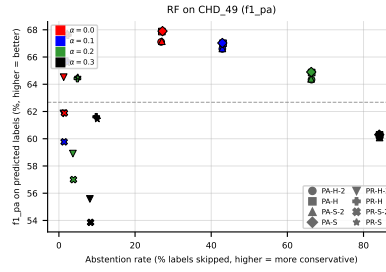


Figure 32: RF ( $f1\_pa$ ) on CHD\_49: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

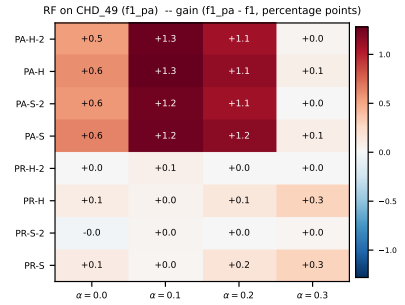
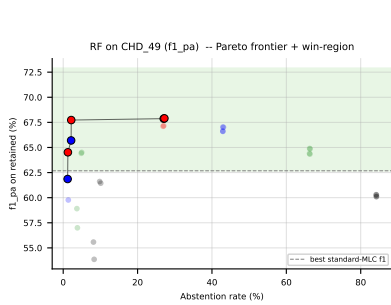


Figure 33: RF ( $f1\_pa$ ) on CHD\_49: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1\_pa - f1$ , percentage points) heatmap (right).

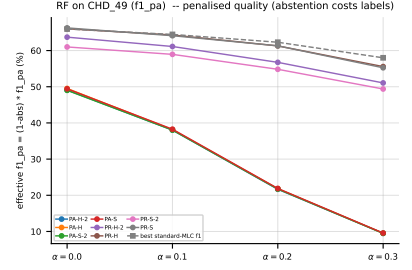
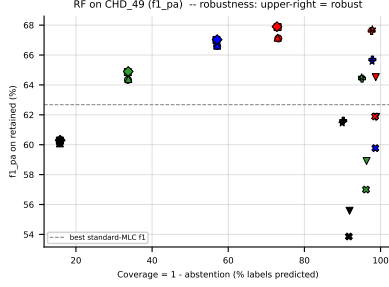


Figure 34: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on CHD<sub>49</sub> — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective f1<sub>pa</sub> =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

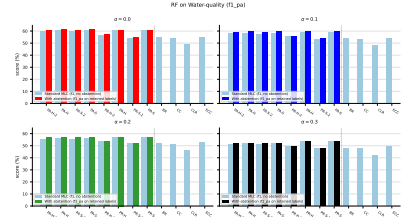
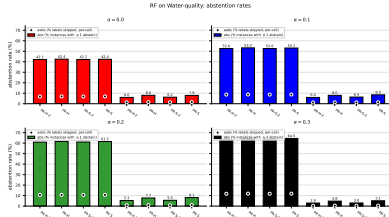


Figure 35: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on Water-quality: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

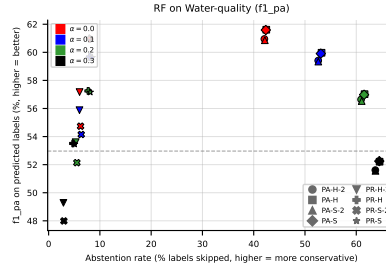


Figure 36: RF (f1<sub>pa</sub>) on Water-quality: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

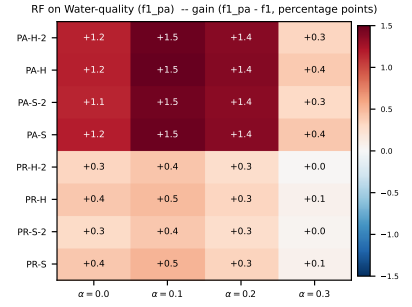
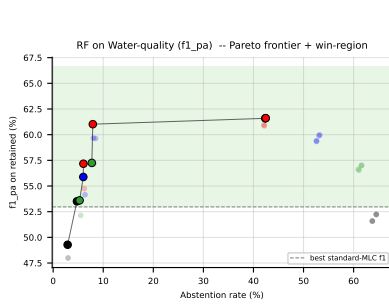


Figure 37: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on Water-quality: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

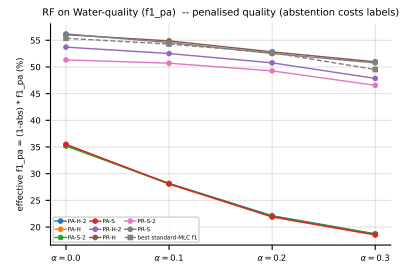
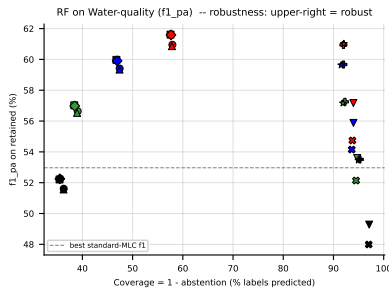


Figure 38: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on Water-quality — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

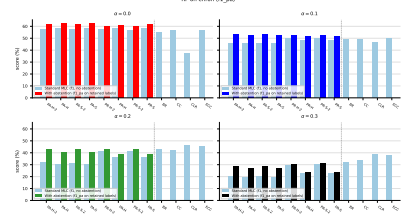
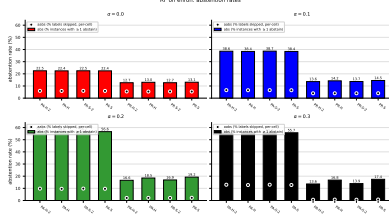


Figure 39: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **enron**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

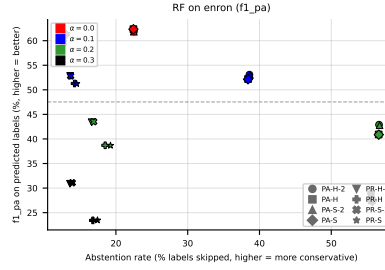


Figure 40: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **enron**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

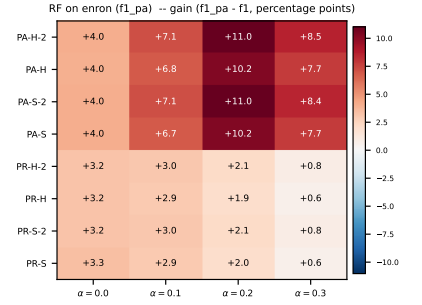
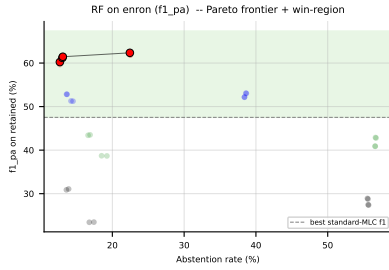


Figure 41: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **enron**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

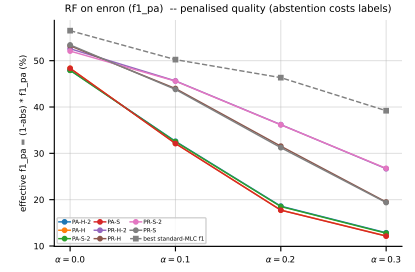
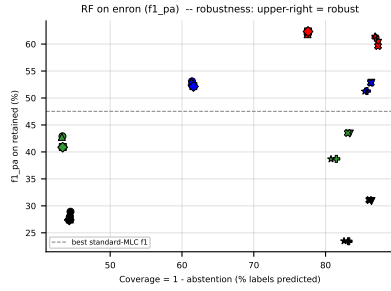


Figure 42: RF ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **enron** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.



### 5.3 RF, metric jaccard\_pa — aggregate



Figure 43: RF (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

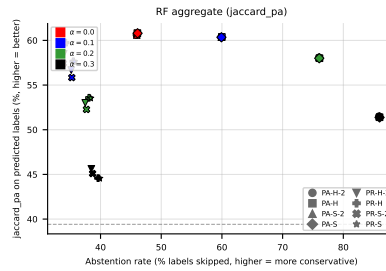


Figure 44: RF (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 45: RF (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

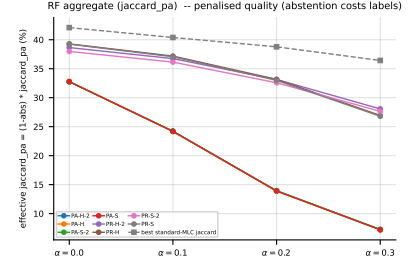
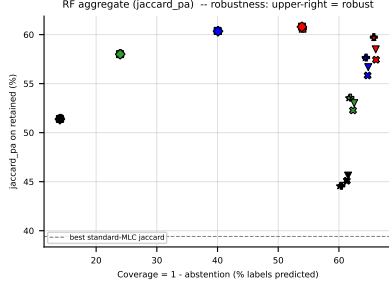


Figure 46: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) averaged across all datasets — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard<sub>pa</sub> =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard}_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.4 RF, metric jaccard<sub>pa</sub> — per dataset

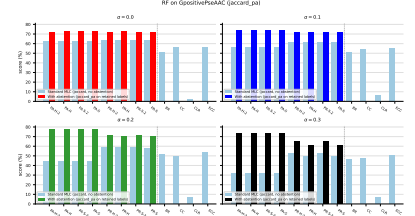
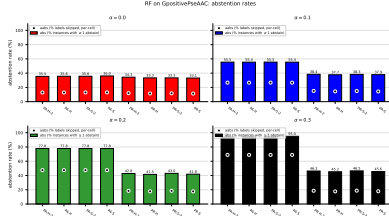


Figure 47: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on GpositivePseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

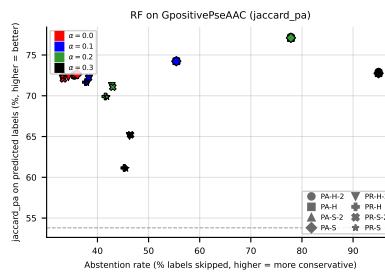


Figure 48: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on GpositivePseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

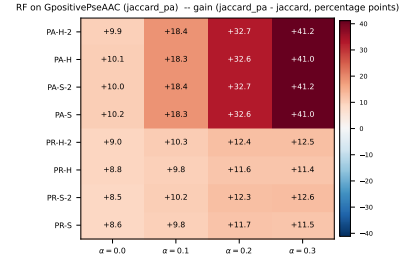
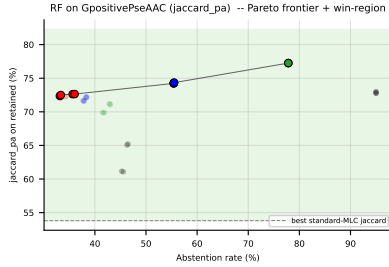


Figure 49: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on GpositivePseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain (jaccard<sub>pa</sub> −  $f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

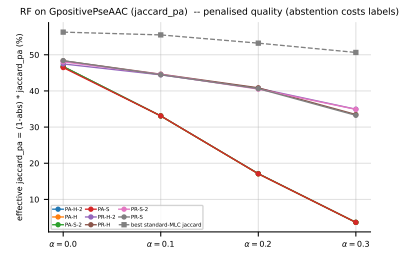
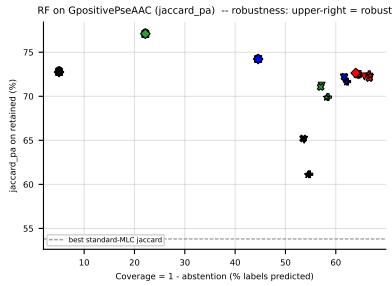


Figure 50: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on GpositivePseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter (x = coverage = 1 − abs); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard<sub>pa</sub> = (1 − abs) · jaccard<sub>pa</sub>, i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

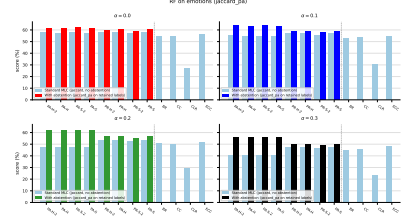
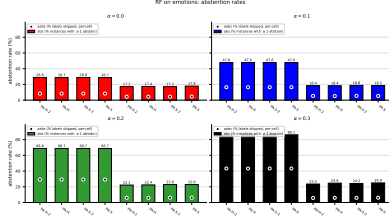


Figure 51: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

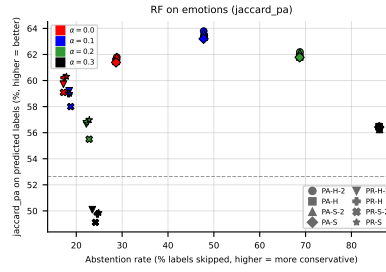


Figure 52: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

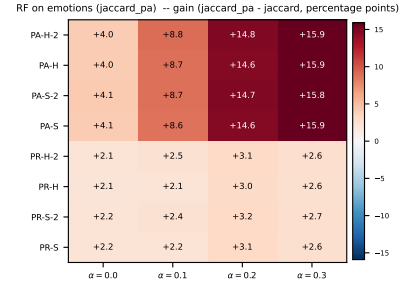
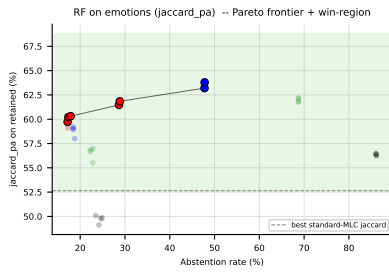


Figure 53: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

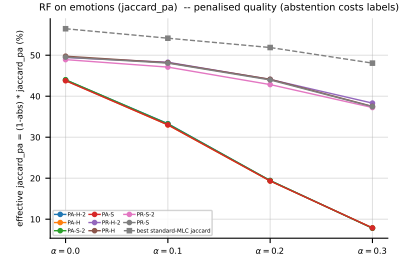
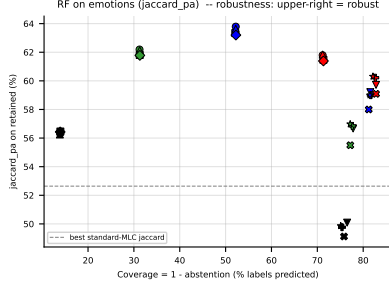


Figure 54: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

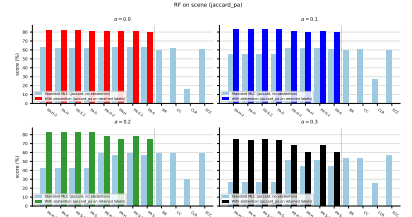
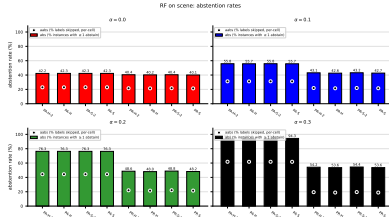


Figure 55: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **scene**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

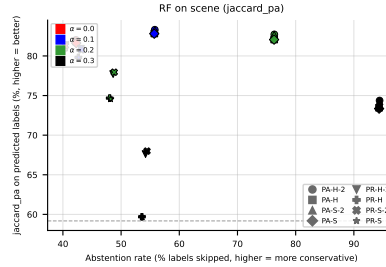


Figure 56: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **scene**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

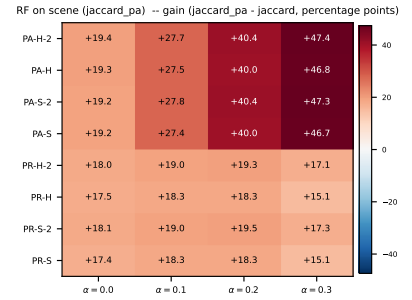
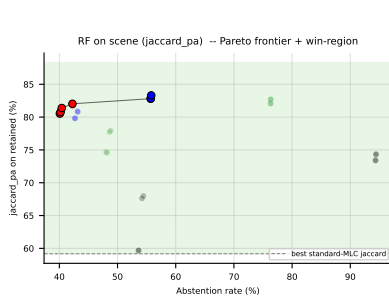


Figure 57: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **scene**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain (jaccard<sub>pa</sub> −  $f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

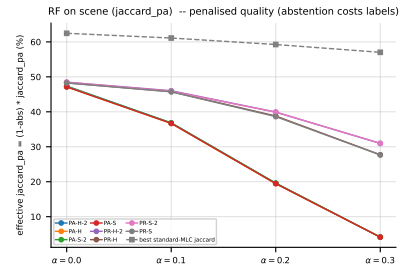
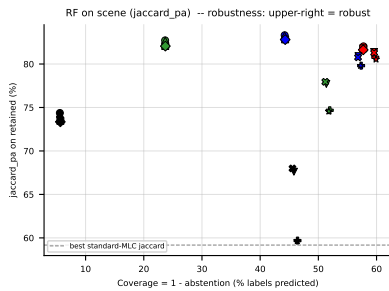


Figure 58: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **scene** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard<sub>pa</sub> =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard}_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

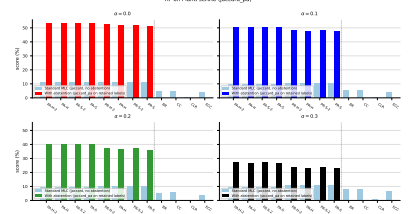
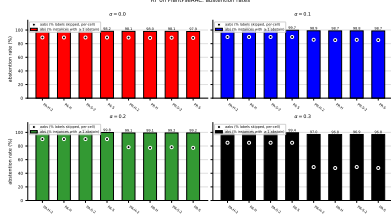


Figure 59: RF (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

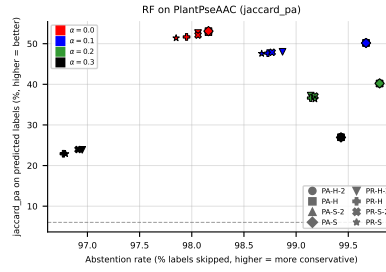


Figure 60: RF (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

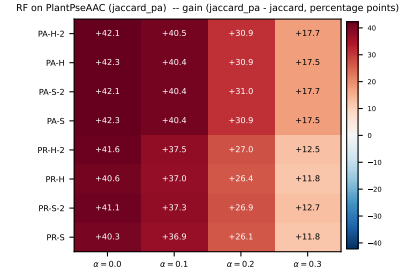
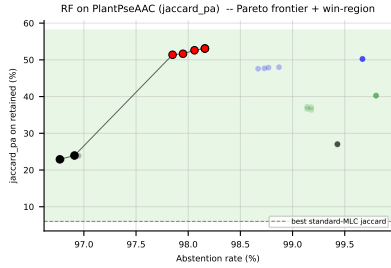


Figure 61: RF (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $jaccard\_pa - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

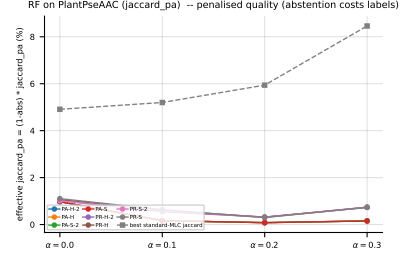
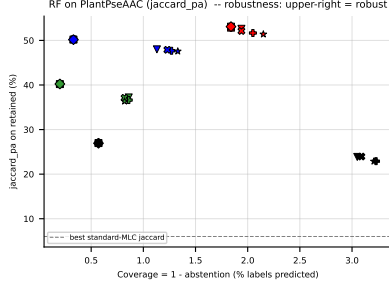


Figure 62: RF (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x$  = coverage =  $1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

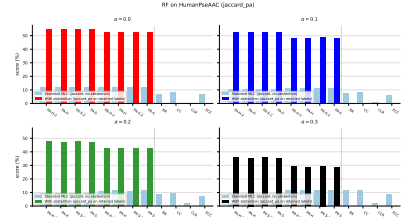
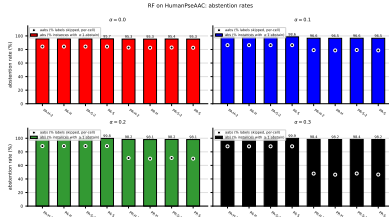


Figure 63: RF (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

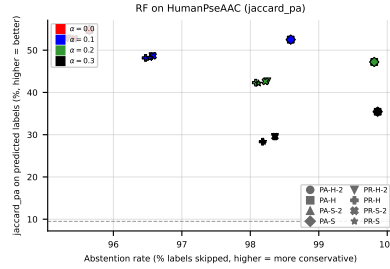


Figure 64: RF (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



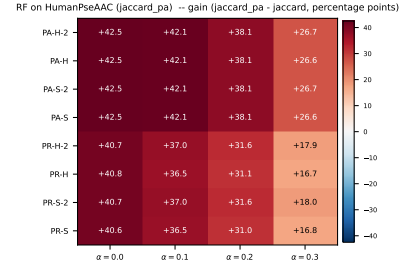
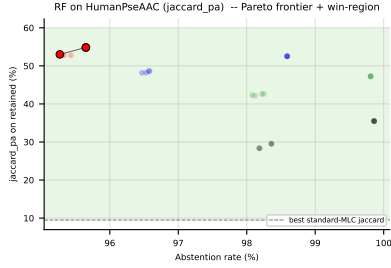


Figure 65: RF (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $jaccard\_pa - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

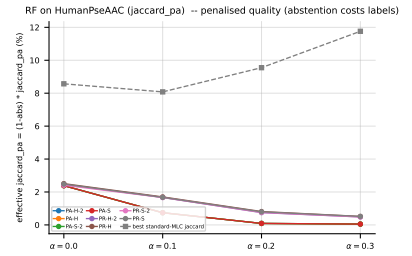
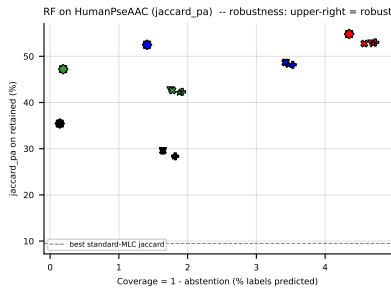


Figure 66: RF (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = coverage = 1 - abs$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - abs) \cdot jaccard\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

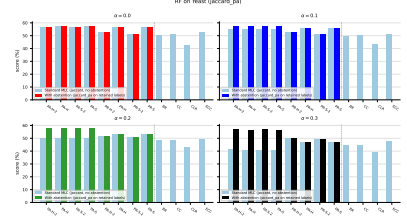
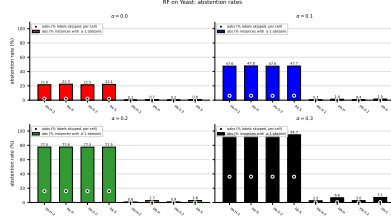


Figure 67: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

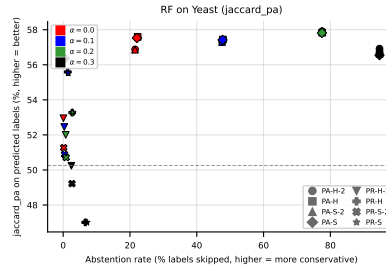


Figure 68: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

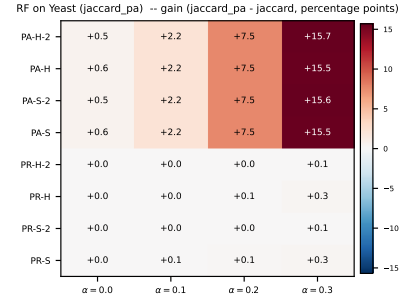
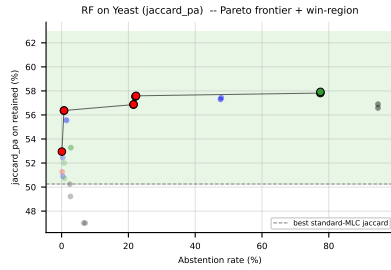


Figure 69: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

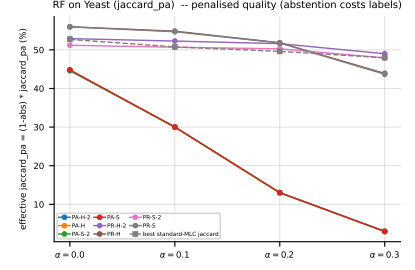
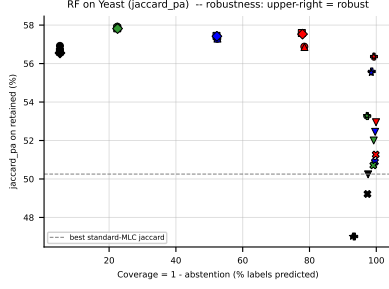


Figure 70: RF (jaccard\_pa) on Yeast — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

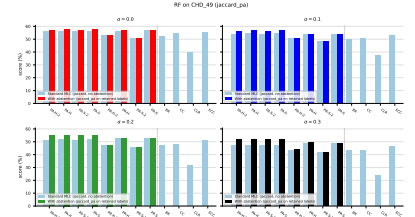
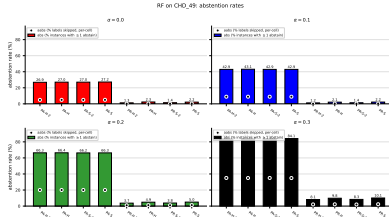


Figure 71: RF (jaccard\_pa) on CHD\_49: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

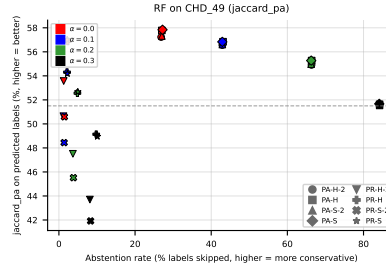


Figure 72: RF (jaccard\_pa) on CHD\_49: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

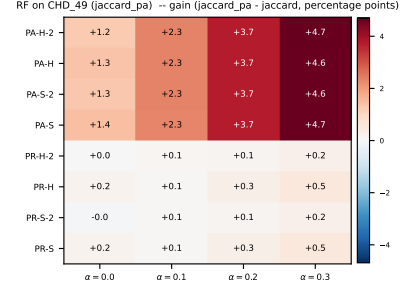
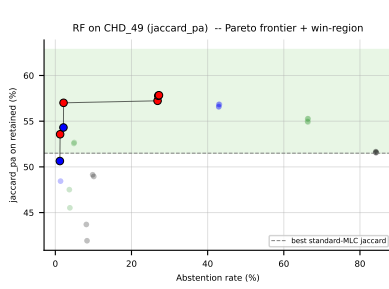


Figure 73: RF (jaccard.pa) on CHD\_49: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $jaccard.pa - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

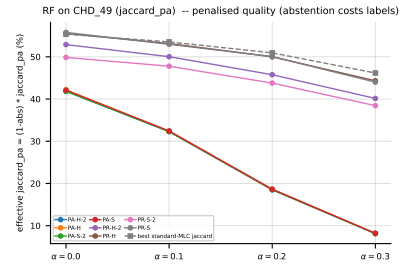
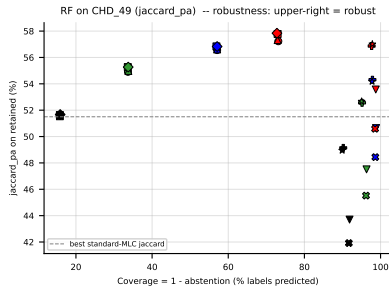


Figure 74: RF (jaccard.pa) on CHD\_49 — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard.pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot jaccard.pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

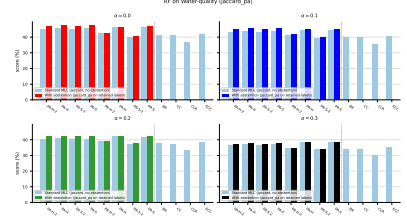
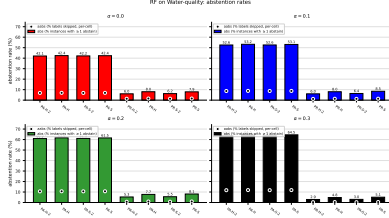


Figure 75: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

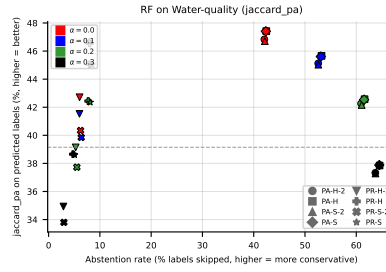


Figure 76: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

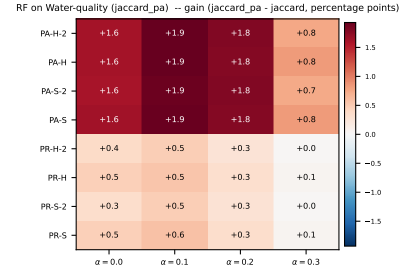
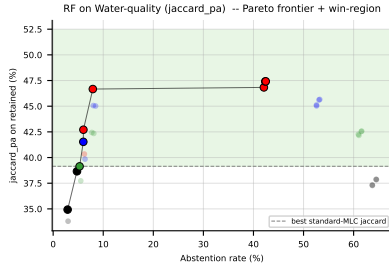


Figure 77: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

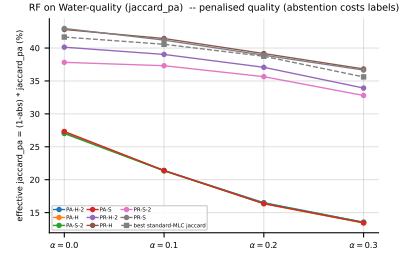
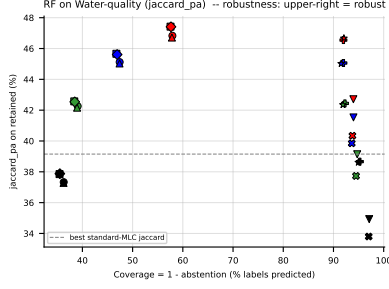


Figure 78: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **Water-quality** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter (x = coverage = 1 − abs); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard<sub>pa</sub> = (1 − abs) · jaccard<sub>pa</sub>, i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

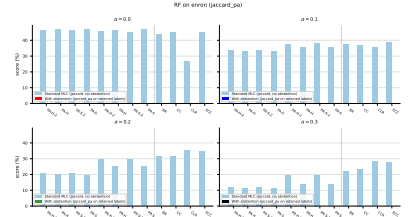
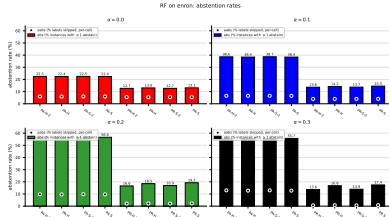


Figure 79: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **enron**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

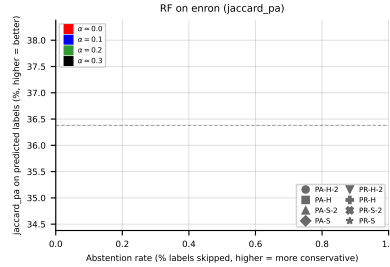


Figure 80: RF (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **enron**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 81: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **enron**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain (jaccard\_pa -  $f_1$ ) heatmap (right).



Figure 82: RF (jaccard\_pa) on **enron** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter (x = coverage = 1 - abs); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa = (1 - abs) · jaccard\_pa, i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.5 LGBM, metric f1\_pa — aggregate



Figure 83: LGBM (f1\_pa) averaged across all datasets: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

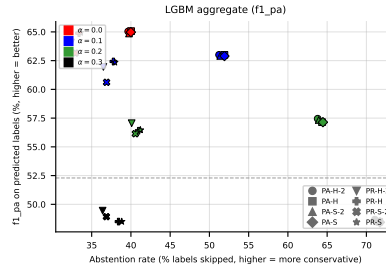


Figure 84: LGBM (f1\_pa) averaged across all datasets: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 85: LGBM (f1\_pa) averaged across all datasets: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1\_pa - f1$ ) heatmap (right).



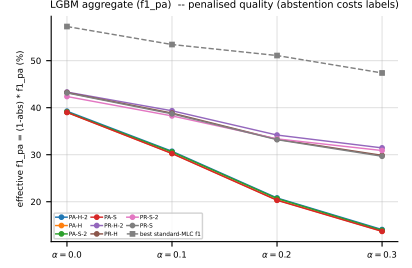
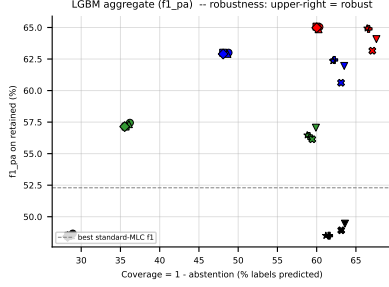


Figure 86: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) averaged across all datasets — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.6 LGBM, metric $f1_{pa}$ — per dataset

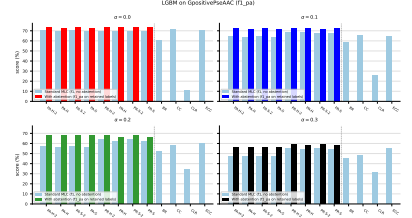
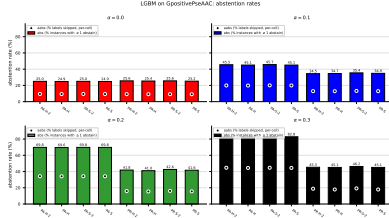


Figure 87: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

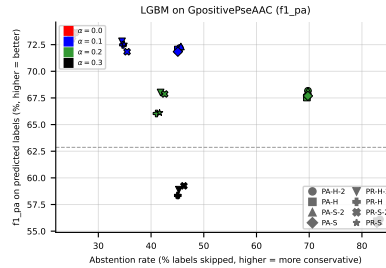


Figure 88: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 89: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).



Figure 90: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **GpositivePseAAC** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

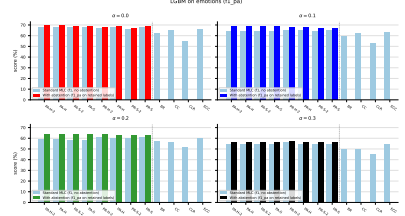
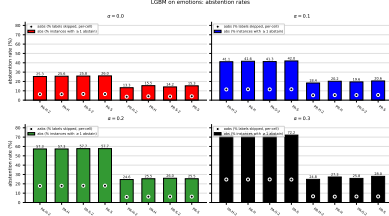


Figure 91: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

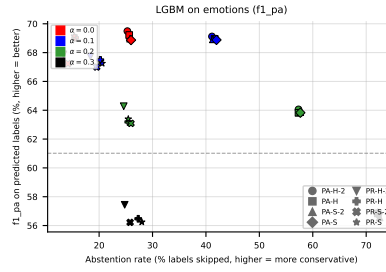


Figure 92: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

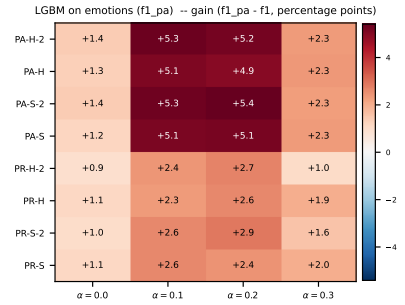
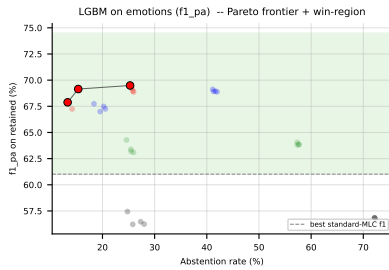


Figure 93: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

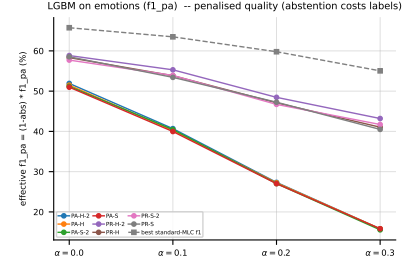
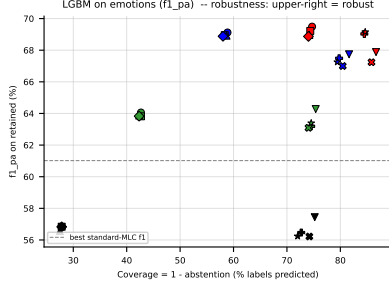


Figure 94: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **emotions** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

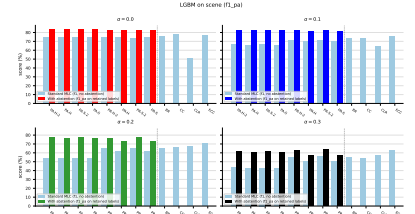
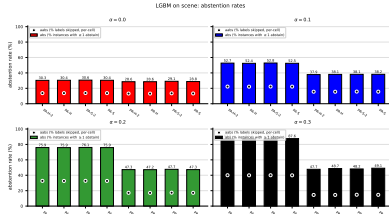


Figure 95: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

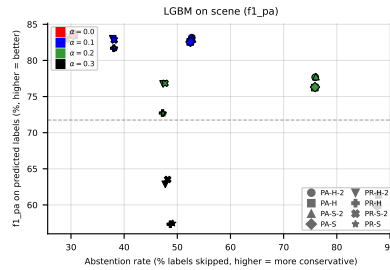


Figure 96: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

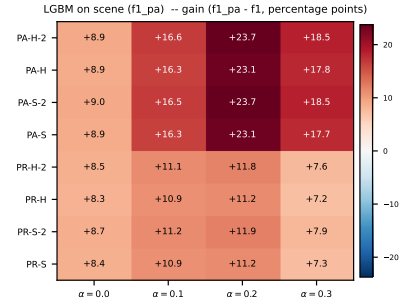
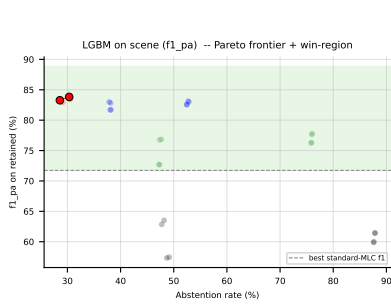


Figure 97: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

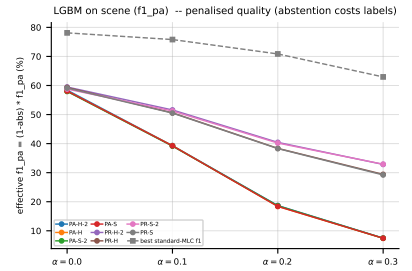
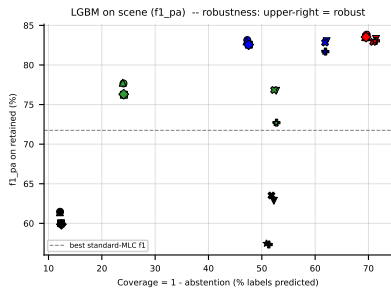


Figure 98: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **scene** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

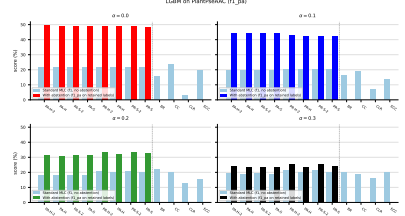
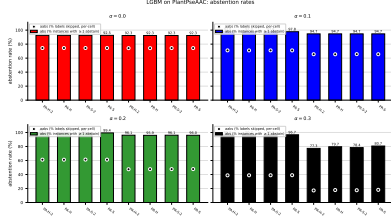


Figure 99: LGBM ( $f1\_pa$ ) on PlantPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

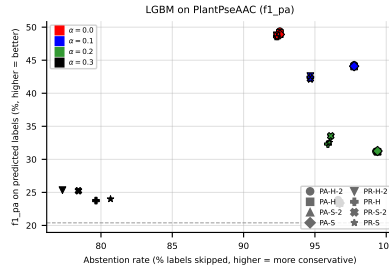


Figure 100: LGBM ( $f1\_pa$ ) on PlantPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

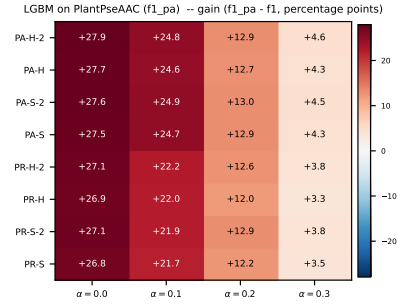
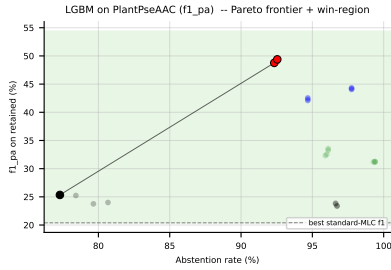


Figure 101: LGBM ( $f1\_pa$ ) on PlantPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1\_pa - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

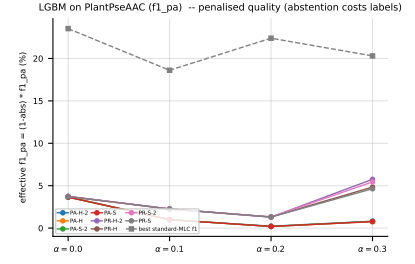
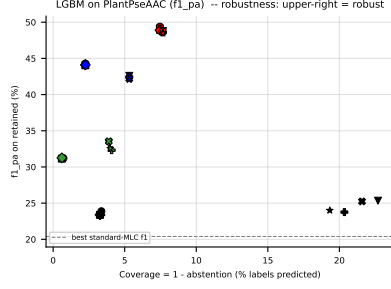


Figure 102: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on PlantPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x$  = coverage =  $1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

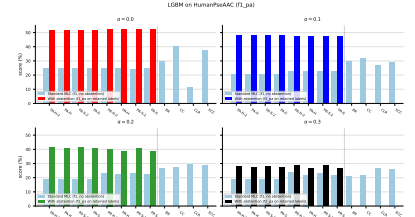
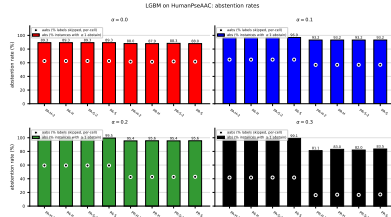


Figure 103: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

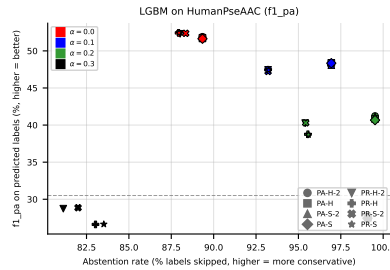


Figure 104: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 105: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).



Figure 106: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on HumanPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.



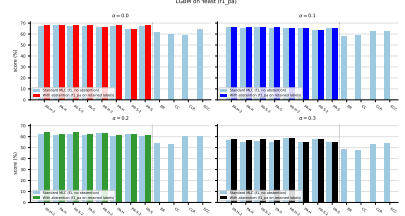
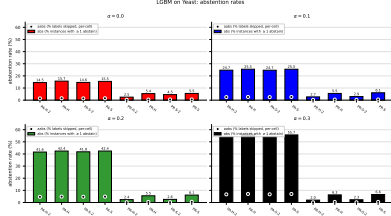


Figure 107: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Yeast**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

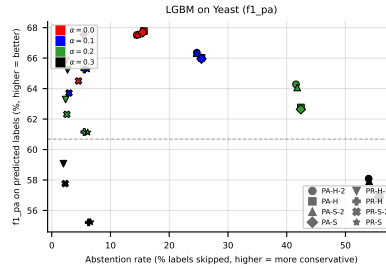


Figure 108: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Yeast**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

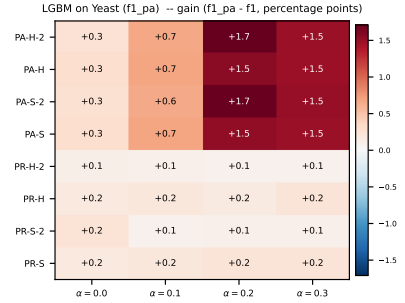
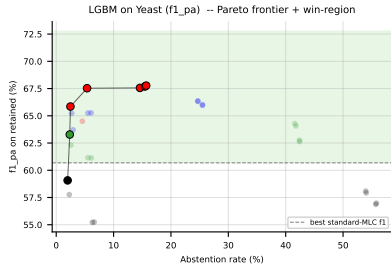


Figure 109: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Yeast**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

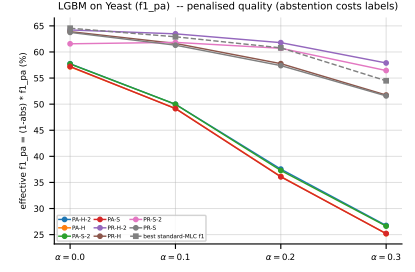
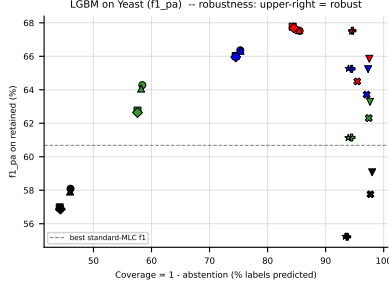


Figure 110: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on Yeast — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

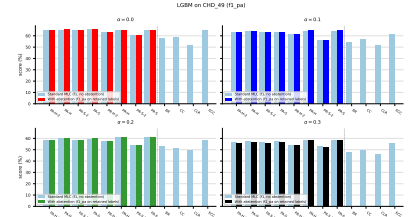
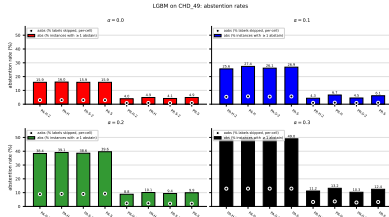


Figure 111: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on CHD\_49: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

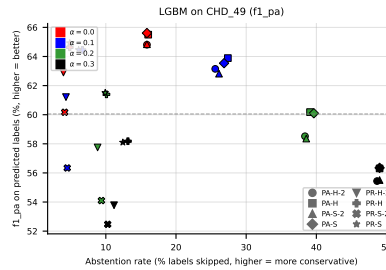


Figure 112: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on CHD\_49: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

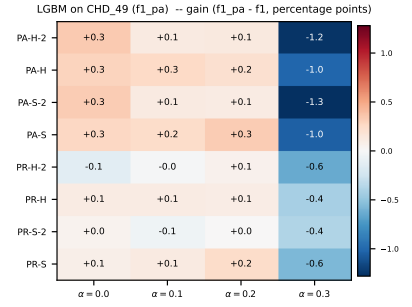
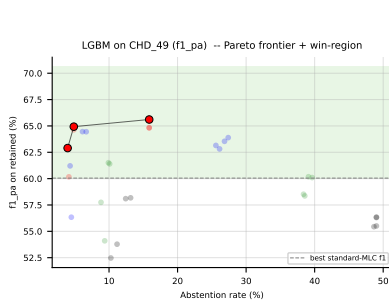


Figure 113: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on CHD\_49: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

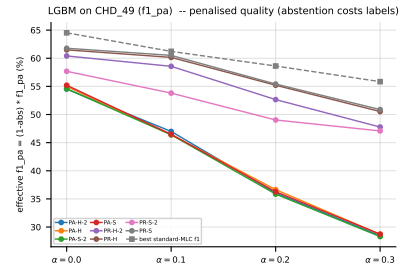
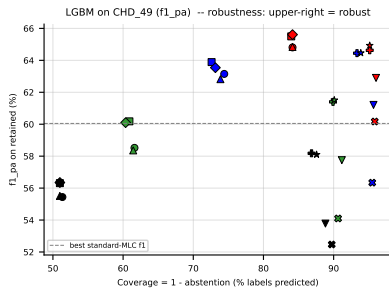


Figure 114: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on CHD\_49 — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

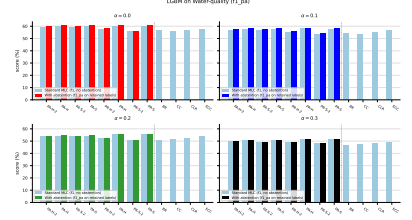
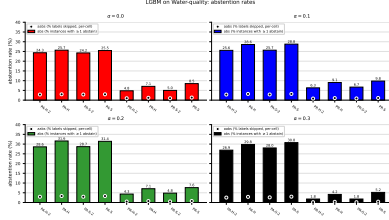


Figure 115: LGBM (f1\_pa) on Water-quality: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

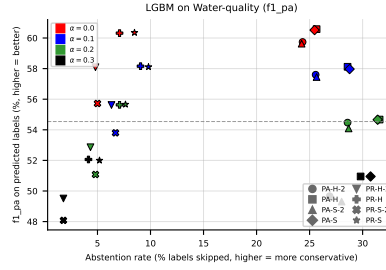


Figure 116: LGBM (f1\_pa) on Water-quality: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

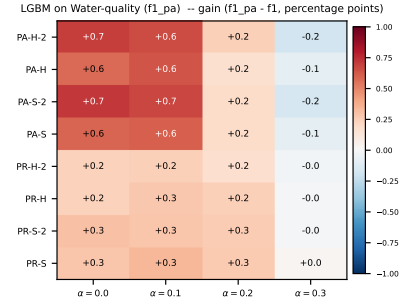
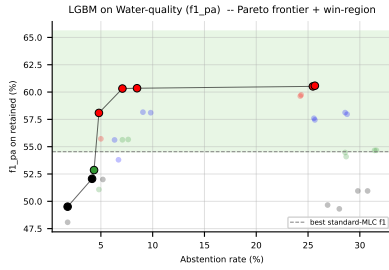


Figure 117: LGBM (f1\_pa) on Water-quality: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $f1_{pa} - f1$ ) heatmap (right).

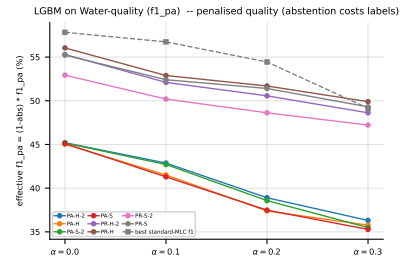
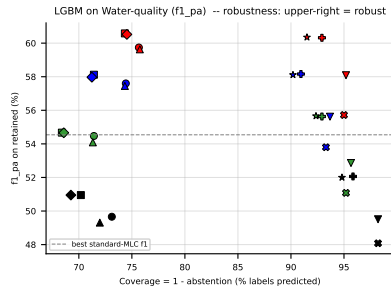


Figure 118: LGBM ( $f1_{pa}$ ) on **Water-quality** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $f1_{pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot f1_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.7 LGBM, metric jaccard\_pa — aggregate



Figure 119: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

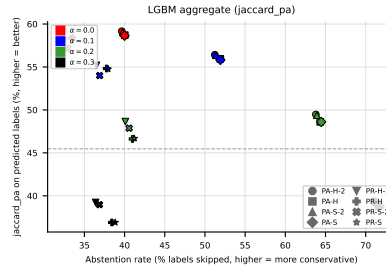


Figure 120: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



Figure 121: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) averaged across all datasets: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

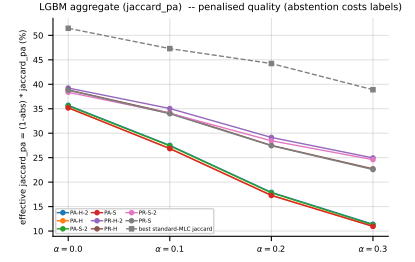
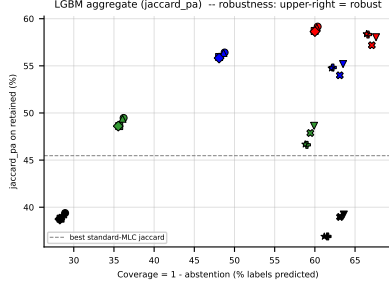


Figure 122: LGBM (*jaccard\_pa*) averaged across all datasets — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective *jaccard\_pa* =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## 5.8 LGBM, metric *jaccard\_pa* — per dataset

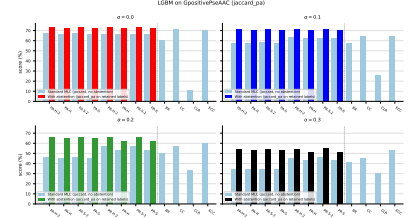
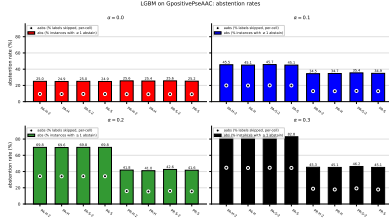


Figure 123: LGBM (*jaccard\_pa*) on **GpositivePseAAC**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

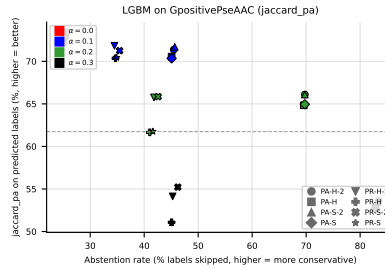


Figure 124: LGBM (*jaccard\_pa*) on **GpositivePseAAC**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

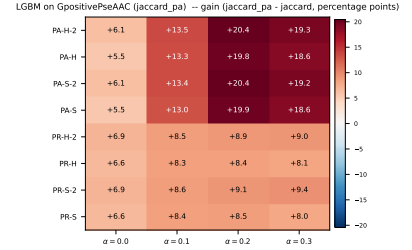
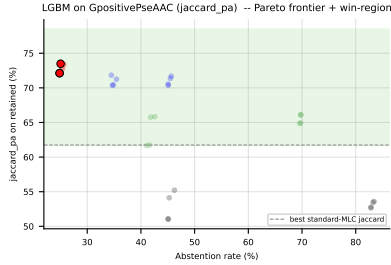


Figure 125: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on GpositivePseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain (jaccard\_pa -  $f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

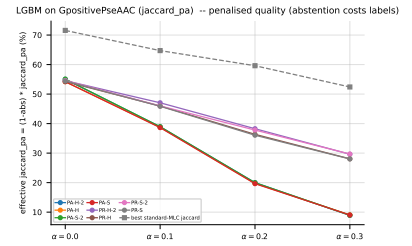
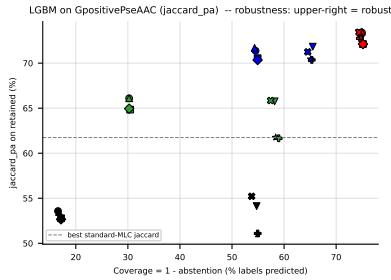


Figure 126: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on GpositivePseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.



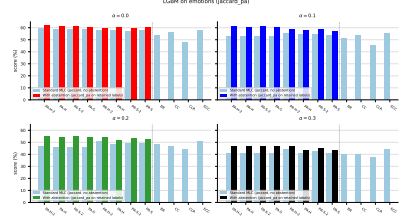
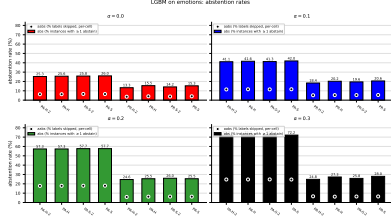


Figure 127: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

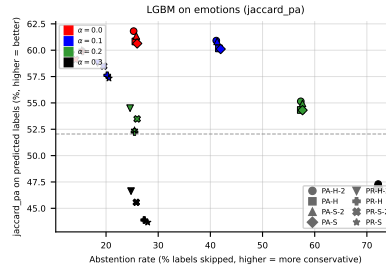


Figure 128: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

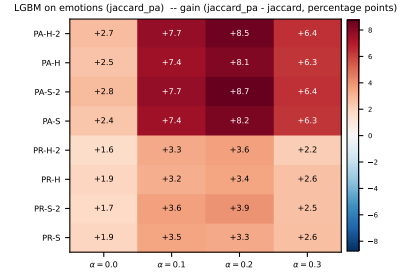
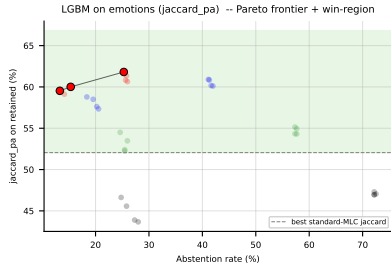


Figure 129: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **emotions**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

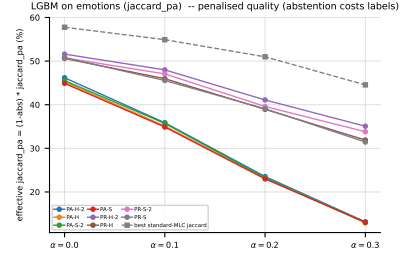
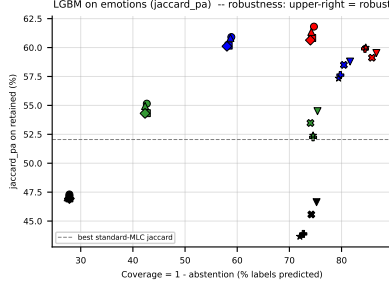


Figure 130: LGBM ( $jaccard\_pa$ ) on **emotions** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x$  = coverage =  $1 - abs$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $jaccard\_pa = (1 - abs) \cdot jaccard\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

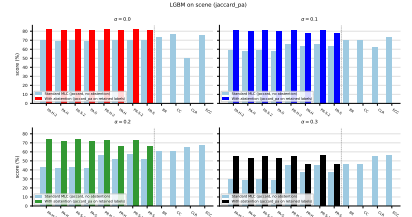
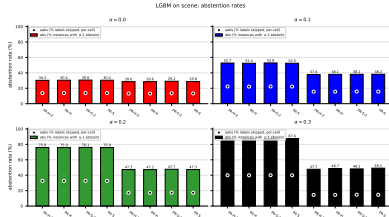


Figure 131: LGBM ( $jaccard\_pa$ ) on **scene**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

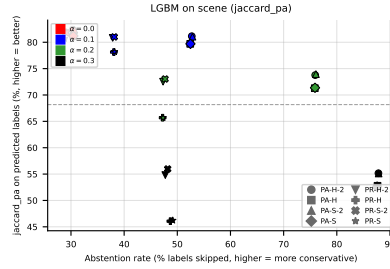


Figure 132: LGBM ( $jaccard\_pa$ ) on **scene**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x$  = abstention rate,  $y$  = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

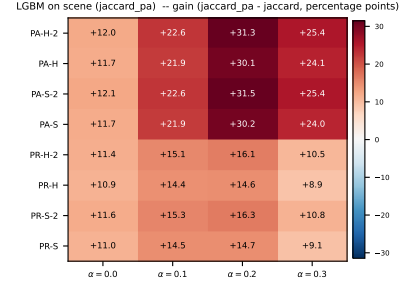
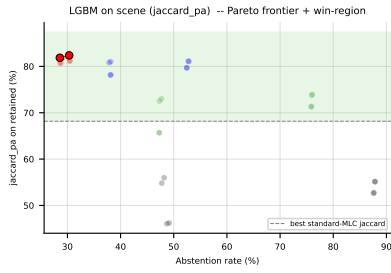


Figure 133: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **scene**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $jaccard\_pa - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

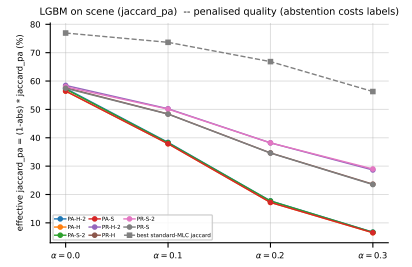
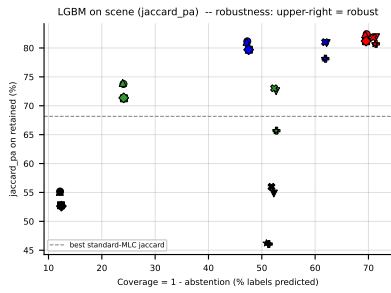


Figure 134: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **scene** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot jaccard\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

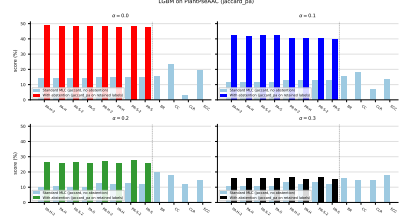
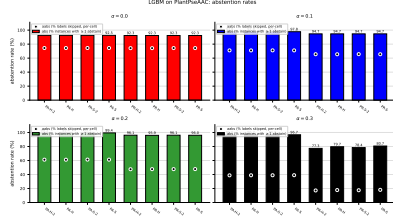


Figure 135: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

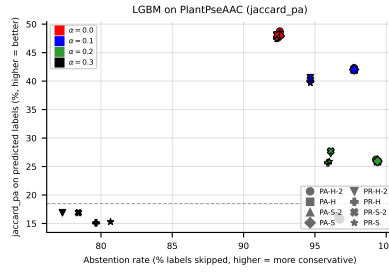


Figure 136: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

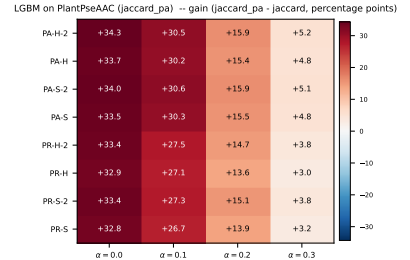
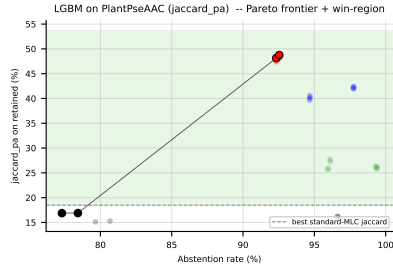


Figure 137: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

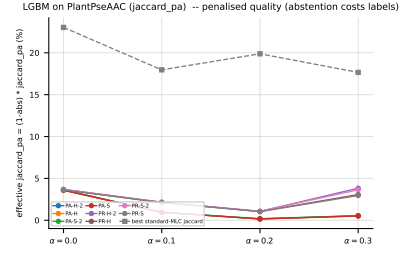
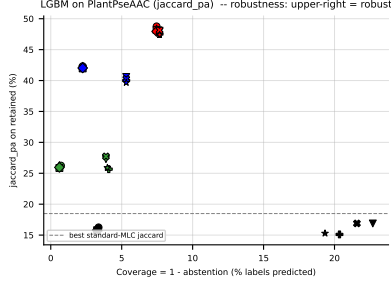


Figure 138: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on PlantPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

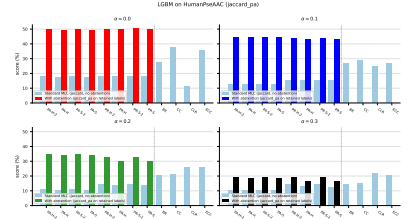
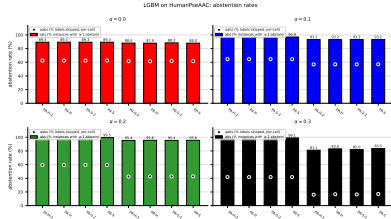


Figure 139: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

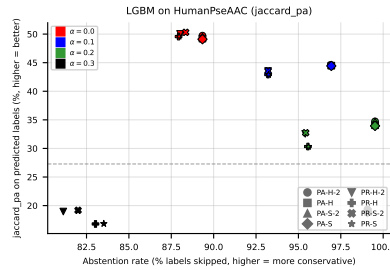


Figure 140: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

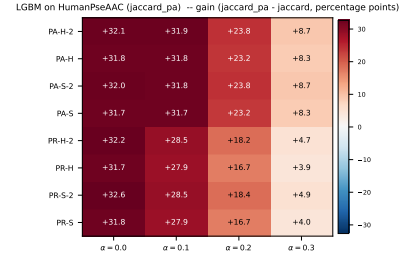
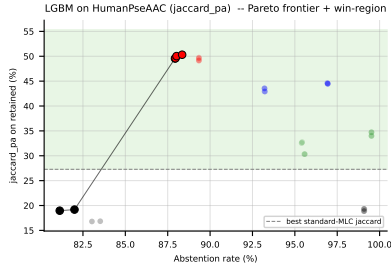


Figure 141: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

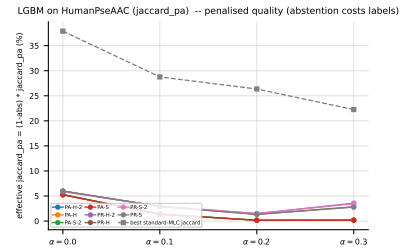
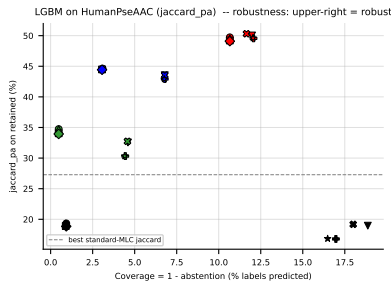


Figure 142: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on HumanPseAAC — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $\text{jaccard\_pa} = (1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

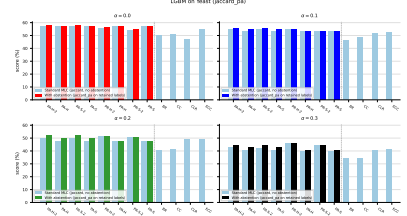
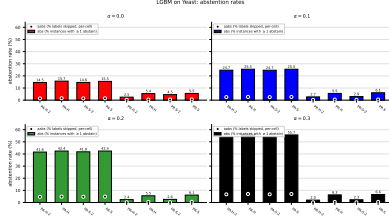


Figure 143: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

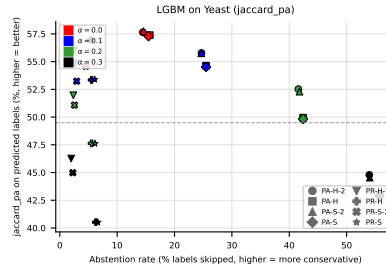


Figure 144: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

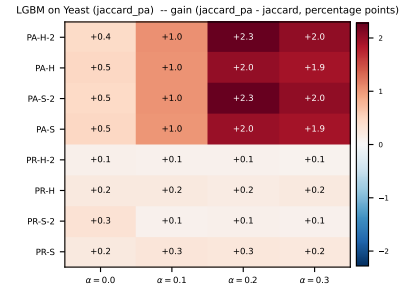
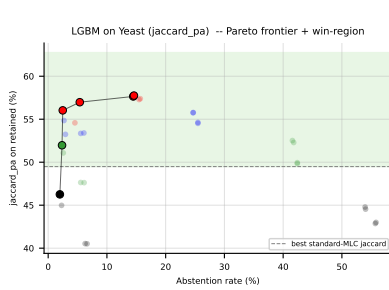


Figure 145: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain (jaccard\_pa -  $f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

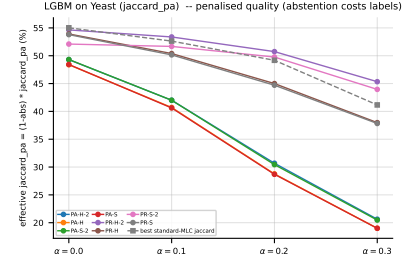
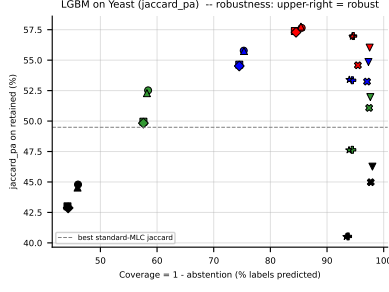


Figure 146: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Yeast** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard\_pa =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard\_pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

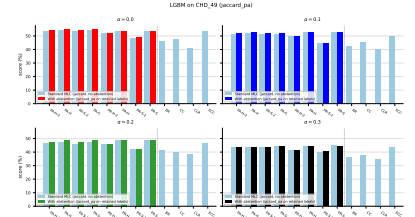
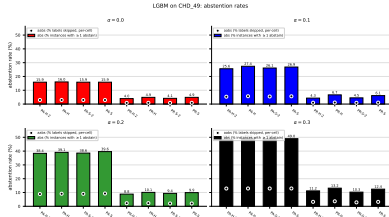


Figure 147: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **CHD\_49**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

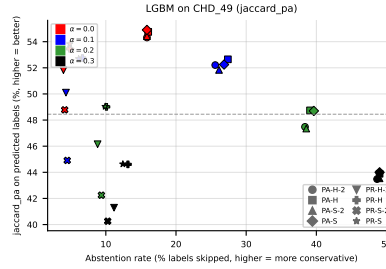


Figure 148: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **CHD\_49**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair;  $x = \text{abstention rate}$ ,  $y = \text{quality on retained labels}$ . Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.



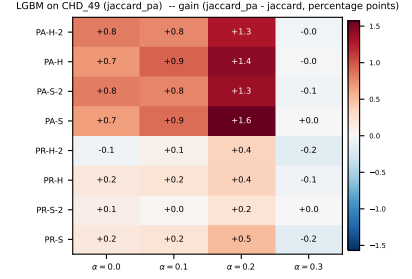
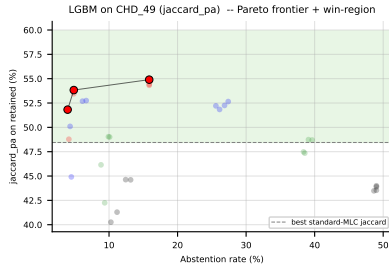


Figure 149: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on CHD\_49: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $jaccard\_pa - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

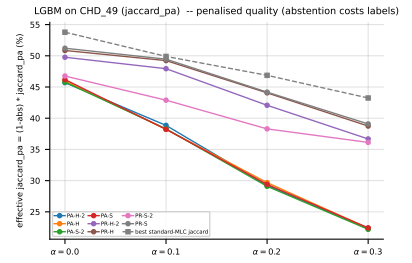
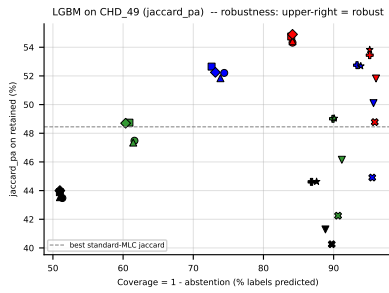


Figure 150: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on CHD\_49 — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = coverage = 1 - abs$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective  $jaccard\_pa = (1 - abs) \cdot jaccard\_pa$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

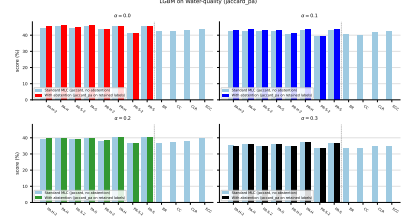
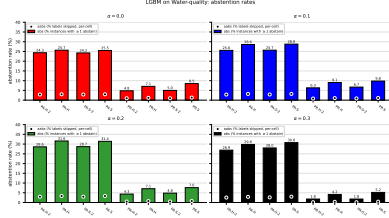


Figure 151: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: abstention rates (left) and standard-MLC-vs-abstention paired bars (right), across  $\alpha \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ . Left: bar = **abs** (% of instances with at least one abstained label, instance-level); dot = **aabs** (% of labels skipped, per-cell label-level). These rates are independent of the quality metric. Right: blue = standard MLC quality (no abstention) on the matched BV metric; coloured = with-abstention quality on retained labels.

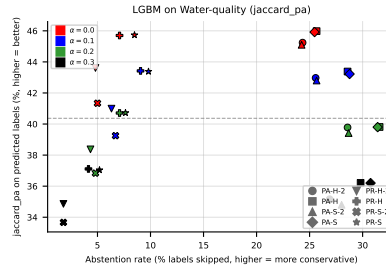


Figure 152: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: coverage-risk scatter. Each point is one (method, noise) pair; x = abstention rate, y = quality on retained labels. Points above the dashed line beat the best standard-MLC baseline.

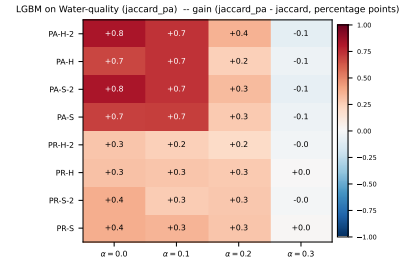
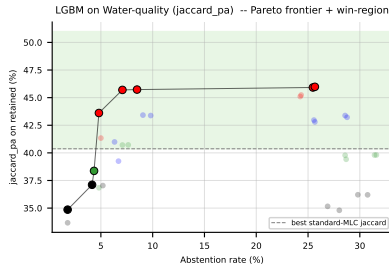


Figure 153: LGBM (jaccard\_pa) on **Water-quality**: Pareto frontier of (abstention, retained quality) with the win-region shaded green (left); per-method per-noise gain ( $\text{jaccard\_pa} - f_1$ ) heatmap (right).

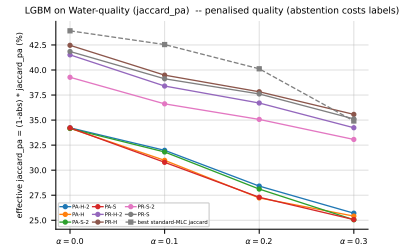
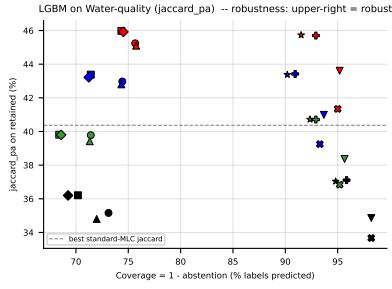


Figure 154: LGBM (jaccard<sub>pa</sub>) on **Water-quality** — robustness view. Left: efficiency-quality scatter ( $x = \text{coverage} = 1 - \text{abs}$ ); upper-right is robust (predicts many labels and keeps quality high). Right: effective jaccard<sub>pa</sub> =  $(1 - \text{abs}) \cdot \text{jaccard}_{pa}$ , i.e. retained quality penalised by skipped coverage. A method whose effective curve stays above the dashed standard-MLC baseline at every  $\alpha$  is robust to noise, not just selectively abstaining on hard labels.

## A Experimental results — appendix tables (RF base learner)

Appendix counterpart of the main Paper results section. Tables G2–G5 mirror the original paper’s appendix exactly (same metric sets, with the 6 non-main datasets split into imbalanced vs. balanced buckets following the original layout). Tables G6–G7 are revision additions reporting the new metrics ( $f_{\text{MLC}}^{\text{Jacc}}$ , macro- $f_1$ , micro- $f_1$ ).

### A.1 Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector)

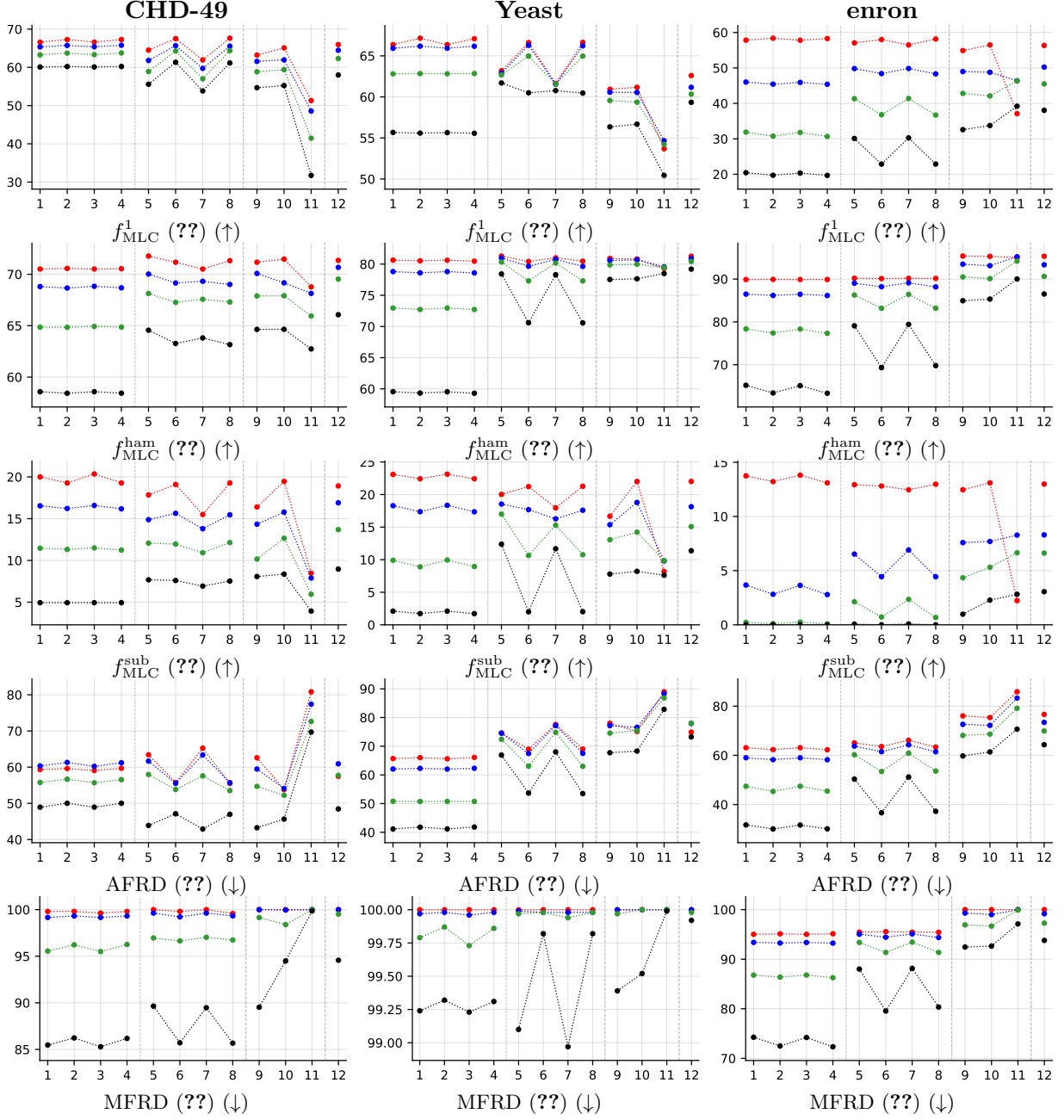


Table 18: (Table G2) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

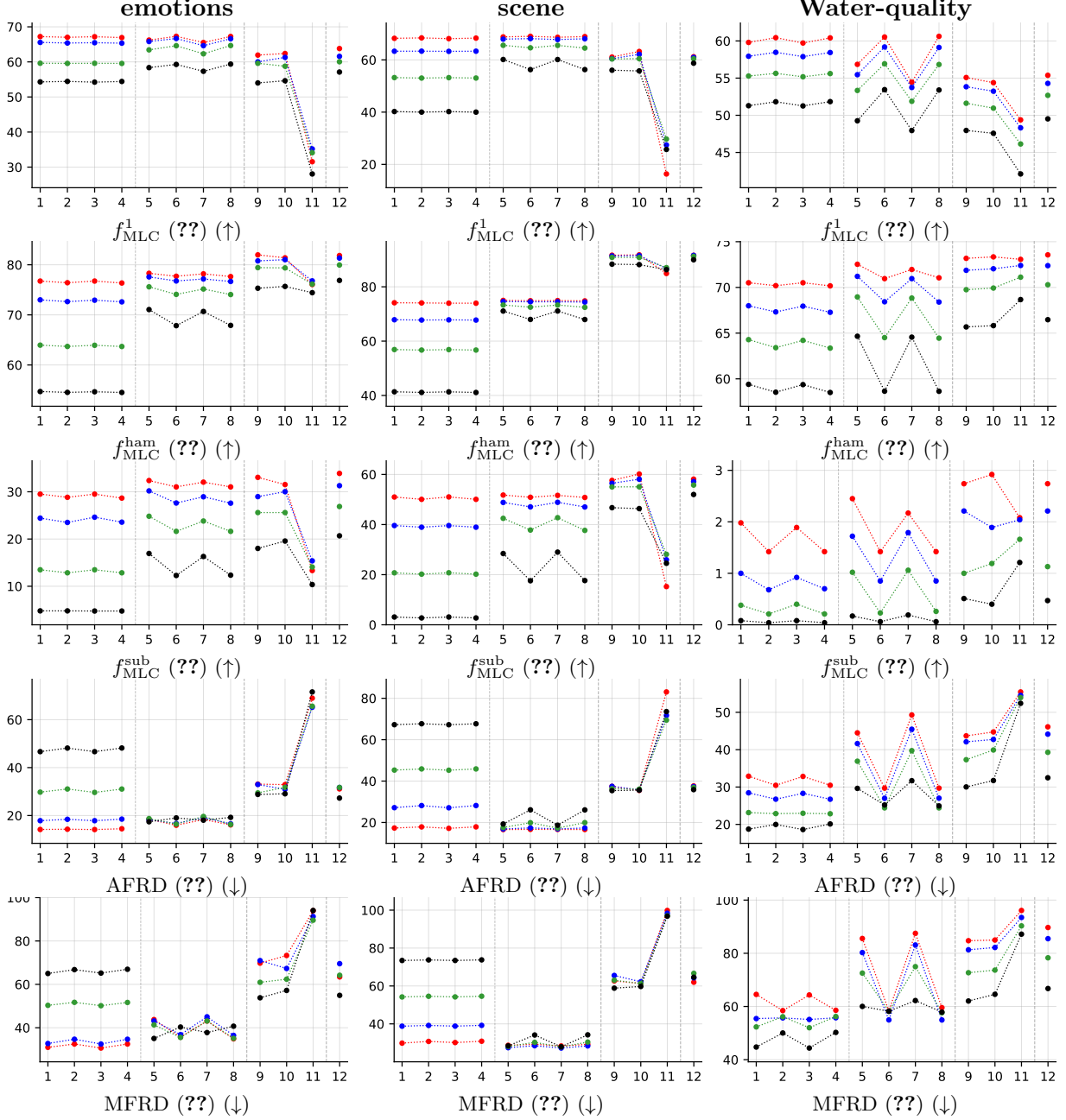


Table 19: (Table G3) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

## A.2 Partial abstention (PartialAbstention)

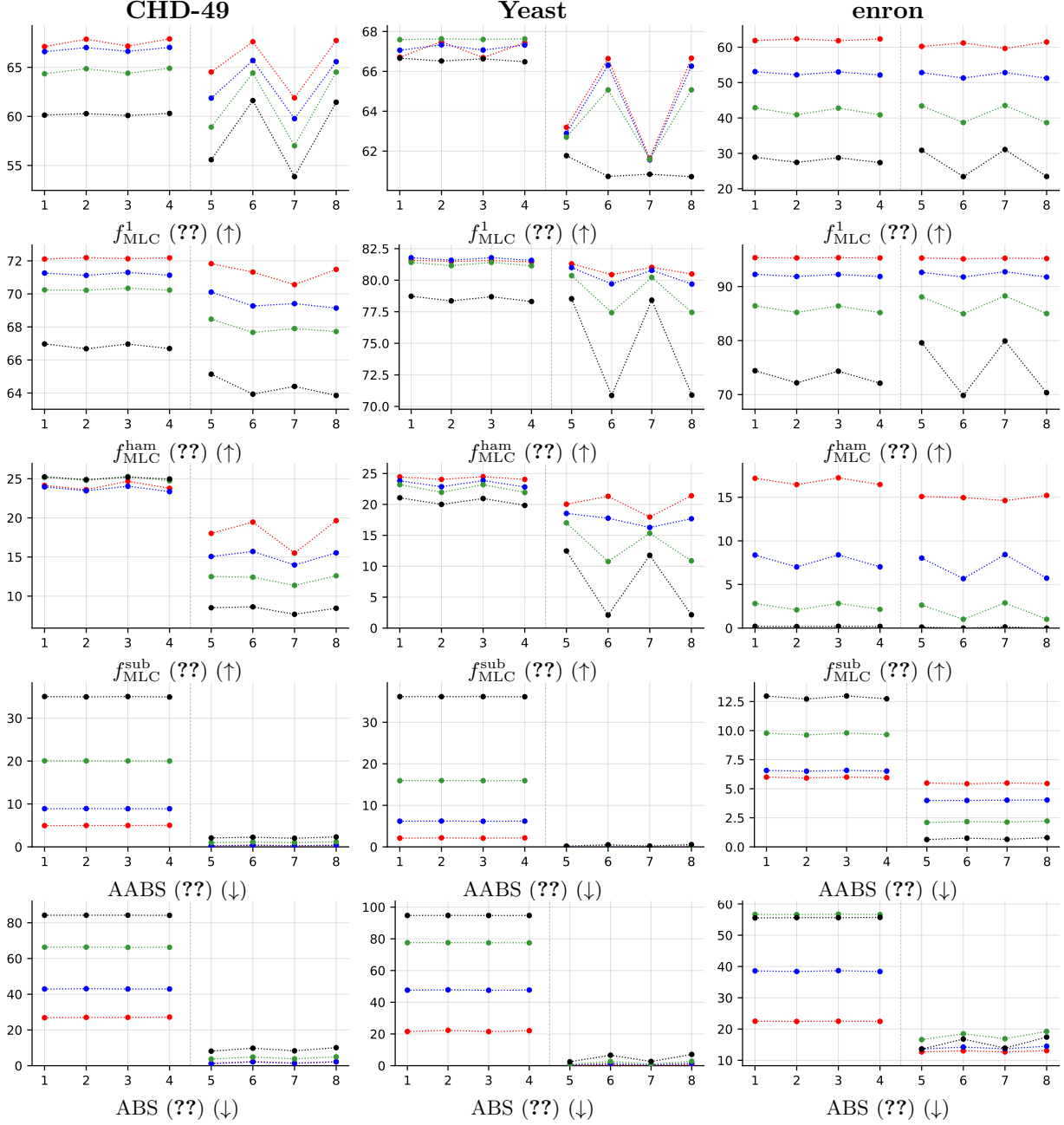


Table 20: (Table G4) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

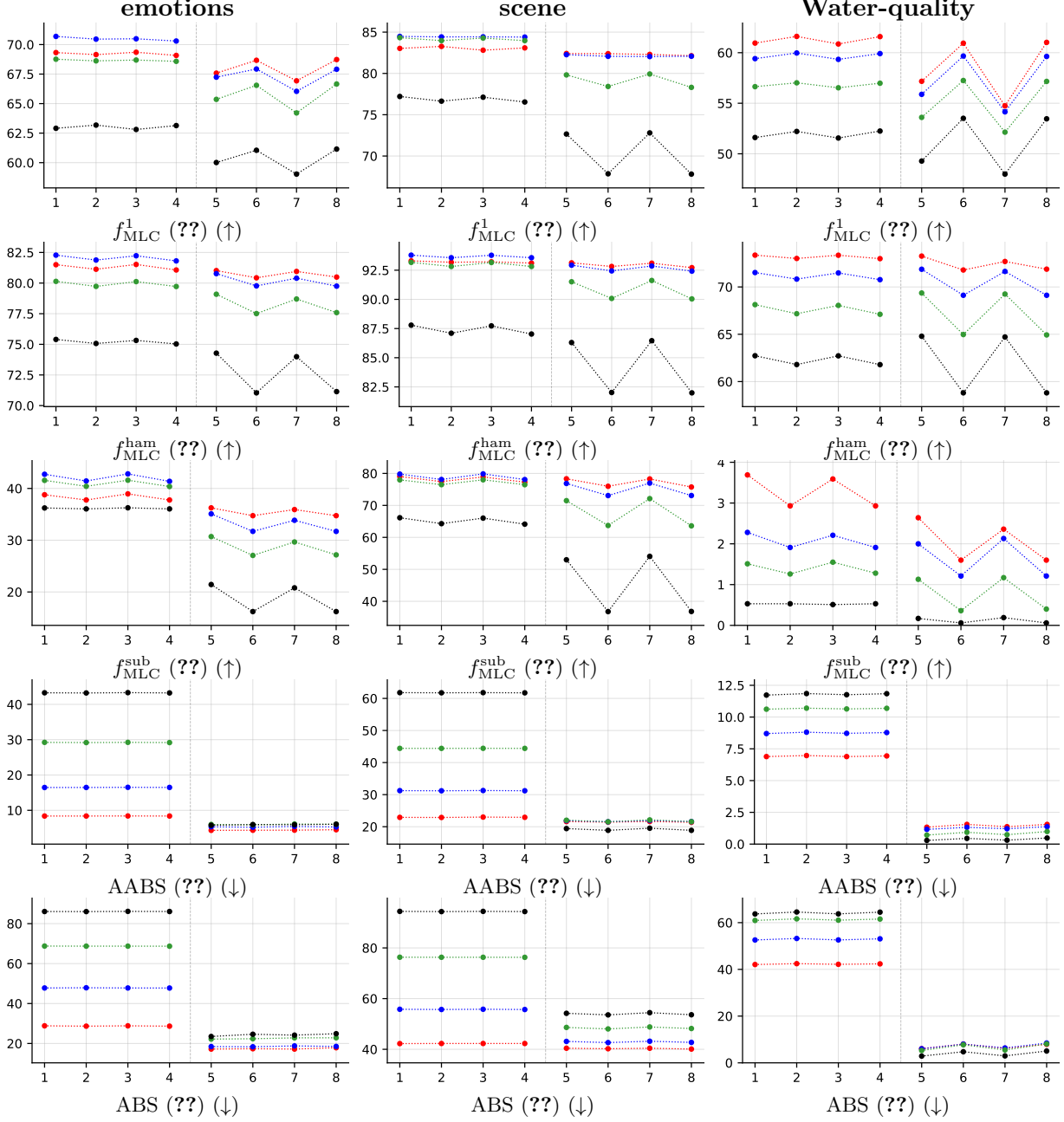


Table 21: (Table G5) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

### A.3 Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector)



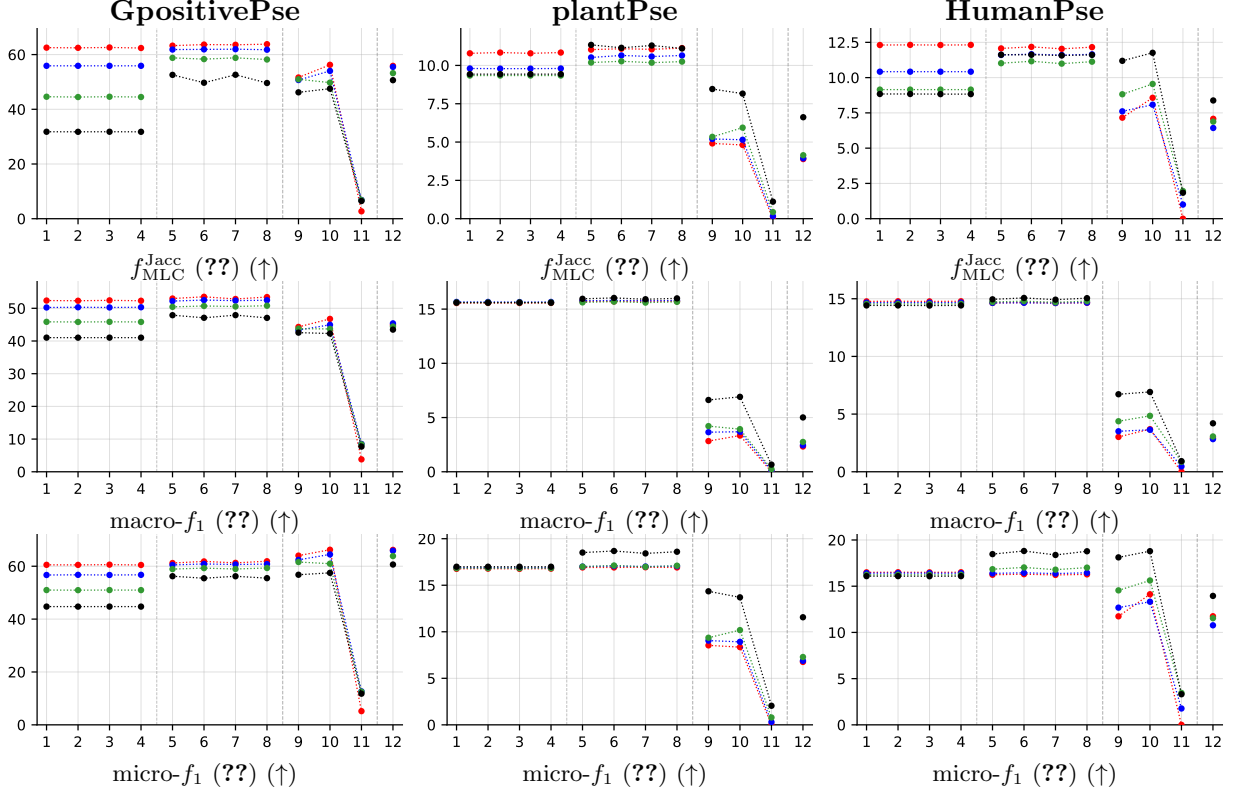


Table 22: (Table G6, new metrics — main datasets) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

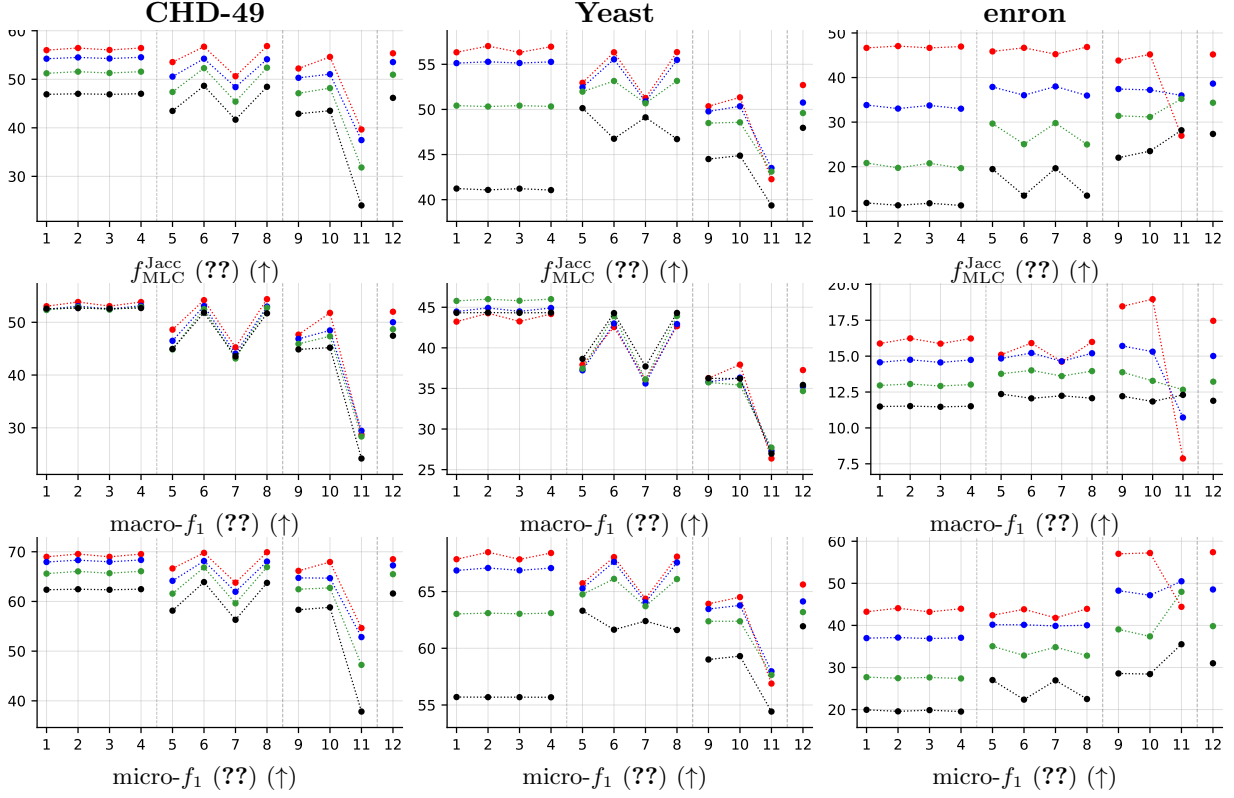


Table 23: (Table G6, new metrics — imbalanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

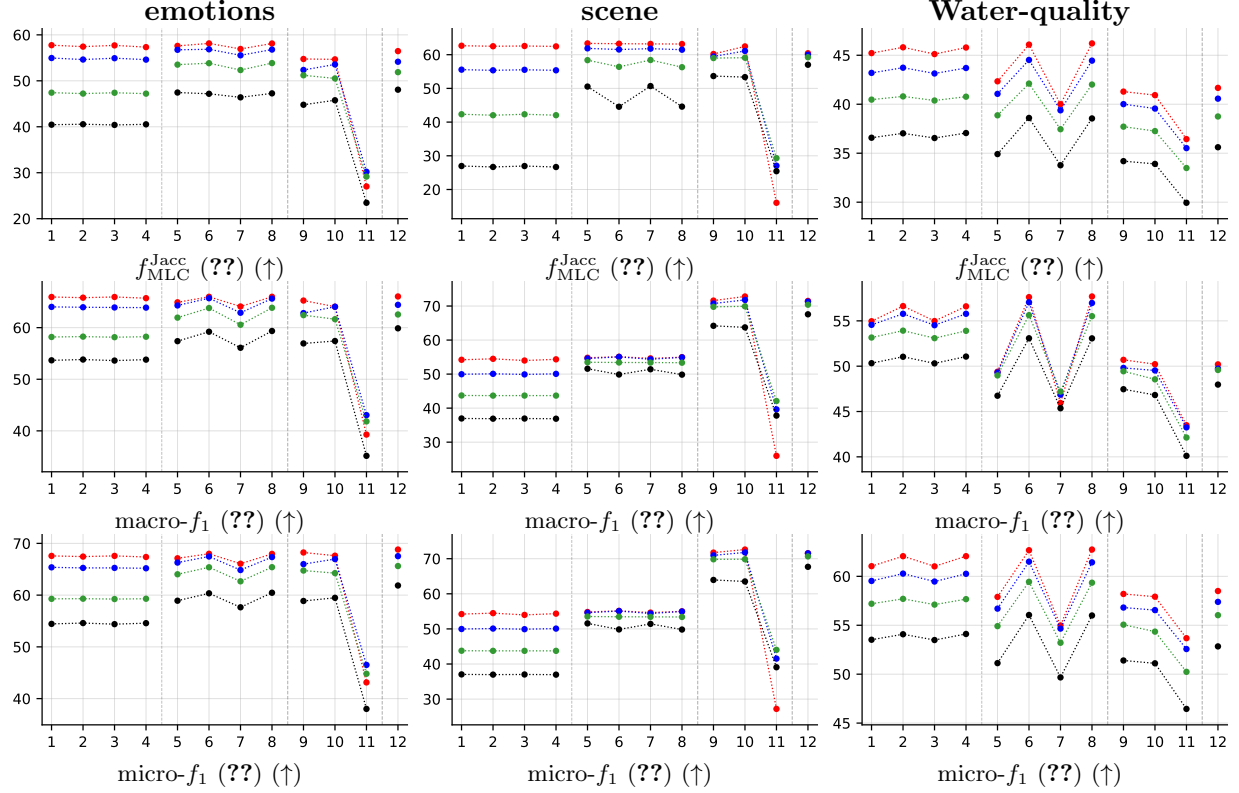


Table 24: (Table G6, new metrics — balanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S), (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S), and (BR, CC, CLR) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4), (5, 6, 7, 8), and (9, 10, 11), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

## A.4 Partial abstention (PartialAbstention)

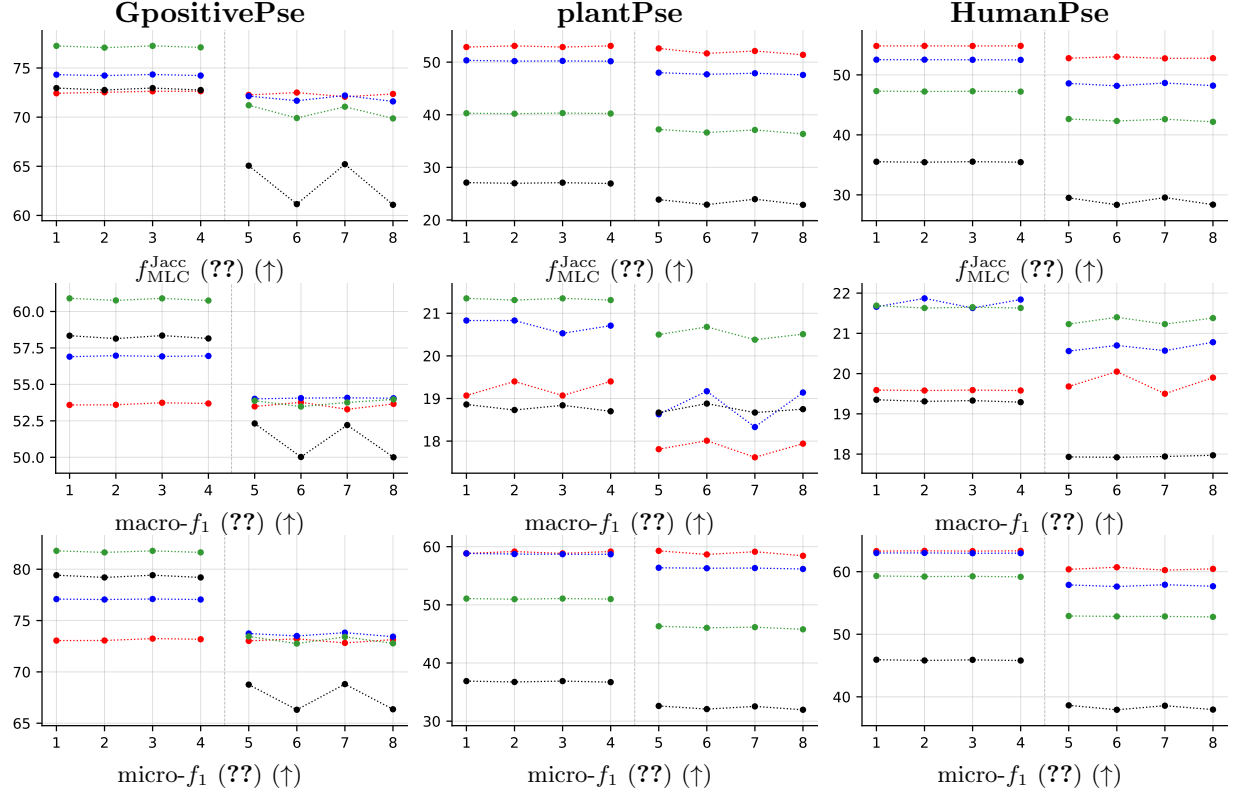


Table 25: (Table G7, new metrics — main datasets) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

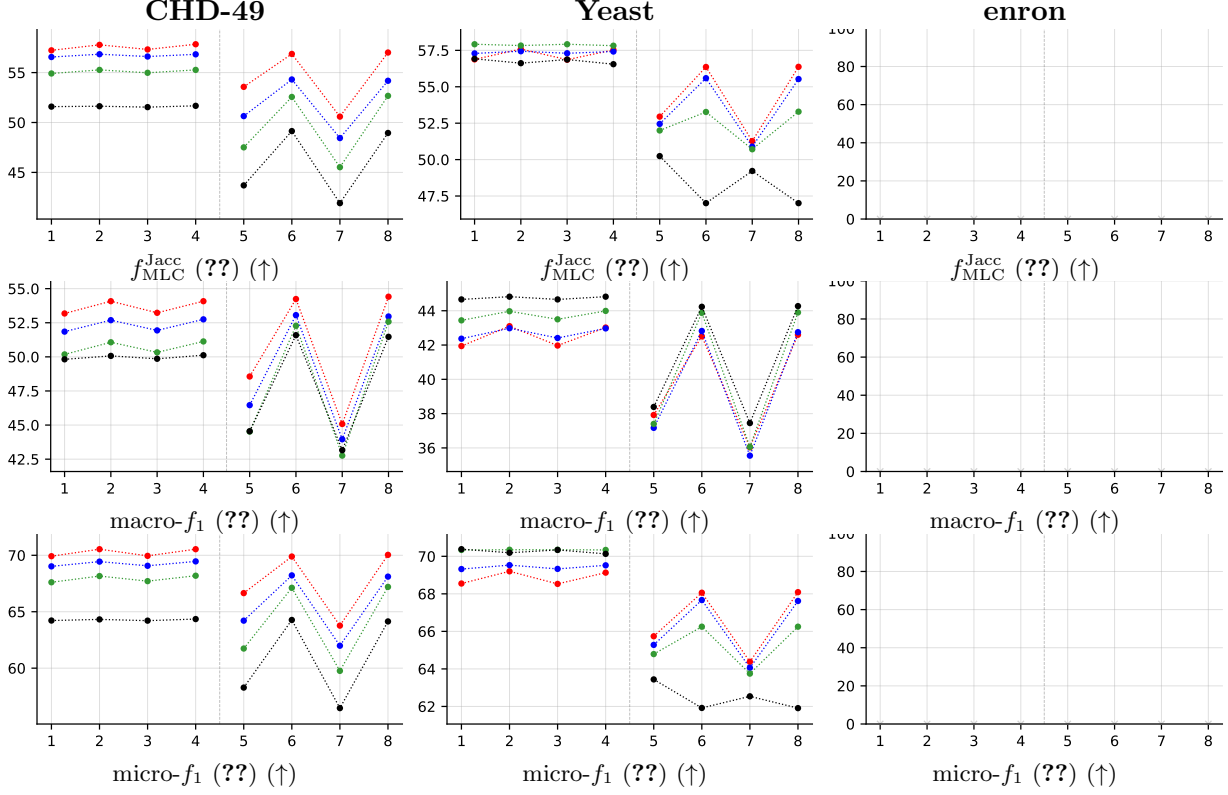


Table 26: (Table G7, new metrics — imbalanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

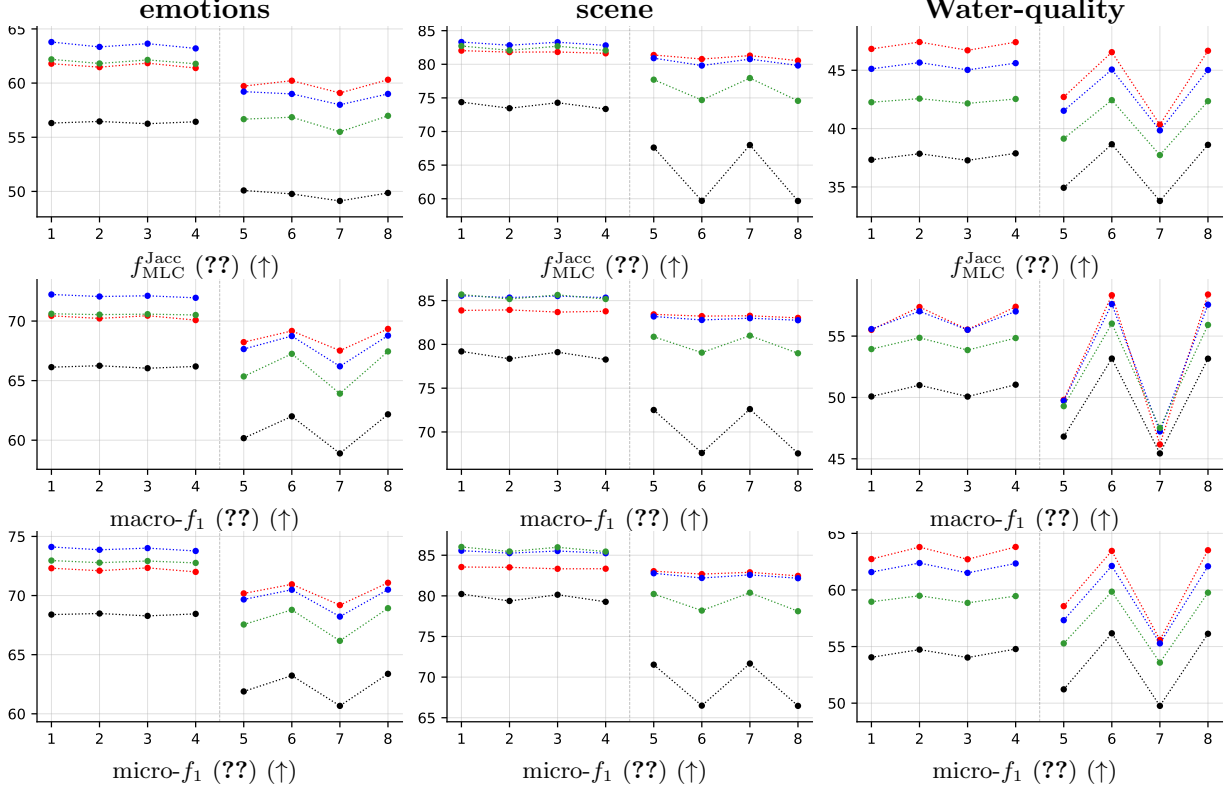


Table 27: (Table G7, new metrics — balanced) Average scores (in %,  $y$ -axis) over  $5 \times 5$  cross-validation folds, plotted against the encoded number of the classifiers ( $x$ -axis): (PA-H-2, PA-H, PA-S-2, PA-S) and (PR-H-2, PR-H, PR-S-2, PR-S) are encoded as (1, 2, 3, 4) and (5, 6, 7, 8), respectively. Results are color-coded with respect to the noisy level  $\alpha$  as follows:  $\alpha = 0.0$ ,  $\alpha = 0.1$ ,  $\alpha = 0.2$  and  $\alpha = 0.3$ .

## B Per-dataset results (RF base learner)

### B.1 GpositivePseAAC ( $K = 4$ )

RF • GpositivePseAAC • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions

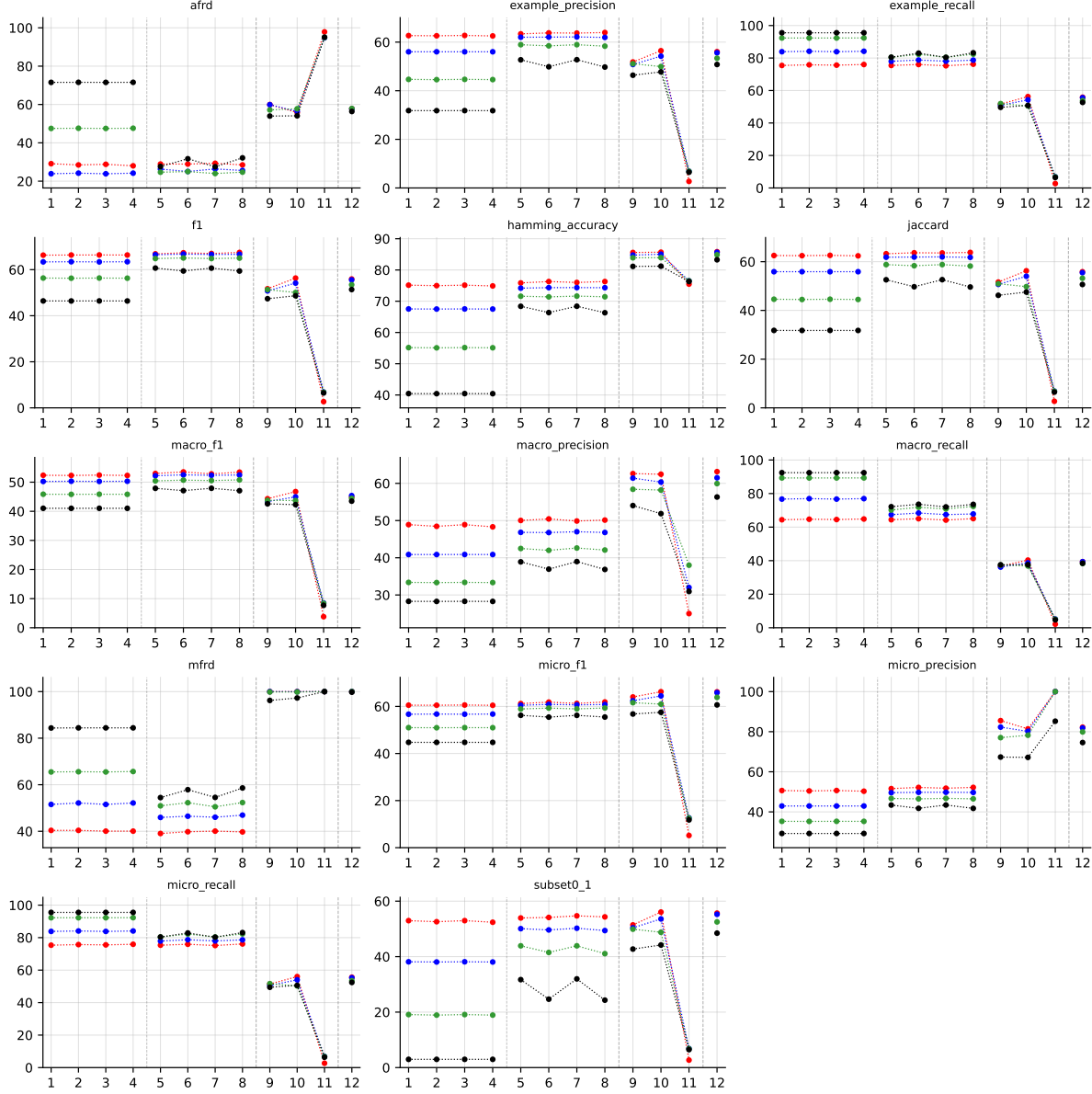


Table 28: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on GpositivePseAAC (RF base learner).

RF • GpositivePseAAC • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention

RF • GpositivePseAAC • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

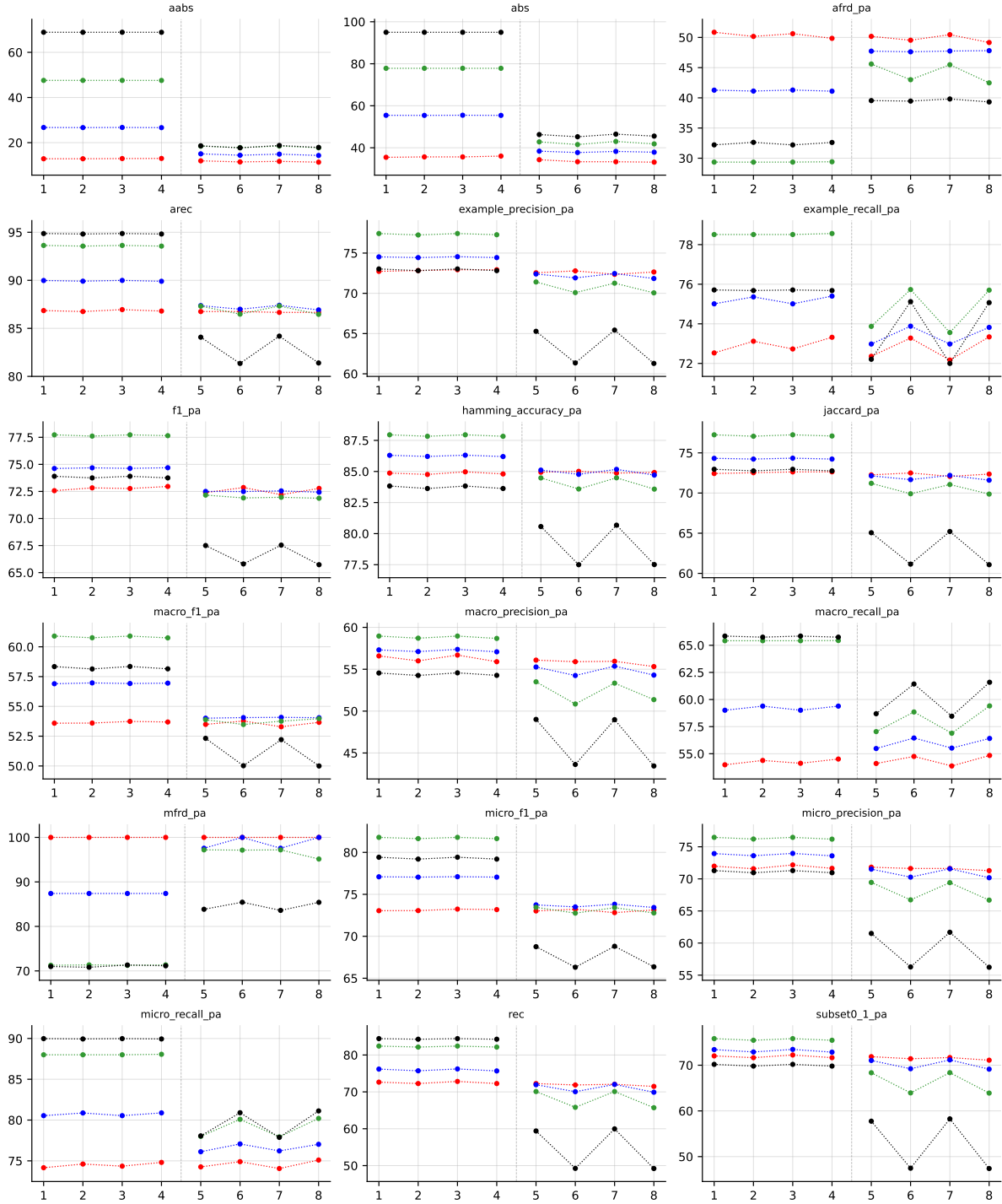


Table 29: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on GpositivePseAAC (RF base learner).



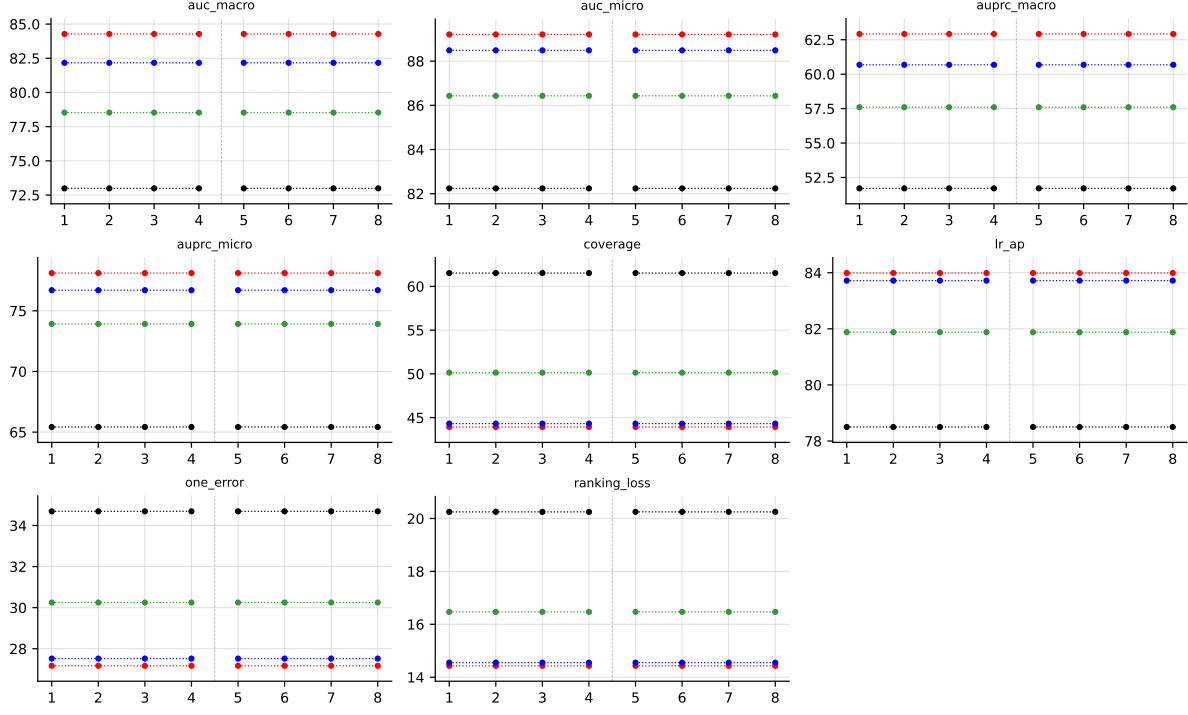


Table 30: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on GpositivePseAAC (RF base learner).

## B.2 Emotions ( $K = 6$ )

**RF • emotions • BinaryVector** — Standard MLC predictions

**RF • emotions • PartialAbstention** — Partial abstention

**RF • emotions • ScoreVector** — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

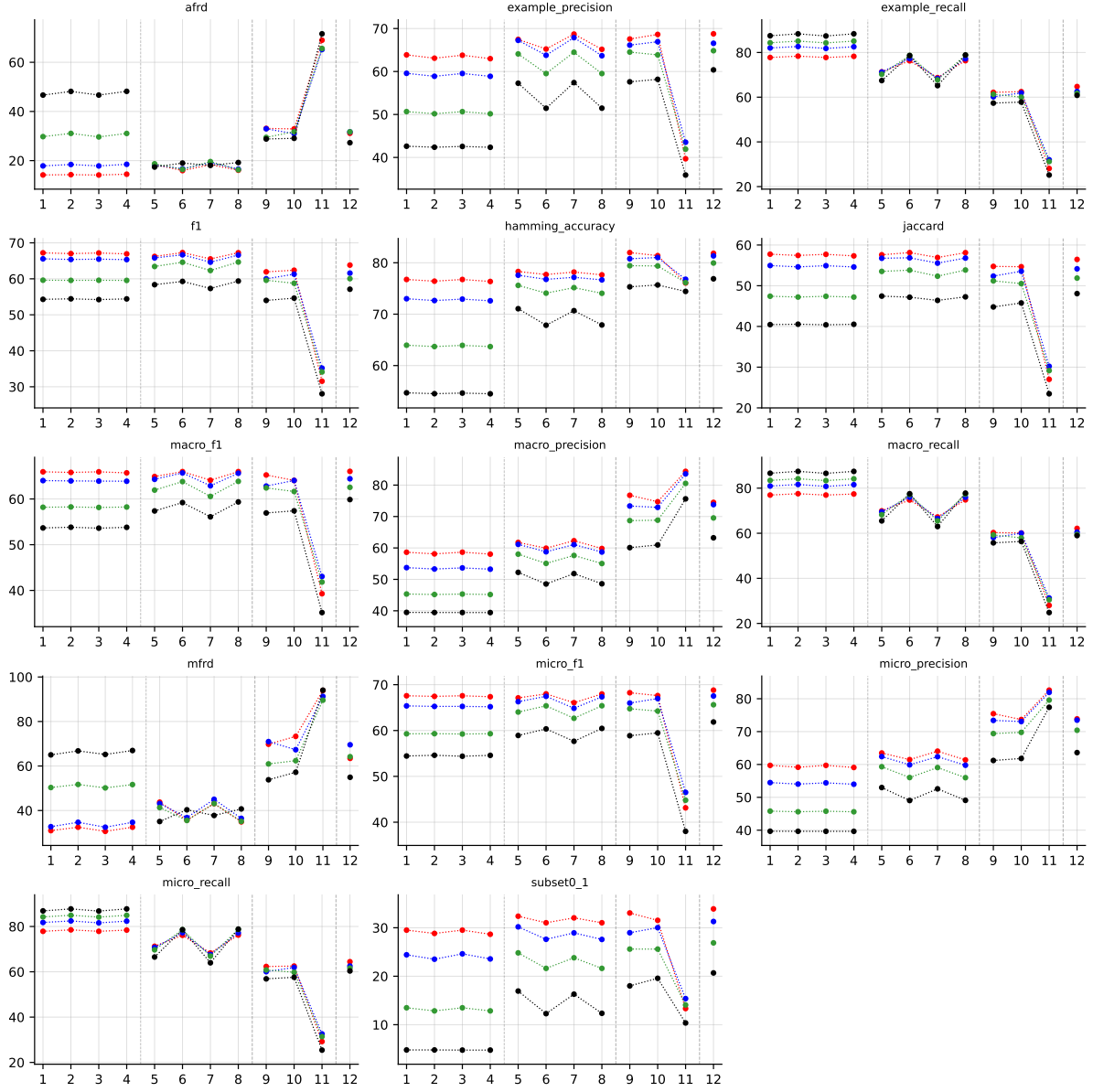


Table 31: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on emotions (RF base learner).

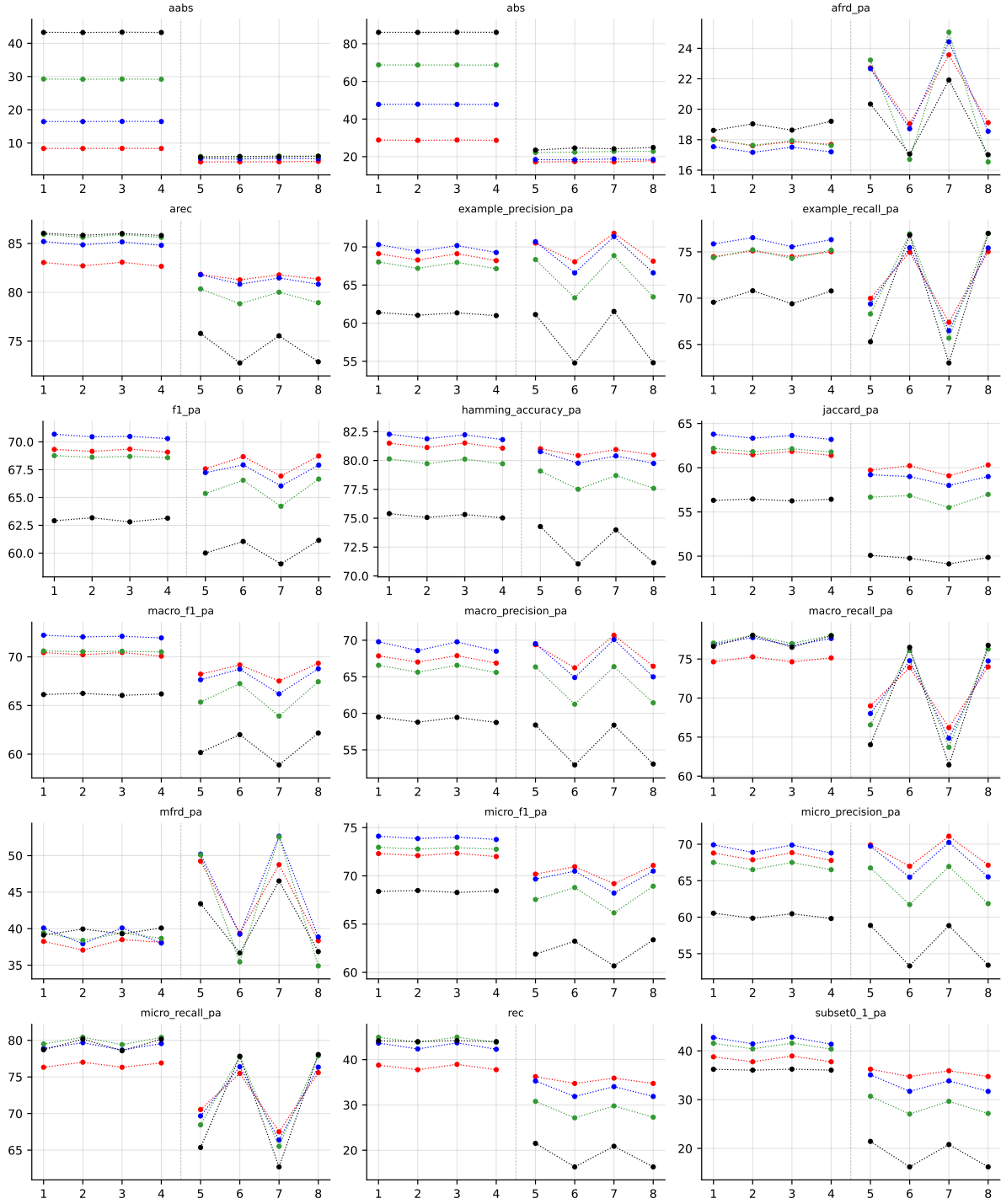


Table 32: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on emotions (RF base learner).

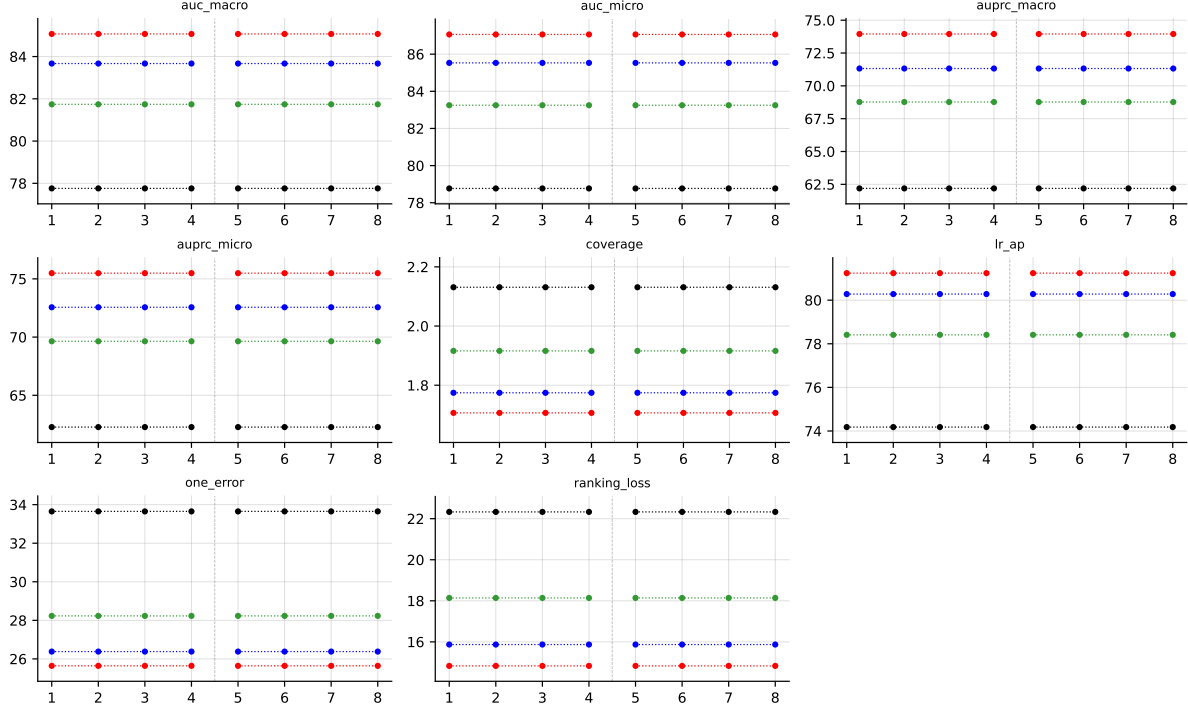


Table 33: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on emotions (RF base learner).

### B.3 Scene ( $K = 6$ )

**RF • scene • BinaryVector** — Standard MLC predictions

**RF • scene • PartialAbstention** — Partial abstention

**RF • scene • ScoreVector** — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

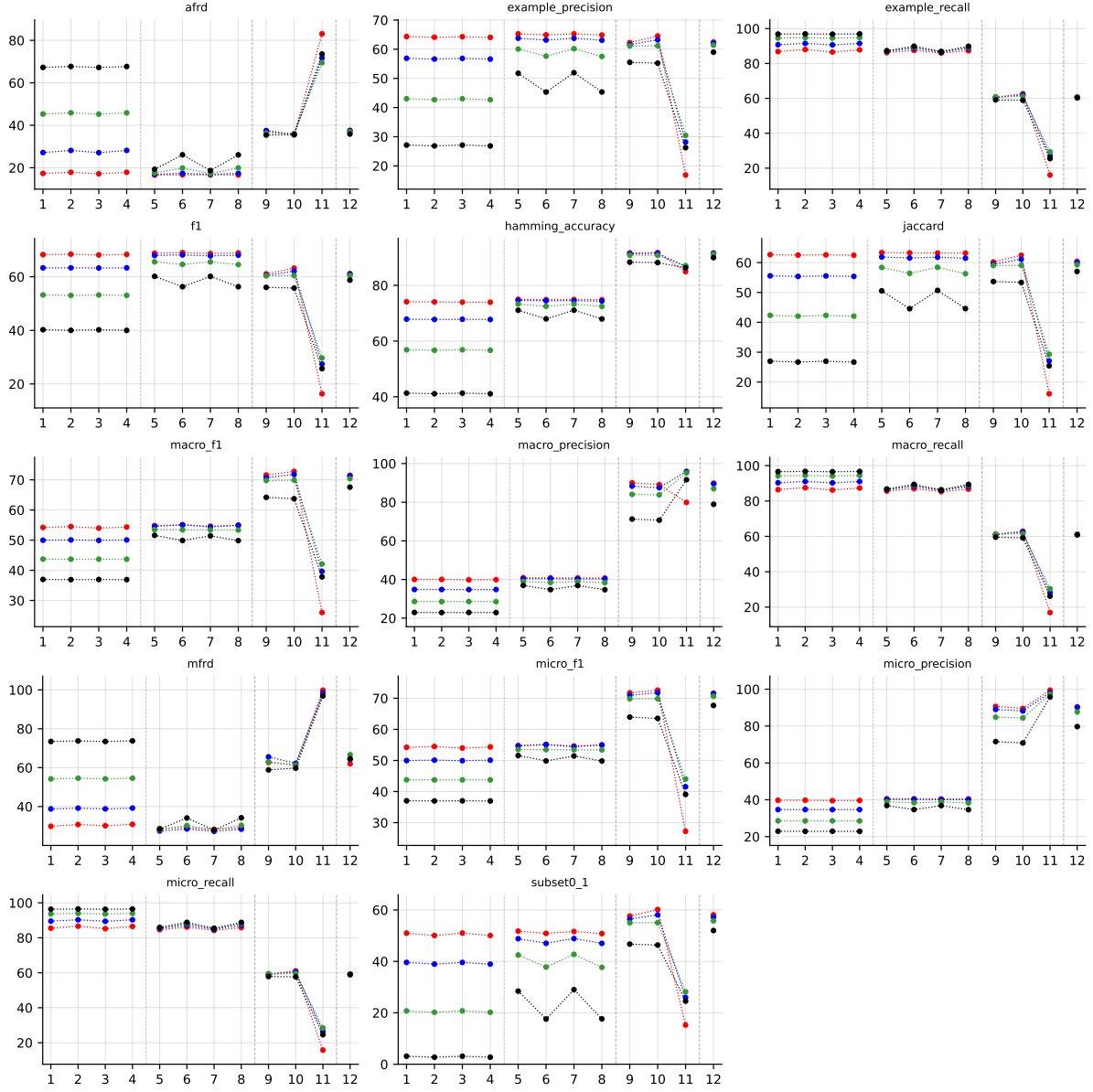


Table 34: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on scene (RF base learner).

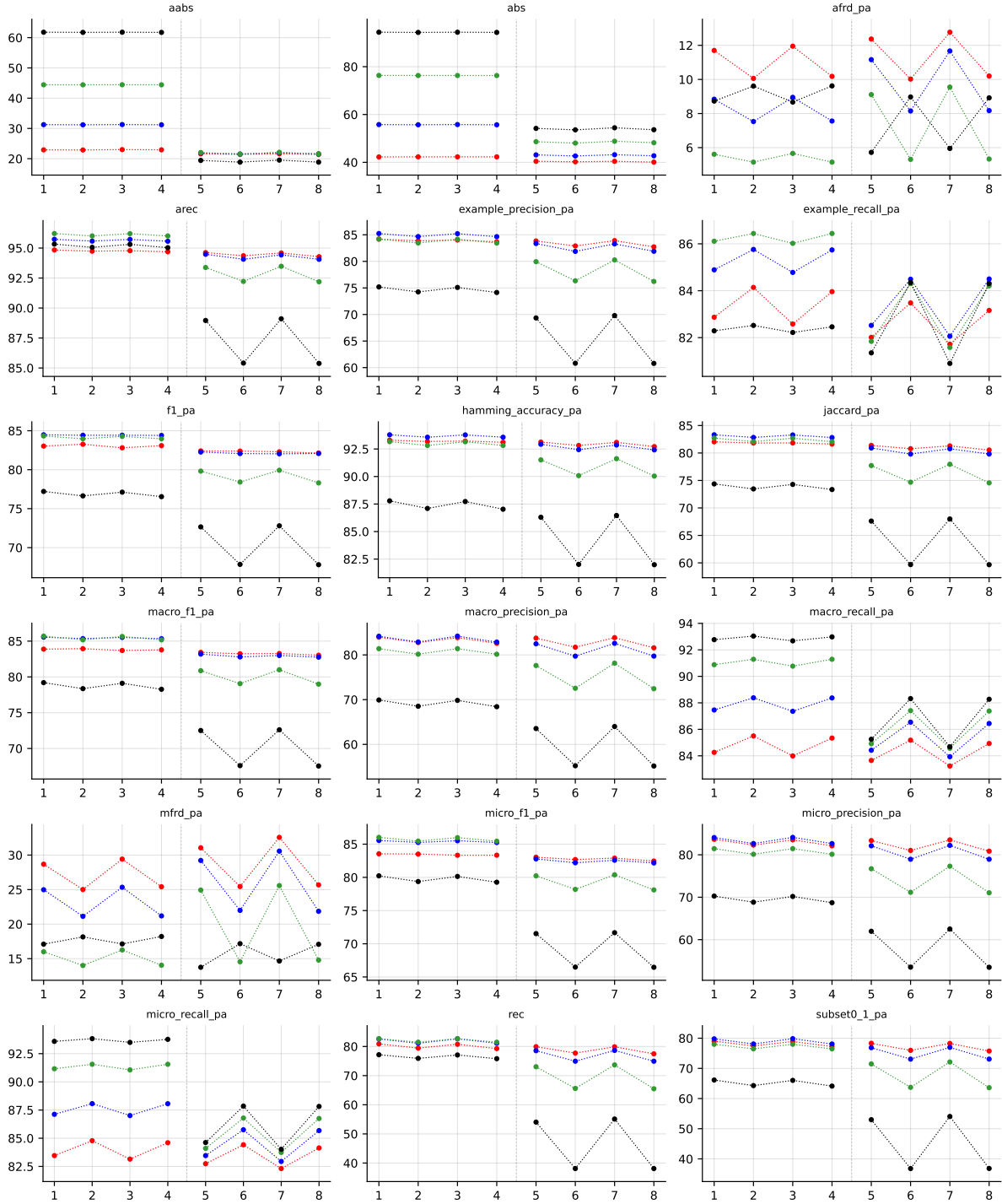


Table 35: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on scene (RF base learner).

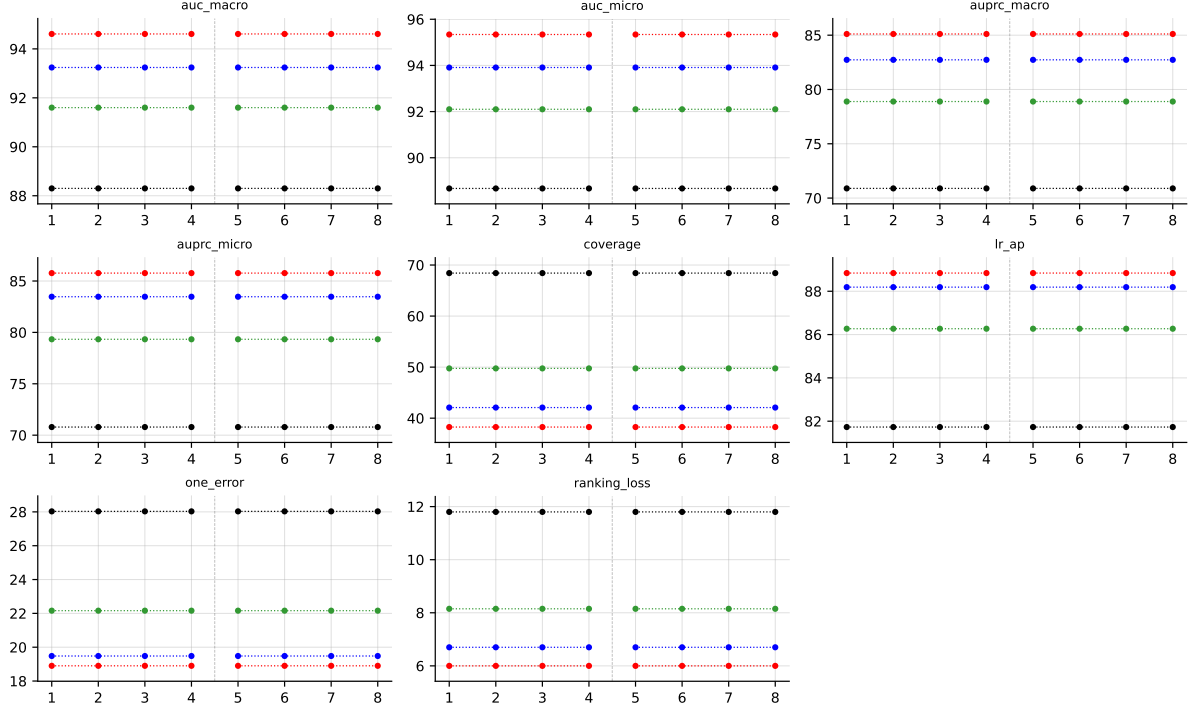


Table 36: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on `scene` (RF base learner).

#### B.4 PlantPseAAC ( $K = 12$ )

**RF • PlantPseAAC • BinaryVector** — Standard MLC predictions

**RF • PlantPseAAC • PartialAbstention** — Partial abstention

**RF • PlantPseAAC • ScoreVector** — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

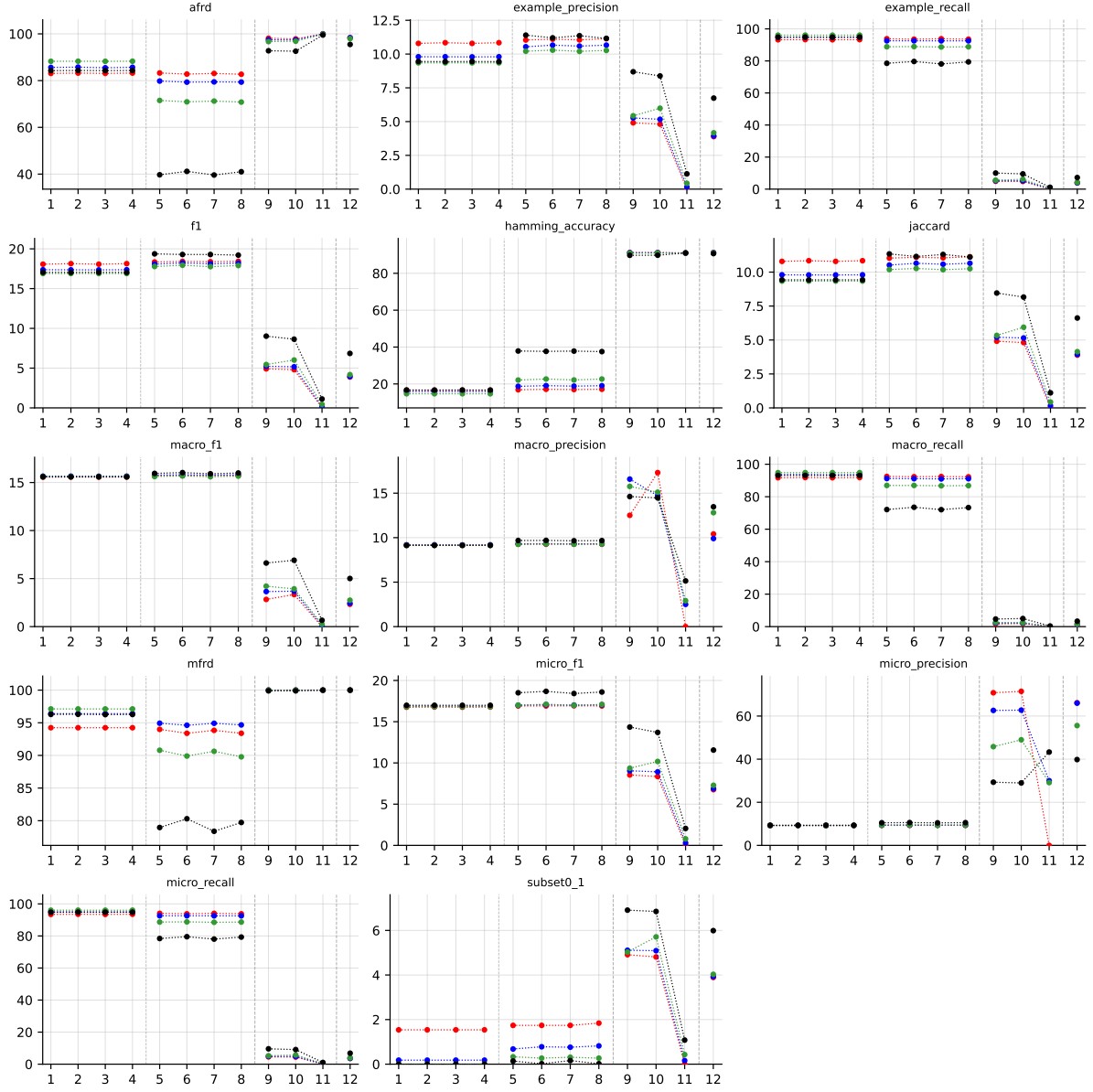


Table 37: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on PlantPseAAC (RF base learner).



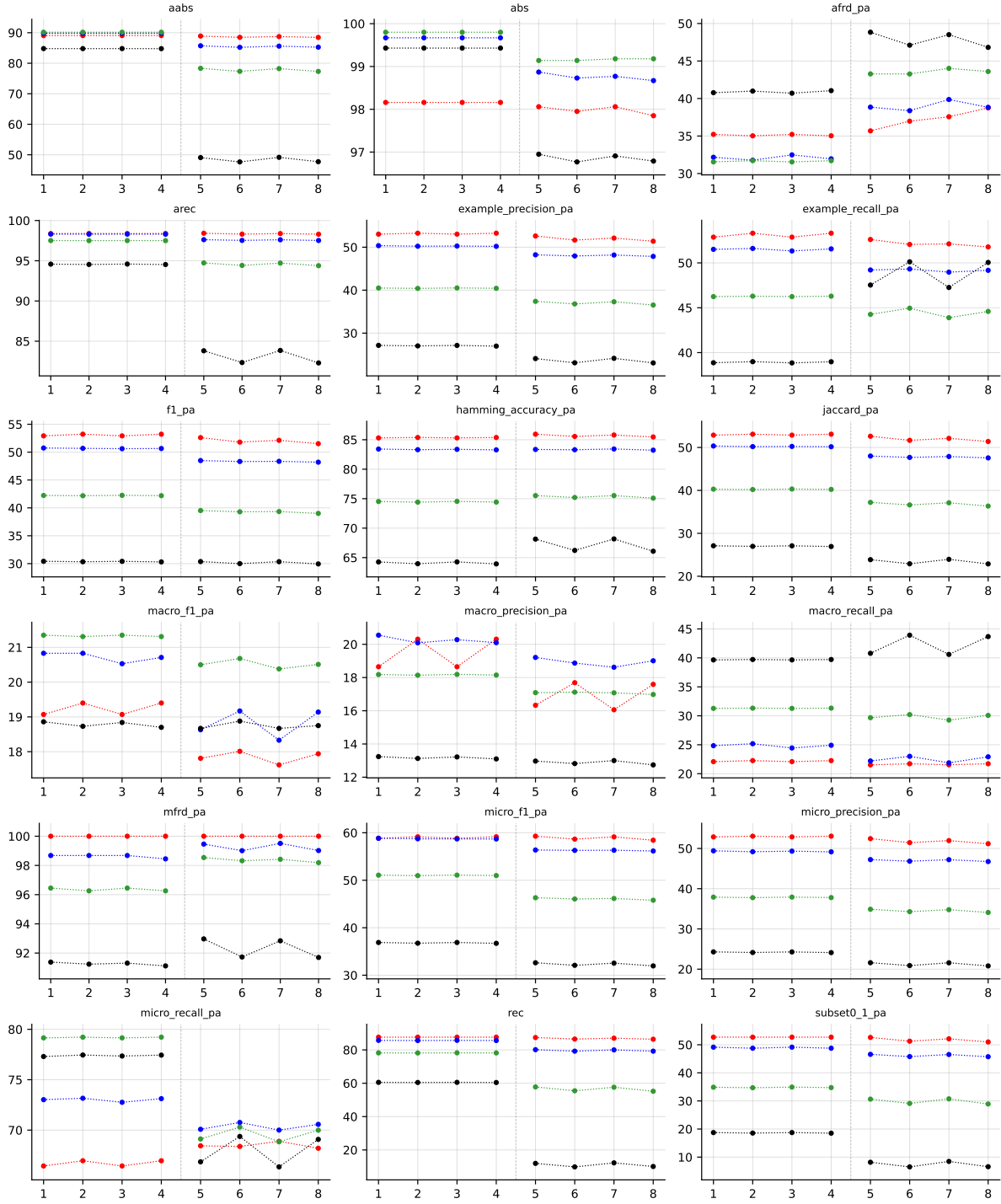


Table 38: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on PlantPseAAC (RF base learner).

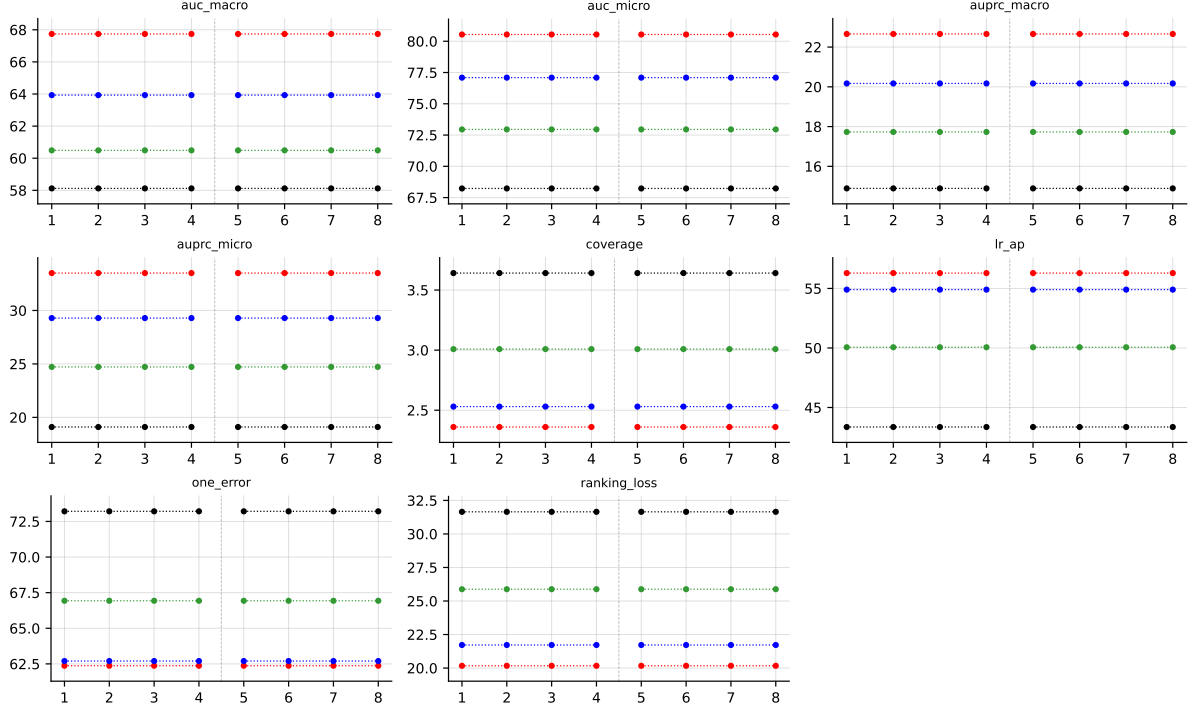


Table 39: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on PlantPseAAC (RF base learner).

## B.5 HumanPseAAC ( $K = 14$ )

**RF • HumanPseAAC • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions**

**RF • HumanPseAAC • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention**

**RF • HumanPseAAC • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)**

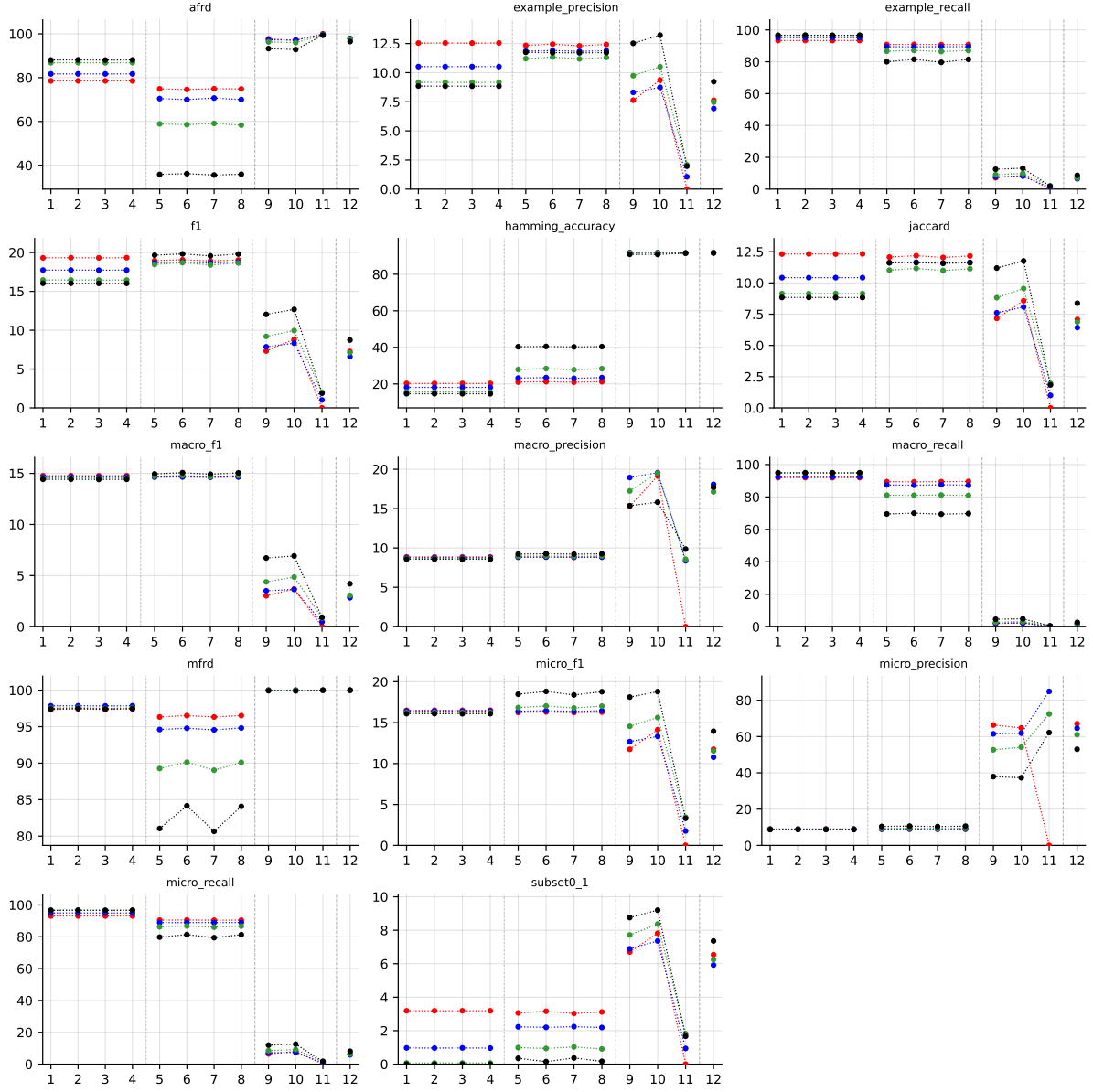


Table 40: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on HumanPseAAC (RF base learner).

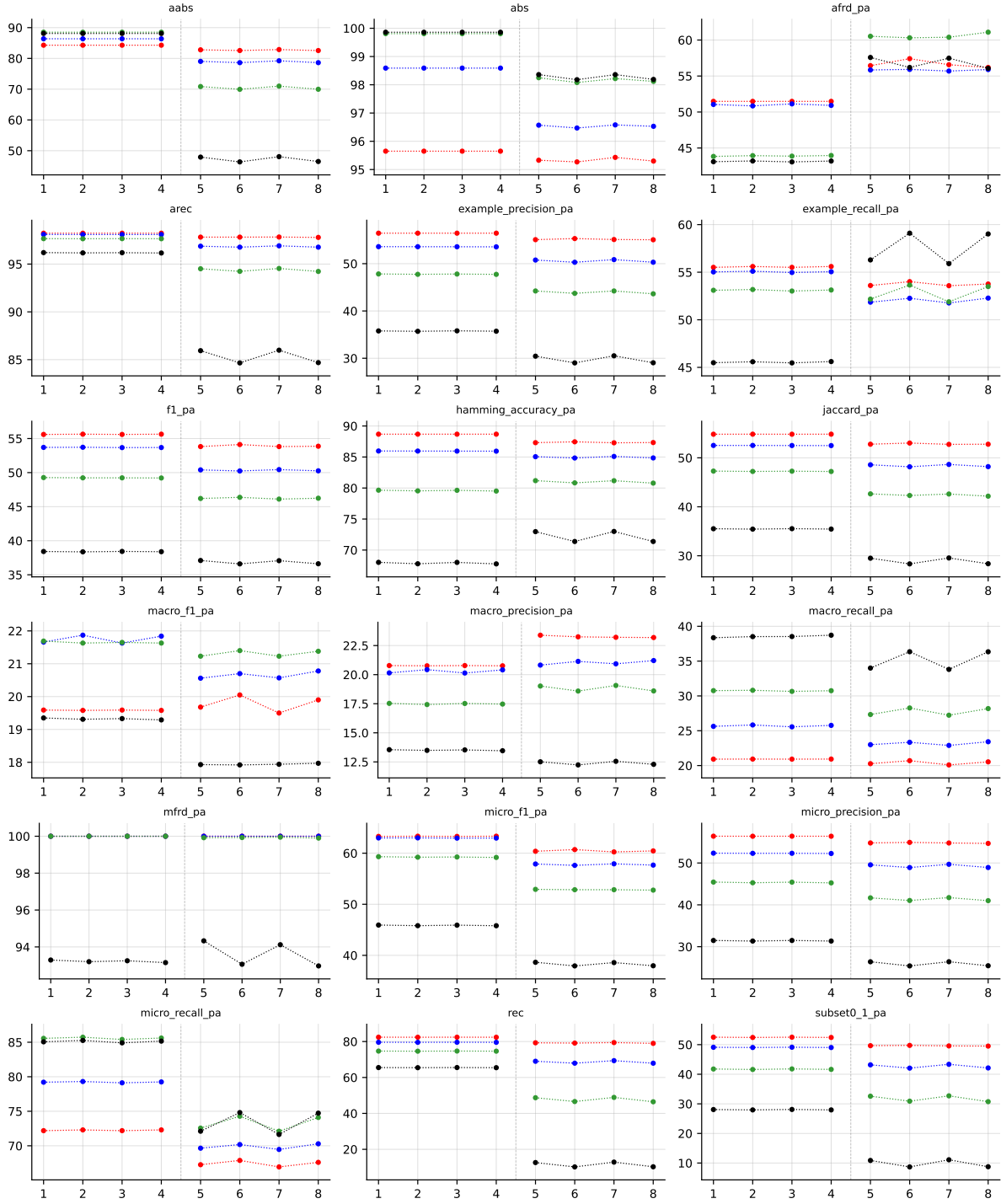


Table 41: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on HumanPseAAC (RF base learner).

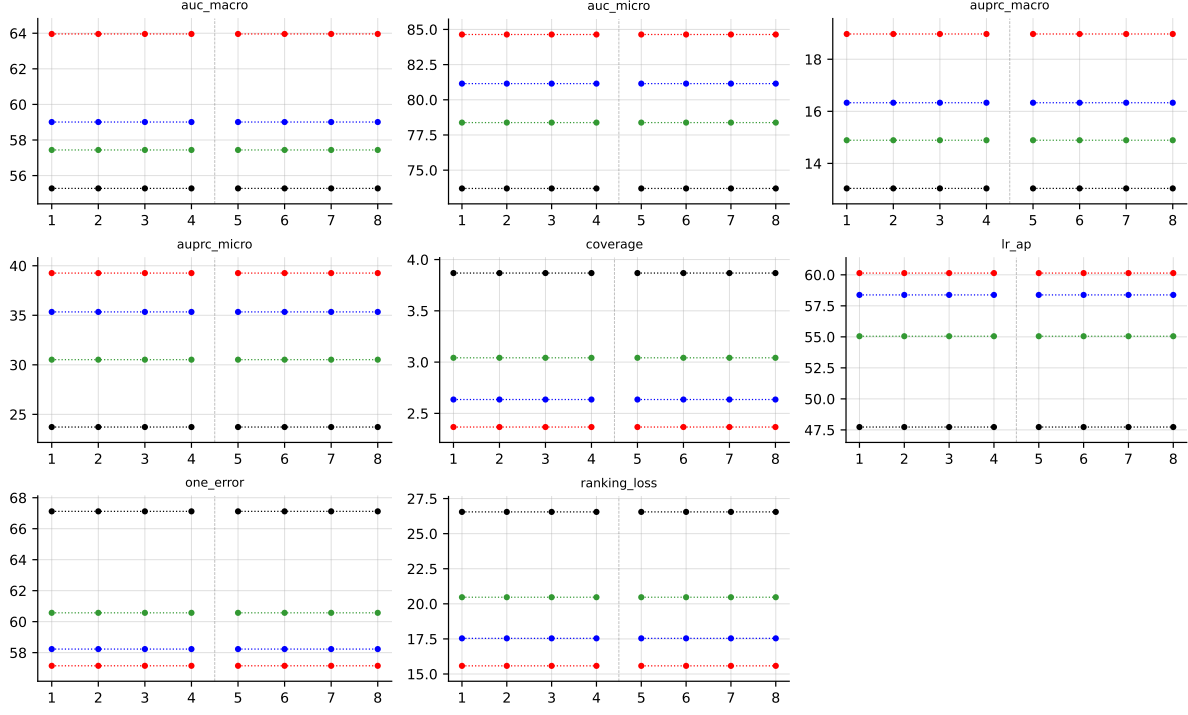


Table 42: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on HumanPseAAC (RF base learner).

## B.6 Yeast ( $K = 14$ )

**RF • Yeast • BinaryVector** — Standard MLC predictions

**RF • Yeast • PartialAbstention** — Partial abstention

**RF • Yeast • ScoreVector** — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

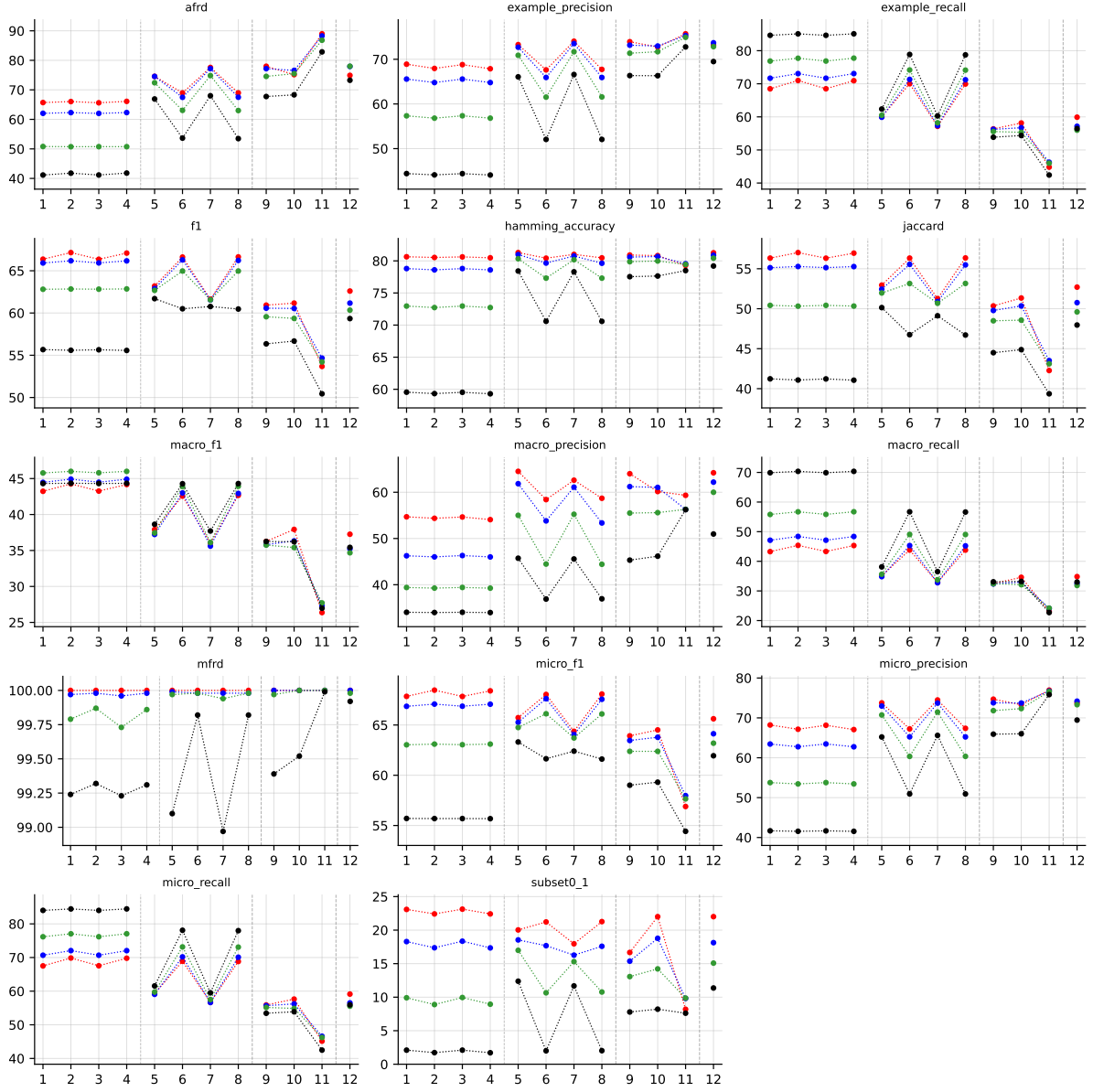


Table 43: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on Yeast (RF base learner).

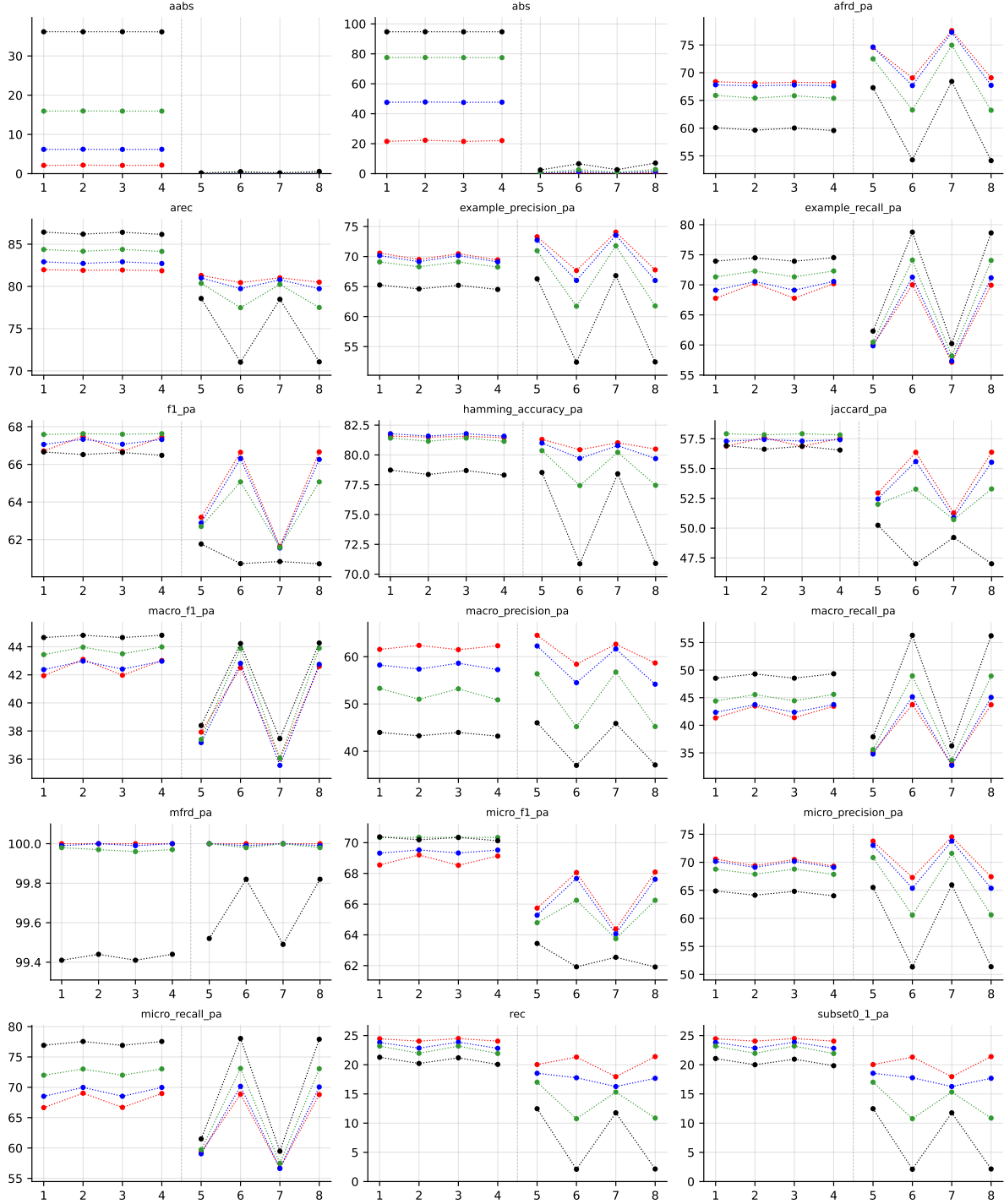


Table 44: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on Yeast (RF base learner).

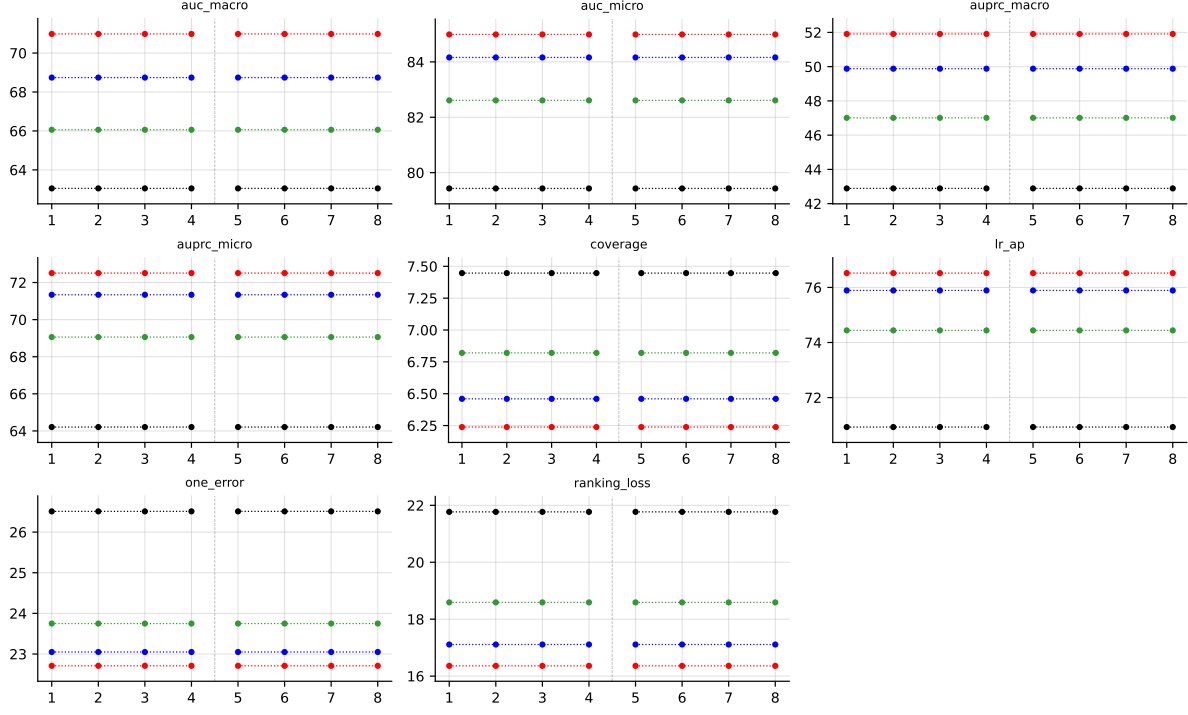


Table 45: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on Yeast (RF base learner).

## B.7 CHD\_49 ( $K = 6$ )

**RF • CHD\_49 • BinaryVector** — Standard MLC predictions

**RF • CHD\_49 • PartialAbstention** — Partial abstention

**RF • CHD\_49 • ScoreVector** — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)



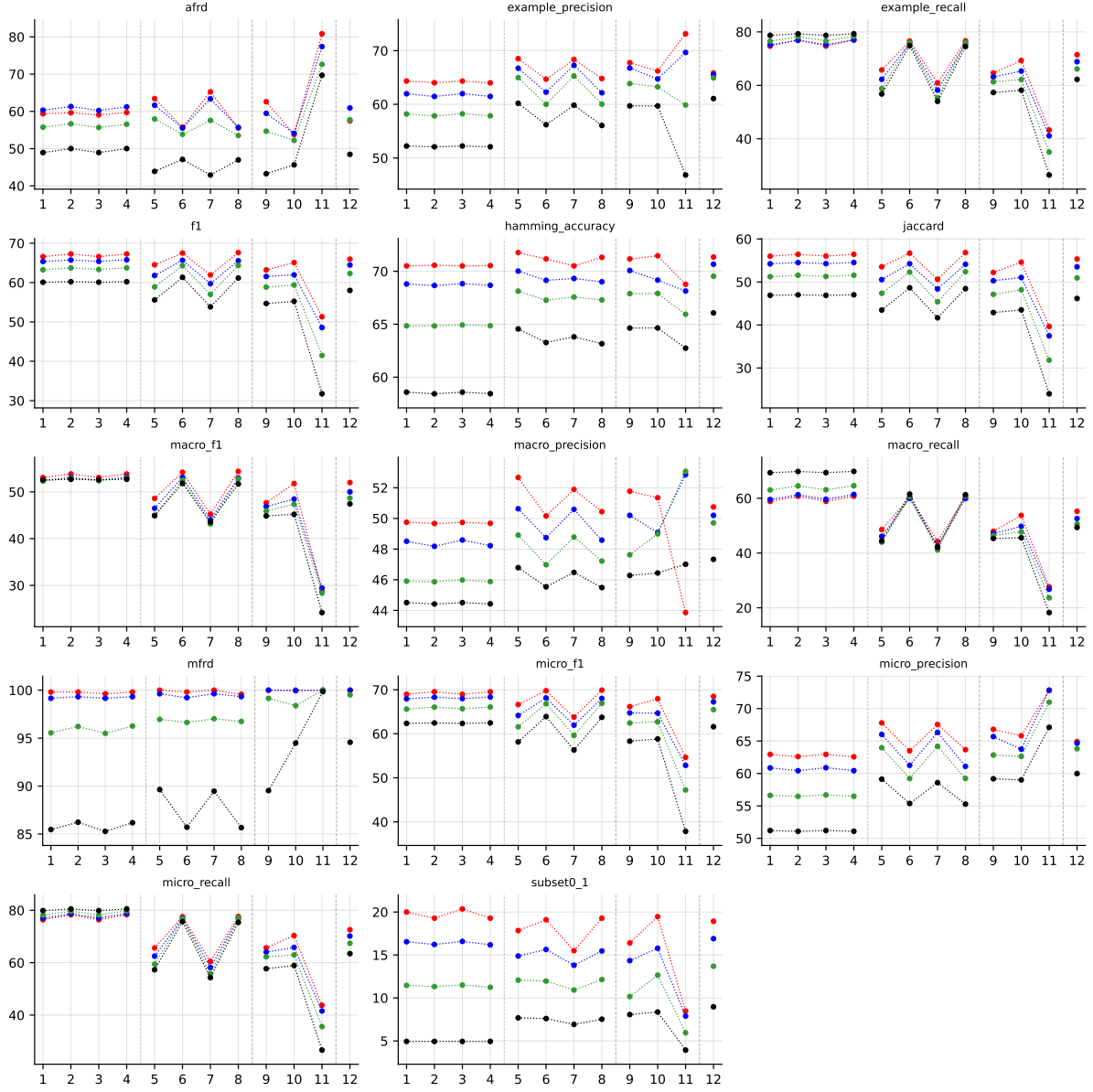


Table 46: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on CHD\_49 (RF base learner).

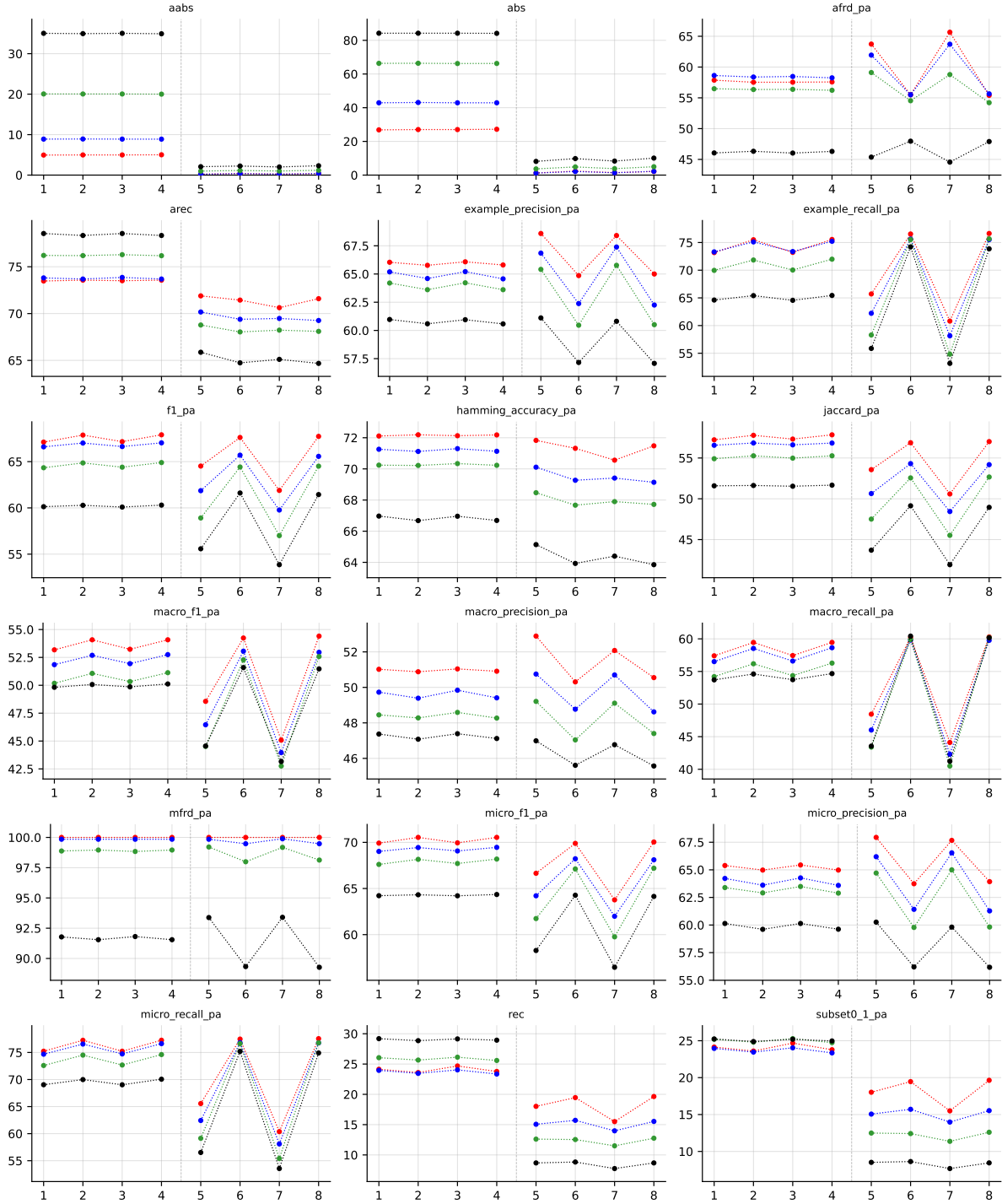


Table 47: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on CHD\_49 (RF base learner).

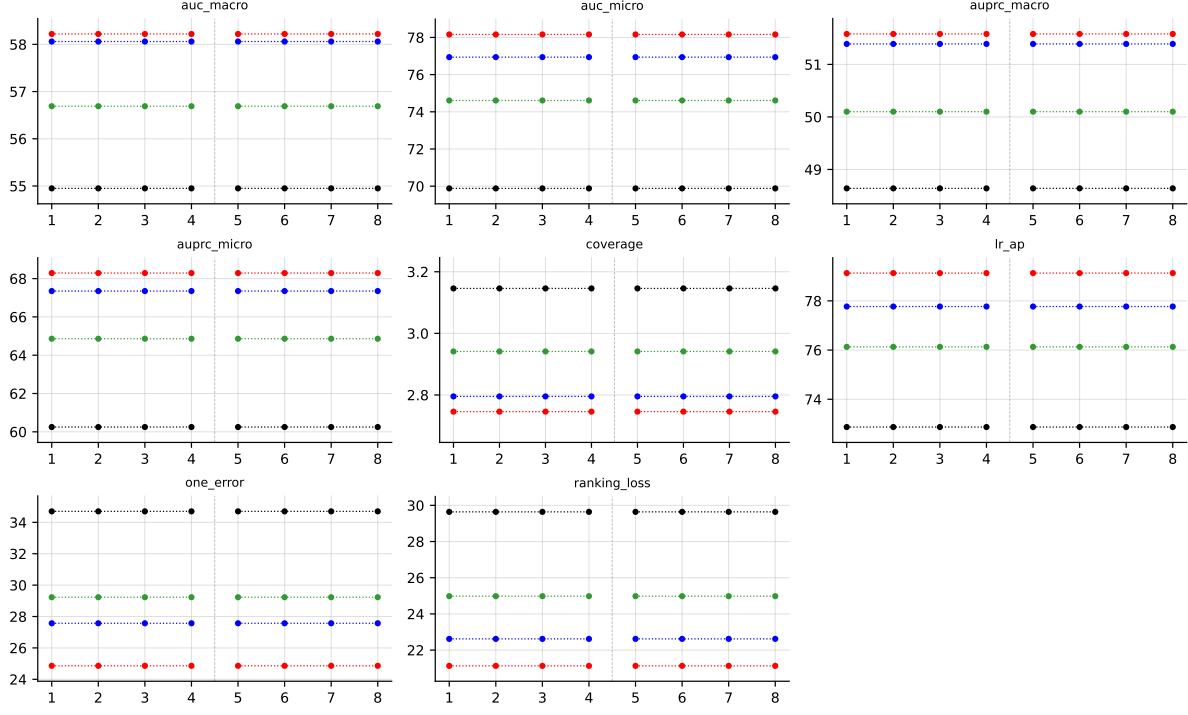


Table 48: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on CHD\_49 (RF base learner).

## B.8 Water-quality ( $K = 14$ )

**RF • Water-quality • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions**

**RF • Water-quality • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention**

**RF • Water-quality • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)**

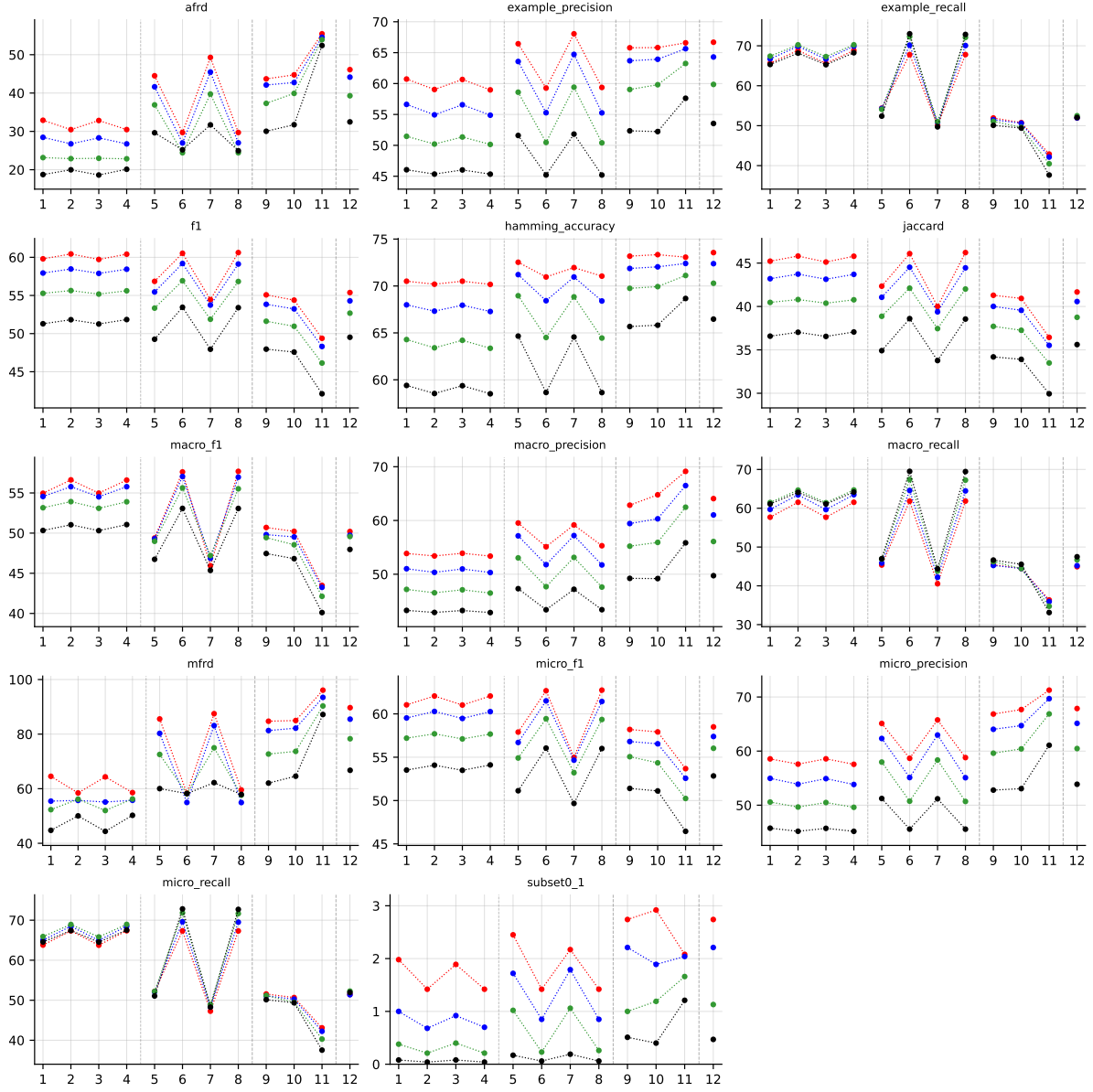


Table 49: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on Water-quality (RF base learner).

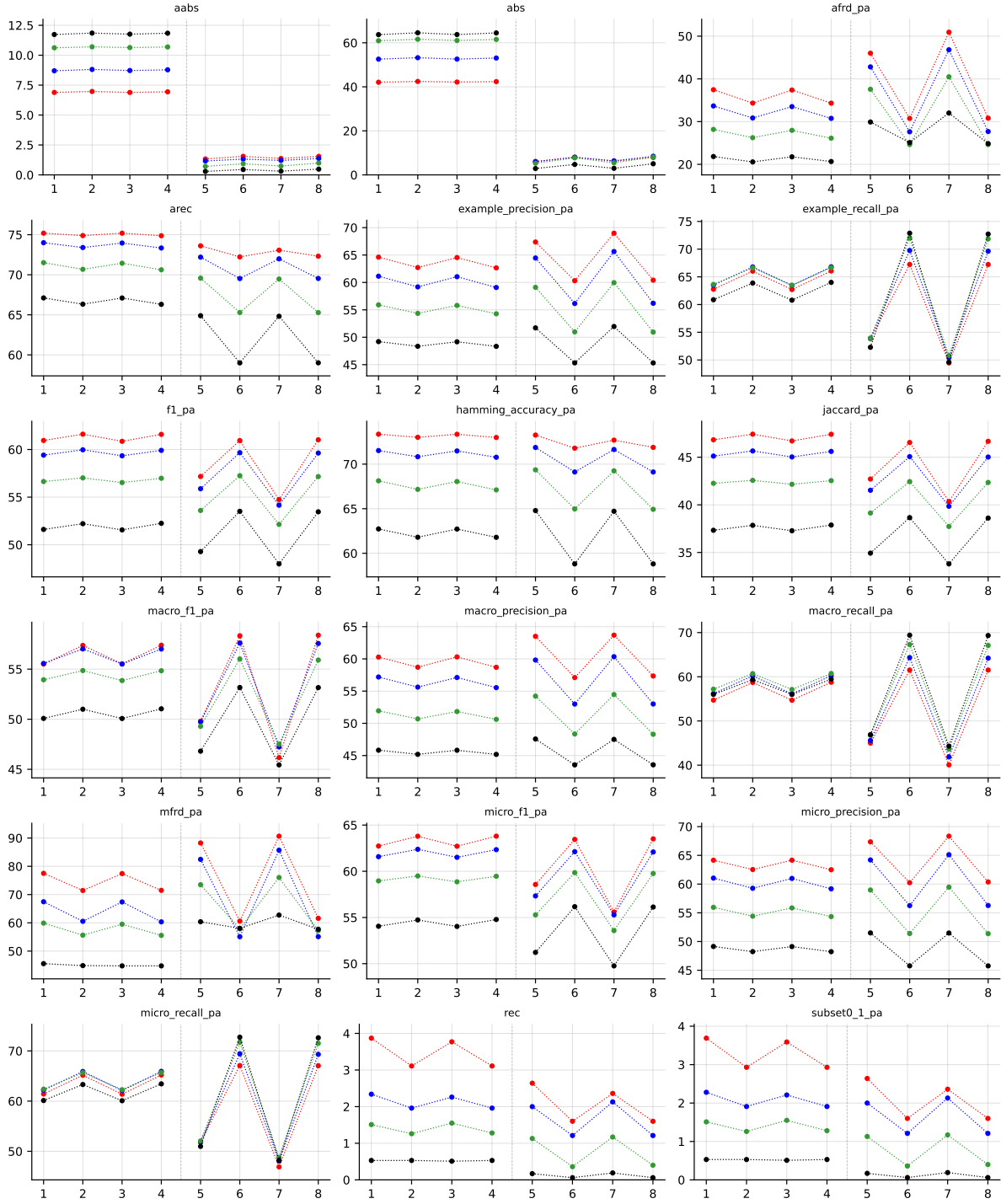


Table 50: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on Water-quality (RF base learner).

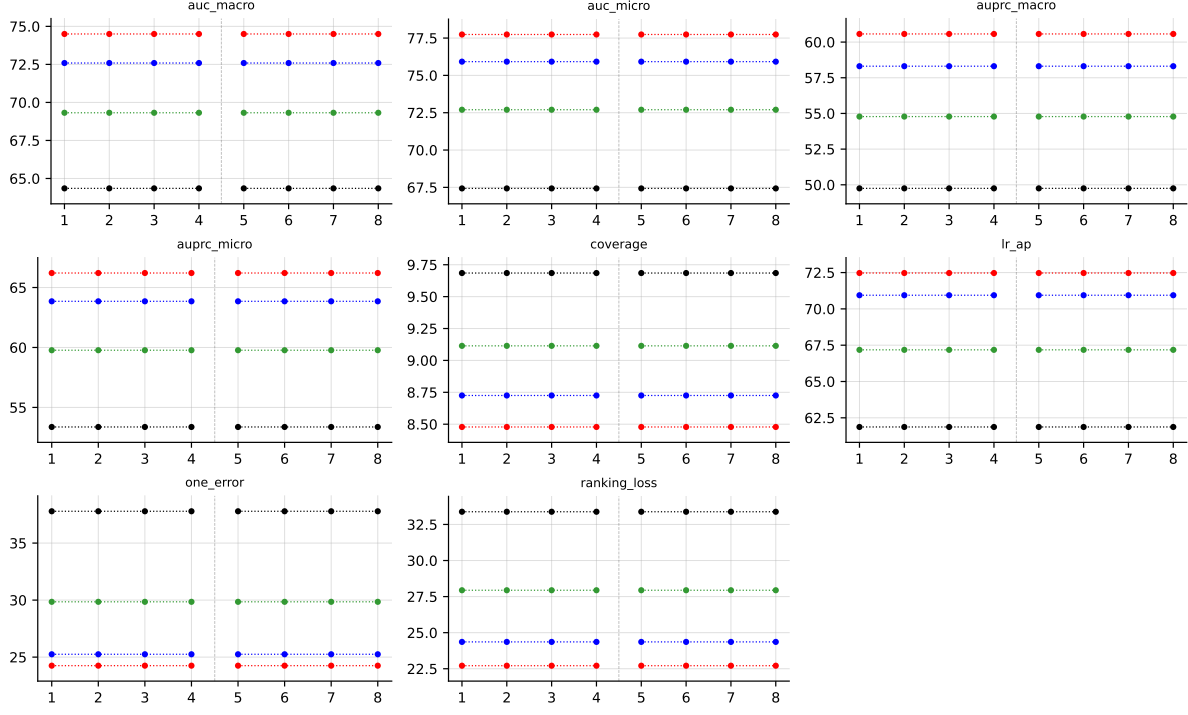


Table 51: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on Water-quality (RF base learner).

## B.9 enron ( $K = 53$ )

RF • enron • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions

RF • enron • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention

RF • enron • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

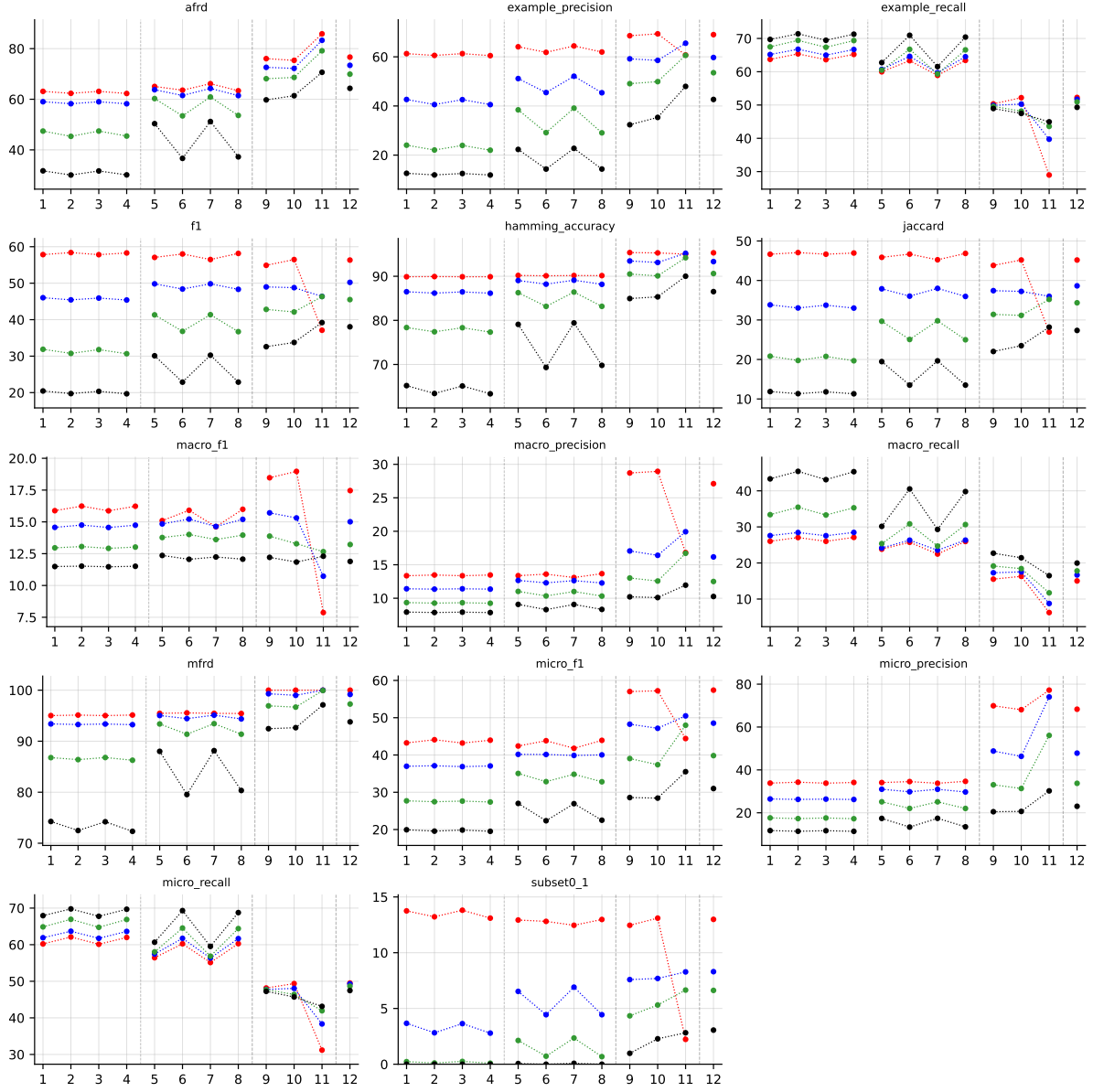


Table 52: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector) on **enron** (RF base learner).

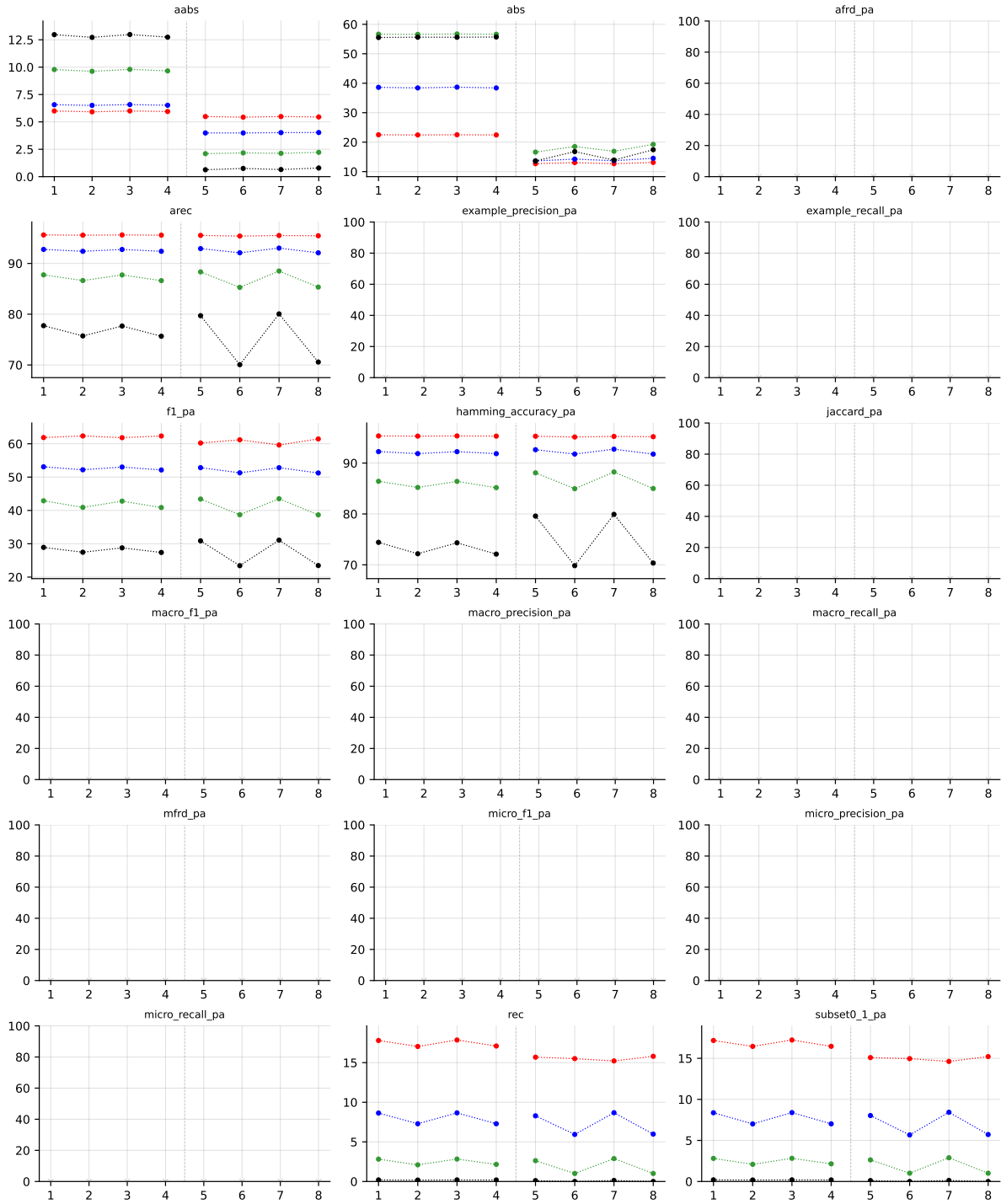


Table 53: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention) on **enron** (RF base learner).



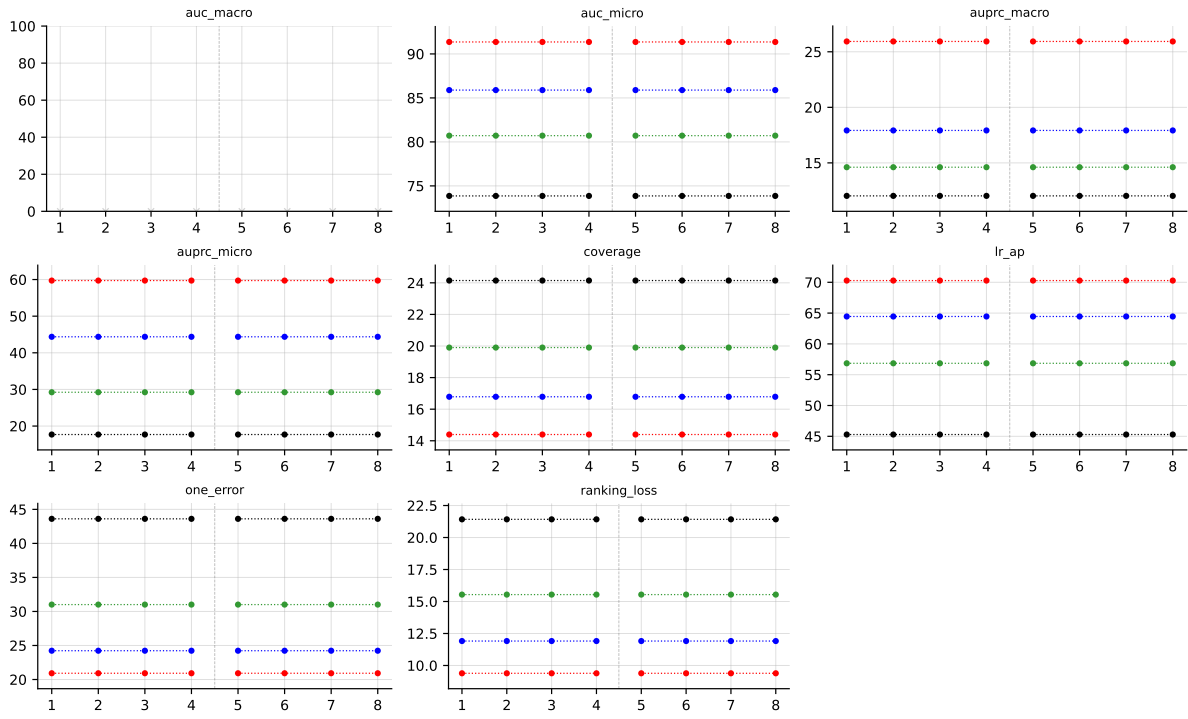


Table 54: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector) on **enron** (RF base learner).

## C LGBM aggregated results

LGBM • Aggregate • BinaryVector — Standard MLC predictions

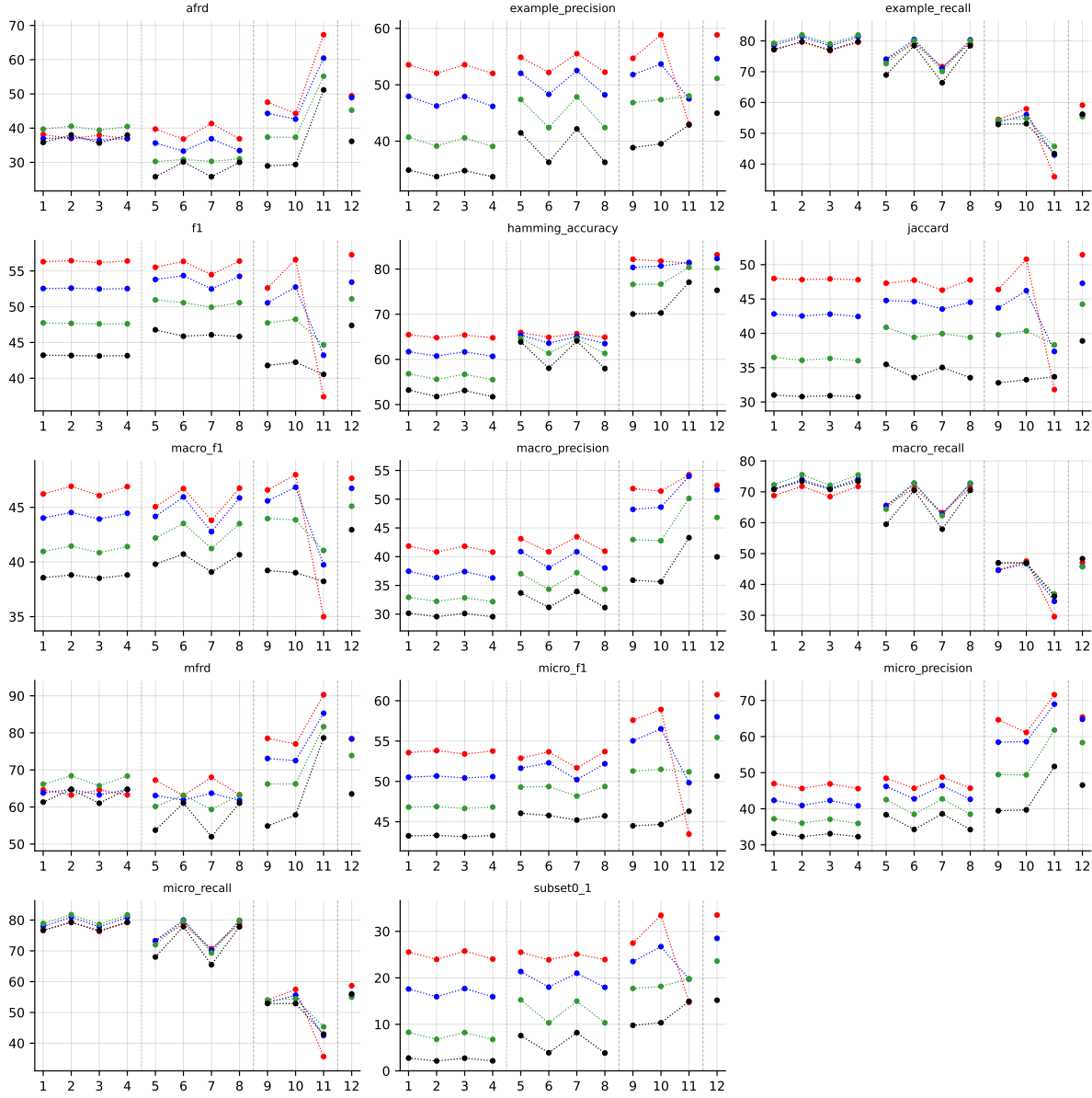


Table 55: Standard MLC predictions (BinaryVector), LGBM base learner, averaged across datasets (8 of 9: enron LGBM still training). Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.

LGBM • Aggregate • PartialAbstention — Partial abstention

LGBM • Aggregate • ScoreVector — Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.)

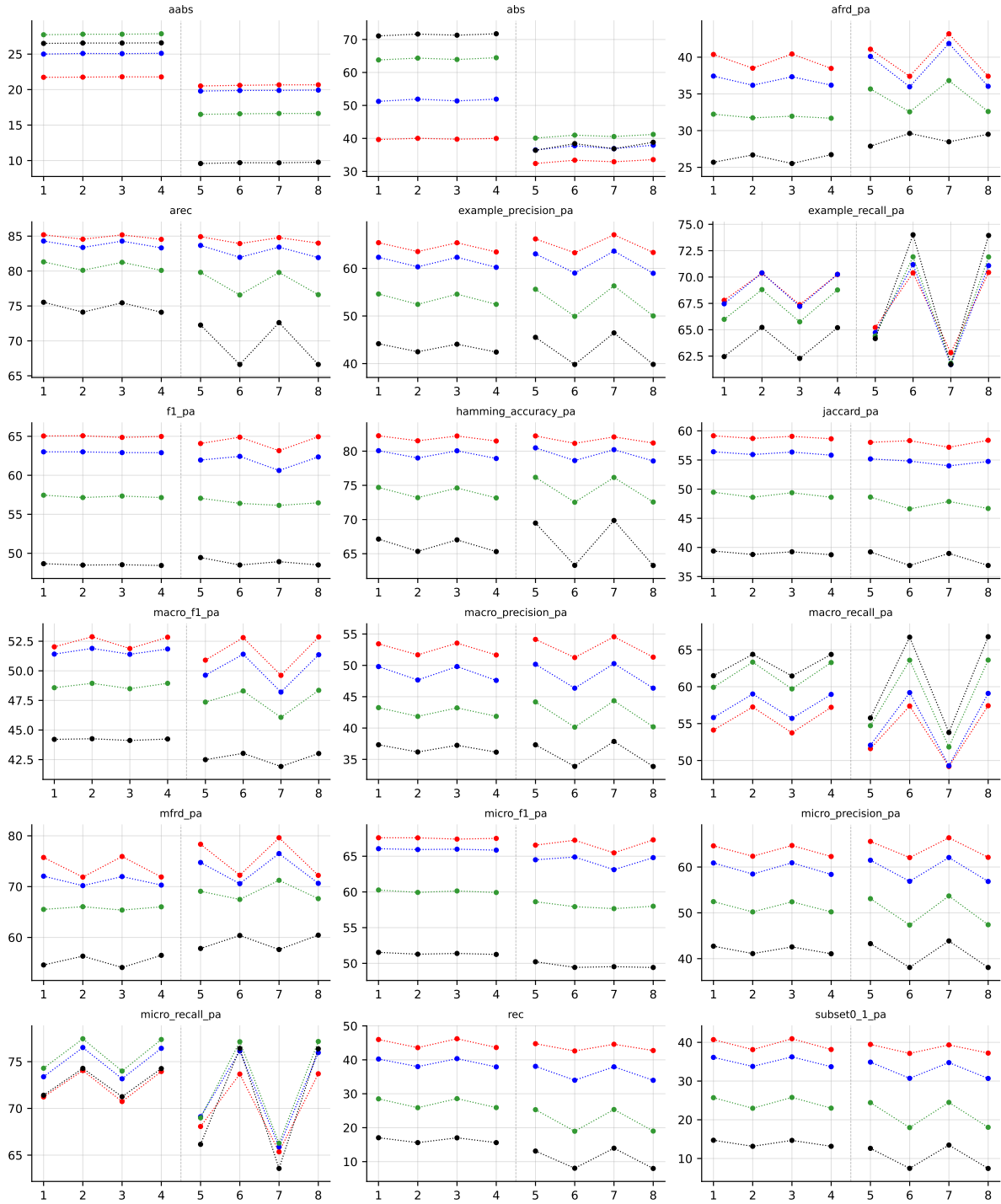


Table 56: Partial abstention (PartialAbstention), LGBM base learner, averaged across datasets (8 of 9: enron LGBM still training). Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.

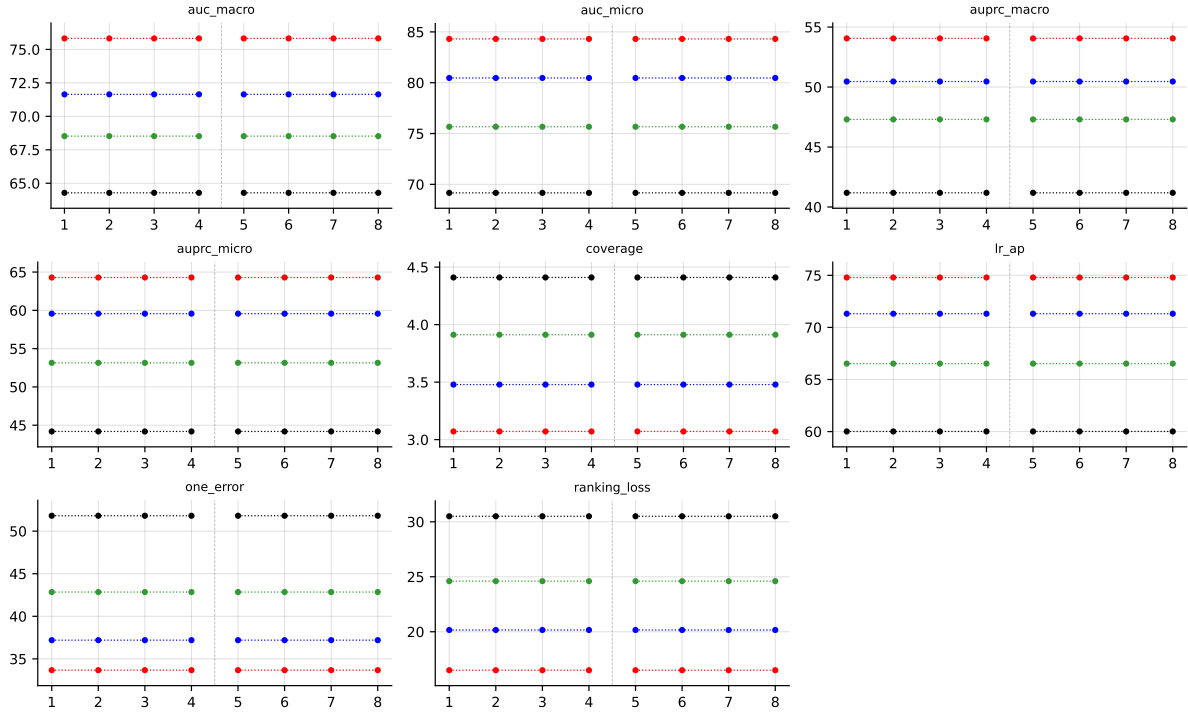


Table 57: Score-vector ranking metrics (AUROC, AUPRC, etc.) (ScoreVector), LGBM base learner, averaged across datasets (8 of 9: enron LGBM still training). Method indices and line colors follow the encoding paragraph above.